

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called 'The Dense Array of Ornaments'

Ārya Ghanavyūha Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra · Toh 110 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྒྱ་སྒྲ་པ་བླ་མ་ཞེས་བརྒྱ་ཐག་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མཛོད་

Toh 110 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Ghanavyūha Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra and in Tibetan as the Phakpa Gyen Tukpo Köpa (ཕཀཔ་ཀེན་ཏུཀཔོ་ཀོཔ་), rendered in English as "The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called The Dense Array of Ornaments." It belongs to the sūtra section of the Kangyur and presents a visionary scene in which the Buddha abides in a magnificent, densely adorned buddha-field together with an assembly of great bodhisattvas who are masters of the highest yoga. The text concerns the qualities and powers of the Buddha and the advanced bodhisattvas surrounding him, unfolding against a cosmological backdrop that encompasses the form realm, the formless realm, and beyond. As a Noble Mahāyāna Sūtra, it is addressed to practitioners of the Great Vehicle and reflects the elaborate visionary and doctrinal richness characteristic of that tradition.

In the language of India: Ārya Ghanavyūha Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called "The Dense Array of Ornaments."

The first fascicle.

I pay homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, having passed beyond all sentient beings of the form realm, the formless realm, and the realm of neither-perception — dwelling in sovereignty over all phenomena that arise from desire — abided together, in a dense buddha-field endowed with power, with those great bodhisattvas, great beings who are masters of the yoga of the supreme yoga, who sport and move about by means of the four bases of miraculous power. These were: the great bodhisattva, great being Subduer of the Views of All Obstructors; the great bodhisattva, great being Great Intelligence; the great bodhisattva, great being who Correctly Demonstrates the Arrangement of All the Qualities of a Buddha Exactly as They Are; the great bodhisattva, great being Avalokiteśvara; the great bodhisattva, great being Obtainer of Great Power; the great bodhisattva, great being King of Magical Display; the great bodhisattva, great being Mañjuśrī in his youthful

form; the great bodhisattva, great being Vajra Essence; the great bodhisattva, great being Moon of Complete Liberation; the great bodhisattva, great being Holder of Force — and, along with these and others, as many great bodhisattvas, great beings as there are infinitesimal dust particles of ten buddha-fields — all of them utterly transcending the objects of the three realms, utterly transcending the domain of mind, mentation, consciousness, and the all-base consciousness (ālayavijñāna), abiding instead in bodies of wisdom and mind, like illusions, moving with fearlessness, amid clouds of Dharma, endowed with meditative absorption, consecrated by the empowerment of the hands of many buddhas, and seated upon great lotuses in immeasurable palaces utterly transcending the objects of the three realms.

In that place there was no coming and going of any obstructors, śrāvakas, or pratyekabuddhas.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha — one who dwells at ease in the qualities of vision, whose sphere of activity is known through his own noble gnosis — arose from the meditative absorption that proclaims a melody of majesty through the display of many forms. Having arisen, he came forth from a palace adorned with light of rainbows and lightning, adorned with many banners and streamers, and proceeded to the upper chamber called Immaculate Moon Essence. Having arrived there, he took his seat upon a fine lion-throne adorned in the manner of the dense array, together with the bodhisattvas.

Having taken his seat, the Blessed One gazed in the four directions, and from between his eyebrows emitted a great mass of light-rays called Precious Gem-Light Adornment of the Ushnīsha, encircled by a hundred thousand light-rays. When this mass of light-rays appeared, all the adornments of all the buddha-fields became manifest as alike to a single adornment of a buddha. The infinitesimal subtle nature of all the buddha-fields was likewise made fully manifest down to the very subtlety of supremely fine dust. The dense buddha-field stood out, transcending the nature of other buddha-fields even at the level of infinitesimal dust.

The dense buddha-field is free of light, of planets, and of the moon.

By its very nature as the unconditioned, it does not appear even at the level of infinitesimal subtle dust. Yet otherwise — not to be mistaken for nirvāṇa, for space, or for cessation unexamined — those great bodhisattvas (bodhisattvas mahāsattvas), the Blessed Ones who are buddhas, and the great bodhisattvas

practicing in other buddha-fields all beheld it.

Then the Blessed One, having beheld those displays of buddha-field adornments and the powers of the buddhas and bodhisattvas, looked out with his buddha-eyes in all ten directions upon the assembly of bodhisattvas, and declared to the bodhisattva Perfectly Displaying All the Qualities of a Buddha as they truly are: "In this buddha-field called Dense Array, Adorned with the Perfectly True Display as It Is — beings belonging to the desire realm, the form realm, the formless realm, and those of the non-perceptual class, along with form-craving, ignorance, and the fruit of meditative absorption, having been wholly incinerated by the fire of primordial wisdom and undergone transformation in abiding — come here, distinguished by bodies attained through dedication with the ten culminating aspirational prayers, being adorned with the meditative absorption of primordial wisdom, the power of a mind-made body, direct knowledge, the magical legs of supernormal power, and dominion; being without obstruction, abiding at length, resembling reflections seen within a mirror — reflections like the moon, the sun, a jewel, lightning, a rainbow, coral, foam, a rainbow-hued stone, vermillion, black-grain seeds, the kiṃśuka flower, the indragopa insect, gold, the campaka flower, a lotus, a conch, the neck of a peacock, and a crystal — having attained those forms, and because they are purified at each ground without outflow, mastering the cause-meditative absorption purified by the undefiled."

Then the great bodhisattva Perfectly Displaying All the Qualities of a Buddha as they truly are rose from his seat, drew his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, joined his palms toward the Blessed One, made prostration, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened Buddha — if the Blessed One would grant me the opportunity to ask a question of him and to request a prophecy, I would ask it."

The Blessed One declared: "Perfectly Displaying All the Qualities of a Buddha as they truly are, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha whatever you wish to ask. I shall satisfy the mind of whoever asks whatever questions they wish by giving prophecy. Speak as you see fit."

Then that great bodhisattva Perfectly Displaying All the Qualities of a Buddha as they truly are, the opportunity having been granted by the Blessed One, addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, does the Dense Array

buddha-field alone transcend beings of the desire realm, the form realm, the formless realm, and those of the non-perceptual class — does it alone abide so? Or do other buddha-fields exist likewise?"

"Son of good family, the Dense Array buddha-field alone does not transcend beings of the desire realm, the form realm, the formless realm, and those of the non-perceptual class and abide so — other buddha-fields also exist in this way. Son of good family, beyond this place, far, far beyond, past ten billion hundred-thousand buddha-fields above, in that direction there is the buddha-field of the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened Buddha Brahmāsvara, and likewise that of the Tathāgata Sovereign King of Śāla Trees —"

and that of the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened Buddha Sovereign King of Stars — and beyond those Blessed One buddhas, the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and fully awakened ones, still further and yet further beyond, there exist many vast and expansive buddha-fields, in number many hundreds of thousands of ten billions, adorned with the assembled retinues of bodhisattvas. And those Blessed One buddhas too, within those various assemblies of retinues, teach the great bodhisattvas, right to the ultimate end of the final age, discourses on the domain of realization of their own individual noble wisdom; words of Dharma for dwelling at ease in the phenomena directly seen; the domain of conceptual thought; suchness free from letters; the genuine limit; and the attainment of nirvāṇa. This is taught as it truly and perfectly is, as a genuine and perfect arrangement. And it is because you spoke, asking whether beyond this there exist other worlds and buddhas, that I, who teach the genuine and perfect arrangement precisely as it is, gave this reply. Not only did you think to ask the Tathāgata because you alone wished to behold the adornments of buddha-fields and the bodhisattvas — but the great bodhisattva Śughādhārin too, wishing to behold the adornments of the buddha-fields of the Blessed One buddhas, the maṇḍala of the melodious voice of the buddhas, and the immeasurable uṣṇīṣa, traversed a hundred billion buddha-fields and, ascending through buddha-fields as numerous as the sands of the Ganges by the supreme miraculous power, still did not see even a single Tathāgata's buddha-field adornments, nor the maṇḍala of the melodious voice of a buddha, nor the immeasurable uṣṇīṣa. Not having seen them, he was filled with wonder, and bearing in his memory, inconceivably and perfectly, the maṇḍala of the melodious voice of the buddhas and the immeasurable uṣṇīṣa, he came back here to this very

world-realm of Sahā and arrived in the presence of the Blessed One at Śrāvastī. He confessed his faults as faults, understood the buddhas to be equal to space and praised them, developed confident devotion toward the domain of realization of his own individual noble wisdom, and went to dwell in the Dense Array buddha-field.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajragarbha, skilled in the grounds and the characteristics of the grounds, subtle and focused in his observation, and reciting words of certain and unerring import, rose from his seat, arranged his outer robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and with palms joined, made prostration toward the place where the Blessed One was seated, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, if the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, would grant me the opportunity to present a request to you on one point for the sake of prophetic instruction, I shall ask it."

The Blessed One declared: "Vajragarbha, ask the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened Buddha.

"I will be pleased by prophetic instruction on whatever questions you ask. Speak, then, just as you wish."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, and the Blessed One had granted the opportunity to the bodhisattva, the great being Vajragarbha, he addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, what is the meaning of the terms 'buddha' and 'becoming fully awakened'? Blessed One, I request that you explain, and that the Sugata teach, for the purpose of turning back the minds of those who abide in the ultimate, who dwell alongside those who have fallen into views — the view that the buddha-lineage, which is the nature of reality (dharmatā), the domain of the noble ones in the ultimate, is demonstrated through the conduct of the grounds — those of past, present, and future conduct — and alongside those whose minds, attached to the doctrines of others, move in a domain defined by form, defining marks, and views that have fallen into the extreme of total inclusion, and those who move in a domain contaminated by views that have fallen into a convergence around particles, the precious, faculties, directions, time, space, self, mentation, faculties, and objects; and for the purpose of turning back the minds of those who, clinging to consciousnesses arisen from the causal, immediately preceding, dominant, and objective conditions, who hold to assertions of existence and non-existence, and who have fallen into

the view that the aggregates of these phenomena and persons are emptiness. Blessed One, teach this, so that those with faculty for the Dharma may hear. O Sugata, please teach.

Apart from the lord who is holy and supreme,
by what, through what knowing and what to be known,
does one become fully awakened from the cause
that is the five consciousnesses and so on?

One who has comprehended the five aspects of what is to be known —
that one is a buddha, for by knowing all phenomena,
one passes beyond sorrow and is of equal going."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent! Vajragarbha, you who have mastery over the ten grounds, who have transcended the domain of conceptual thought, you who are learned and who proclaim the lineage of the buddhas as the nature of reality — excellent! You who have mastery over the supreme yoga: this question about 'buddha' and 'becoming fully awakened' has not arisen in you alone as a matter of curiosity. The good illusionist and other children of the Victors have also arisen in curiosity about this matter, inquiring into the nature of buddhahood: 'What is the meaning of the word "Tathāgata"? Is form the Tathāgata? Or is something other than form the Tathāgata? Likewise with the formations of the aggregates, elements, and sense bases. One does not see the equality of inner and outer, and since the aggregates are produced by a fabricated cause and are subject to disintegration, there is no Tathāgata in the aggregates. Since one has comprehended the absence of subtle particles, it is the domain of wisdom, primordial gnosis, and meditative absorption. Since the mind in meditative equipoise has not followed after them and the aggregates have arisen, the dharmakāya of the Tathāgata is therefore permanent' — so they wonder."

"O child of the Victors, excellent — you who are learned in the thorough analysis of the dharmadhātu! O child of the Victors, therefore listen very well, take it to heart, and I will explain it to you."

"Excellent," said the bodhisattva, the great being Vajragarbha, and he listened to the Blessed One in reply.

The Blessed One then declared: "O son of good family, Vajragarbha, you who have mastery over the vajra-like meditative absorption — Vajragarbha, the aggregates are not the Tathāgata. Nor does the Tathāgata exist apart from the aggregates. Nor does he abide in the aggregates.

Nor does the Tathāgata abide in the aggregates. Nor in arising and ceasing. Nor is he something to be known, nor knowing, nor an object, nor the sense faculties. Why is this? Because the aggregates, elements, sense sources, and objects are without conceptual thought, and the Tathāgata does not look inward or outward from among these. Form has no production and no mind; it is a phenomenon without arising, destined to perish at its end, like grass, wood, or a clod of earth, like a mass of extremely fine dust-motes rising up.

Feeling arises from the conjunction of two, like a water bubble. Perception arises from causes such as a pot, a cloth, a crown, and the like; it too is like a mirage arising from two — just as, for example, when the sun's rays fall upon the parched spring earth and rise up shimmering like waves upon water, they bewilder thirsty deer and birds into mistaking them for water and searching for it. In the same way, perception is not the nature of those things; it enters into forms that are not their nature; it arises from false and thorough imputation; it is not found apart from what analysis and discourse say about it; it is exhausted in being mere name, like speaking of a rabbit's horn or the son of a barren woman; and it is to be regarded like describing forms seen in a dream. For example, when in a dream one sees forms by means of perception of form, upon waking neither form and so forth nor a beautiful woman can be found anywhere. In the same way, when through ignorance one wanders astray and sees women, men, and the like, upon full awakening these too cannot be found.

Formations are like the pith of a plantain tree — when sought, those that are formless, arising from body, speech, and mind, cannot be found by those who are yogins skilled in analysis. Consciousness is like an illusion, having no nature of its own. It is as though a magician or his student, relying on nothing more than grass, wood, or a clod of earth, fashions an illusory form complete with many bodily parts — an elephant, a horse, a chariot, a person, an ornately dressed form — and shows it as something wondrous from one side; and just as the naive crowds, who are not the learned, are led astray. In the same way, consciousness too appears in one aspect, and when examined and analyzed in another aspect, knowing that it grasps the self through that very self in a twofold manner, it turns away, like the wonder of a single illusory form that has been conjured up.

The Tathāgata is permanent, stable, everlasting, imperishable; he is the object of those yogins who cultivate the recollection of the buddha. What is proclaimed as the tathāgatagarbha (buddha-nature) is the expanse of nirvāṇa,

imperishable like space. The word nirvāṇa — a word that goes beyond the dharmadhātu as a term — is taught by the Blessed Buddhas of the past, present, and future. It is thus: whether Tathāgatas arise or do not arise, the nature of reality of phenomena, the very abiding of phenomena in the Dharma — the dharmadhātu and the blameless dharma — these two abide just as they are.

What is called the vajra-essence that is without fault is free from every blemish of arising. And the vajra-essence that is without fault is not only free from every blemish — it also enters into meditative absorption. The passage through that which is without fault is something a bodhisattva should abandon. Why is this? Because, having focused the mind upon that very gateway of meditative absorption,

one looks upon sentient beings no longer, actualizes the ultimate limit, and passes into nirvāṇa like a fire whose iron fuel has been entirely consumed. In doing so, one abandons diligent effort for the welfare of sentient beings, parts from great compassion and the perfections, cuts off the lineage of the buddhas, and travels the path that leaves śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas stranded at a dead end. Like a great elephant mired in the swamp of meditative absorption, one becomes thoroughly obstructed; and because the objects of consciousness are utterly shrunk away, one will not abide in or complete all the sense sources of buddha-Dharma. Therefore that gateway should not be actualized; one should remain without touching it, without approaching or accomplishing it.

Having thus entered upon the path of the dharmakāya of the buddhas, knowing the very greatness of buddhahood, one employs the domain of buddhas of manifold aspects who turn the wheel of Dharma. Possessing the domain of emanation. Roused from meditative absorption by the Tathāgatas through their engaged activity. Having passed beyond the eighth ground. Having caused the ground of the Cloud of Dharma to be thoroughly known. Having tasted the very greatness of buddhahood, one enters the ground that is the domain of the self-knowing, self-cognizing noble wisdom of the Tathāgata — and abides there, practicing the meditative absorption in which movement through all directions is undisturbed; spontaneously accomplished, permanent, enduring, and stable, dwelling in the dense buddha-field. One then reveals to those lords of the vajra ground the engagement of magical display, transformed in their very being, possessed of wish-fulfilling wisdom and meditative absorption, of powers, direct knowledge, and the legs of miraculous

ability, moving sovereignly — like the reflection of the moon in unbroken water, like the king of swans, present and meaningful to behold. In the assemblies of all human lords, one appears in whatever forms sentient beings desire according to their intentions, in order to reveal the dense buddha-field, and thus enters in accordance with the minds of sentient beings.

In all the realms of the desire realm and for the great bodhisattvas who exercise mastery — causing them to taste joys in the abodes of precious jewels and the like, revealing the successive stages of the grounds, displaying abundantly from field to field the supreme bliss of pure realms — one appears at last in a way that is not like a mantra-adept who has accomplished the highest ritual of anointing at the ultimate end, nor like a household deity ever-present in one place; rather, like one seated invisibly in a house, one moves and acts in forms of invisible emanation — rays of emanation, magical display playing through further magical display. And when one has departed, the *nirmāṇakāya* of the Tathāgata sets like the sun, and beings remain attached to and dwelling in that form body of the Tathāgata.

Then the Blessed One (the Buddha) spoke these verses:

The faculties and aggregates are an emanation,
they arise too from existence and from ignorance.
Bound by habitual tendencies, unbearable in weight,
they come forth from the causes of objects and sense faculties.

The assemblies of discernment are attachments,
they are the lasso — that is the movement of mind.
Anger is the same as a tongue of fire,
aversion is a thing that is poison itself.

The sage who practices yoga so well
always discerns these clearly:
to abandon the aggregates entirely,
the yogin practices yoga.

Form is a collection of elements;
the remaining aggregates are formless.
Just as in mid-space, there is no painting,
no shadow, no trunk of a tree, or such things —
just as the form of wind is unseen in the sky,
and just as the tracks of a bird —
so too, what is known individually by the wise:

perfect reality and the ultimate limit,
which has gone beyond the domain of words —
there the entity of buddhahood is invisible.

By the word "buddha," nirvāṇa is meant;
and nirvāṇa itself is buddha.

Because it is free from conceptuality and what is conceptualized,
it cannot be shown or demonstrated.

Free from cause and free from effect,
it is set apart from being and non-being alike.

When a stone has been ground to powder,
gold does not appear within it;
yet through the distinctive work of refinement,
gold comes to appear.

Forms are analyzed down into their particles.
By the wise, the remaining aggregates,
the elements, the collections of sense bases,
consciousness, and the sense faculties —
all things, whether singular or manifold —
when thoroughly refined down to their subtlest atoms,
buddha is not found among these entities.

Yet neither is buddha absent.

Those who are yogins see the buddha:
the one endowed with the thirty-two supreme marks.

Where suffering is, there too is bliss.

It is in that very suchness that appearance shines.

One should not say "there is no buddha" —
for buddha abides in meditative equipoise.

The buddha of virtue who is the causal buddha,
the root, which is wisdom itself,
the Victor of all the world,
the perfectly and completely awakened one —
these have been taught as the five buddhas.

The remaining Victors who are emanations
possess the tathāgatagarbha (buddha-nature)
and the thirty-two supreme marks.

For this reason a buddha exists,
and is seen by the sage who is a yogin.

Having passed beyond all three realms,
awakened in a multitude of aspects,
a buddha-field of Tathāgata divine substance,
filled throughout by noble sons,
the Great Sage — the buddha — dwells there,
resplendent with marks in all directions.

The yogin, in even equipoise, resting in yoga,
adorned beautifully together with the Dharma,
performs mutual meditation in just this way.

In the region of what is dense, upon what is not known to wisdom, making it
known,

one ranges about in that dense realm.

And who are the sentient beings in that dense realm?

All those embodied buddhas
pass utterly beyond, perishing in an instant,
ever devoted to meditative absorption.

Those who descend from Tuṣita and manifest —
all those who engage in conceptual thought see them.

The one who comes from the dense realm is like a great elephant.

The body of the buddha abides in the dense realm,
appearing in forms of every kind and manifold aspect.

By entering according to the wish of sentient beings,
the Tathāgata in meditative equipoise
appears like the reflection of the moon in water.

The jewel of manifold and varied forms
is made beautiful through its wealth of color.

Likewise the buddha, within the dense realm,
is made beautiful through meditative equipoise.

All phenomena are like reflections,
set apart from unity and from difference.

The holy person who is omniscient
enters into every purpose and aim.

Not from atoms, not from time,
not from the sense faculties, not from what is cherished,
not from conditions — yet adorned beautifully
with the world and with the buddha;
in the manner of a cause, the buddha
is beautifully adorned with respect to effects.
The body of the world is to be placed —
with ocean, mountains, and trees,
and with its multitude of wandering beings —
so that, in meditative equipoise, one greatly rejoices.

All activities, inner and outer,
those beautiful ones such as planets and the moon —
placed again in the palm of the hand,
all beings are gathered in like a mustard seed.
This is the yoga of the buddha, the sage.
The Great Sage is supreme among sages.
To the worlds, one acts without acting.
The buddha, through magical power, sends forth emanations.
All three of these elements
are emanated through the light of the buddha.

Those engaged in conceptuality, who do not know and are dull with myopic
vision and intoxication, are just wandering astray.

Those who hold views of self and no-self,
and those who speak of being and non-being —
they are defeated.

Yet those who speak of total destruction
or of partial destruction —
is there in this either absence or partial absence?
Where could there be self or no-self?

In all the diverse arising of buddhas,
the master of yoga is resplendent.
As with the activities in a city of gandharvas (beings of scent),
so too all appearances in the world —
dream forms of manifold aspect —

As a mirage appears to deer,
so too are the manifold phenomena of the world.

Actions such as weaving and the rest
are like a rope carried by the wind.

The supremely knowing master of yoga among buddhas
is like one who turns the mechanism of a machine for men,
or like one who grasps the foam of the ocean.

This concludes the first chapter, arising from the ornament of wisdom of the
Dense Array.

Then Mañjuśrī, who had become a youth, rose from his seat, arranged his
upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, joined his
palms together in the direction of the Blessed One Śākyamuni, the Tathāgata,
the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, and addressed the
Blessed One with these words:

Blessed One, how shall those who have committed the five acts of immediate
retribution, those who have abandoned the sacred Dharma, those who have
rejected noble ones, those who incline toward unrelenting torment, those who
are estranged from mother and father, those who have killed a brahmin, those
who have killed cattle, and those beings who have committed acts leading to
death — how shall all these beings be completely liberated? Blessed One, how
shall those beings be completely liberated from the suffering of saṃsāra?

The Blessed One declared: Mañjuśrī, those beings who have given the two
kinds of giving will be completely liberated from the suffering of saṃsāra.
These two are as follows: the gift of Dharma and the gift of material things.
Through the gift of Dharma, one will come to recollect one's births. Through
the gift of material things, benefit will be conferred upon all sentient beings.
Through the gift of material things, the suffering of hunger and thirst will be
entirely purified. Through the gift of Dharma, sentient beings will be
completely liberated from the suffering of saṃsāra in the hells, in the realm of
rebirth as animals, and in the world of the Lord of Death.

Mañjuśrī, if one gives both of these gifts, all acts of giving will be
encompassed. Mañjuśrī, furthermore, all giving and all acts closely related to
giving will be encompassed through five gifts. What are the five? They are as
follows: giving of conveyances, giving of parasols, giving of silks, giving of
garments and religious robes, and giving of alms, bedding, seats, medicine for
illness as a supporting condition, and the requisites — through these, all
suffering will be entirely purified.

Mañjuśrī, further, there may be some beings who have committed the five acts of immediate retribution, or who have abandoned the sacred Dharma, or who have rejected noble ones, or who incline toward unrelenting torment, or who remain for a whole aeon, or some beings who are estranged from the Three Jewels, or who harm the buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, or who steal the wealth of the community, or who in their youth have killed sheep, or who are chandālas, or who bear birthmarks — Mañjuśrī, any being who hears, inquires about, engages in inquiry into, grasps, reads, masters, teaches others extensively and correctly, or recites even a single syllable of this precious Dharma ornament of the Dense Array, this vast, wondrous, and wholly magnificent teaching — and any being who honors and serves the one who speaks this Dharma, who rises early in the morning to meet them face to face and offers them a view and prior discourse, and who touches them with their hands — all those beings, Mañjuśrī, will be completely liberated from all the sufferings of the hells, of the realm of rebirth as animals, and of the world of the Lord of Death.

Mañjuśrī, in whatever region of the earth there is one who speaks this Dharma, or if there is a cemetery, a corpse, or a charnel ground nearby, and one sees the face of that teacher — even the five acts of immediate retribution will be purified.

Mañjuśrī, within the great ocean, hungry ghosts are born in numbers running into hundreds of thousands of leagues in length. Those hungry ghosts endure feelings of unbearable suffering brought on by their own karma. Mañjuśrī, likewise, those sentient beings who abandon this precious great sūtra will come to experience such suffering.

Mañjuśrī, whoever treats this precious sūtra with honor and makes offerings to it with flowers, incense, lamps, perfume, garlands, ointments, powders, Dharma robes, parasols, victory banners, and divine pennants — and also makes offerings to the one who speaks this Dharma — even if that teacher of Dharma should commit the five acts of immediate retribution, one should still not disturb his mind.

At the very least, whatever wild animals and birds of the realm of animal rebirth eat the flesh of corpses lying in charnel grounds in the region where the teacher of Dharma dwells — all of those beings will become irreversible and will attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. All those other wild animals and birds will attain rebirth in this very densely arrayed buddha-field.

Have no doubt, hesitation, or second thoughts about this.

Whatever sentient beings have in former times planted the roots of virtue, have formerly been embraced by bodhisattvas, and have formerly ripened from the seeds of the bodhisattva — all of them, in future lives and future times, will come to hear this precious sūtra, and having heard it, will make great offerings to it.

This is the second chapter, on generosity, from the precious Gathered Ornament of All Sūtras.

Having a domain vast and boundless and utterly subtle,
born from contemplation, supreme among persons who know,
with faculties transcended and become direct perception,
with attachment and with faculties entirely abandoned —
this is the manner of what is needed for the meditator
who contemplates contemplation through contemplation itself.
This is what abides in the hearts of all
who are skilled in yoga, the accomplished sages.

Free from the positions of existence and non-existence,
the side of the buddhas is without stain.

Parted from intellect and from the object of knowledge,
measure and faculties are left behind.

It is not the domain of mind and awareness —
that is the domain of those who are liberated.

Though all marks arise as appearance,
the Tathāgata is utterly without mark.

The proud he causes to be free of pride,
steadily composed and without taint,
neither moving nor unmoving.

Dwelling on the path of non-attachment —

gods who arise in divine realms,
gandharvas, asuras, kiṃnaras (half-human celestial beings),
and sages sitting in their assemblies
praise him, yet he remains forever unmoved.

In him there is no wonder, no craving.

Wherever among beings, there is no stirring.

Because he is the far shore of the yoga
that has from the very beginning been pure,

through the miraculous activity of the buddhas,
the gods see only the activity, as if by way of a display,
yet he is neither here nor there —
just as with the sun and moon, it is so.
He who abides in the domain of yoga
is seen by beings to make the proud free of pride.
Dwelling in distinct assemblies of different kinds,
to whichever person and by means of whatever faculty they are governed,
to them he teaches the Dharma in just that way.
Through the rays of light that generate yoga,
illuminating the qualities that are the subject-matter of yoga,
the three aspects of the way of the Victors,
the kings and their royal retinues,
the affairs of the royal domain,
the groves of austerity and the fields —
all excellence arises from this.
Divine substances, space,
and the pure source of precious things:
by the power of the god of gods,
in all directions and regions there is blazing.
Whatever means of the three elements,
of various kinds, that the skilled ones employ —
all those works that are undertaken
yield fruit effortlessly, like the buddhas.
This is ever the concern of those who hold the sūtra,
those who practice austerities, those who are learned,
those engaged in laughter and play,
and those who are dancers.
By the descent of Tuṣita, the worlds
behold it: women and those who walk with them,
those who seize and those who give, those in connection,
the crowned ones and those who hold the bow.
By the holy ones it is seen everywhere;
from the dense realm it does not depart.
This domain, by that Sage,
shines out most brilliantly in all directions.

Like a cataract upon one who has cataracts,
like a mirage to the deer,
just as worldly beings see an illusion
as something other than it is,
and just as in a dream what is dreamt
is seen by the dreamer as something other,
so too the special, elevated vision
is, for those yogins, like blindness.

This is the domain of the god of gods,
and at all times for that one's son,
Miguyin, Gulang, Brahmā,
Sananta and Sananda,
Sanatkumāra, the young ascetic,
Netso and the rest — even when contemplated,
their domain is thoroughly obscured.
By yogic practice these are not seen.

Whatever sages there have been, past and present,
and those who abide today —
none of these are to be found in this domain,
for they are veiled by the habitual tendencies of [false] views.

Upon the grounds, traversing stage after stage,
the vajra-essence is taught there.
In the dense realm made by the god of gods,
those who are present in it
are shown this vajra-essence
in meditative equipoise, with great thoroughness.

The domain of practice for those who have yoga —
however one may arrive at it —
shapes, colors, and distinguishing features,
those things fashioned by a craftsman's craft:
whether aggregated or atomic,
the examined entity does not exist.
Arising is nothing more than phenomena,
and ceasing too is nothing more than phenomena.
Through the identification of the utterly subtle,
qualities are examined as actually existing entities.

Like a lamp that illuminates,
causes accomplish the required purposes,
yet defining marks are not found from the beginning,
and through separation from destruction, nothing abides.

As for what has passed, even as a past entity
it does not exist, nor does it arise.

Without what is to be taken as a condition,
there is no examined entity whatsoever.

Although the conditions are assembled,
no entity is present in them.

Whatever becomes the condition for conditions —
the entity of existence and non-existence does not appear.

Nor does non-existence appear as appearance.

This is examined through the identification of the subtle.

The aggregates are like clay pots, like cloth and the rest;
like a mirage for a thirst-tormented deer,
like a dream, like a city of scent-eaters (gandharvas).

A flawed learned discourse, together with poison —
through three hundred views in it,
with entries and withdrawals and a transcendence of sorrow:
nothing of this exists.

Then the lord of the earth, who teaches in accordance with the true nature of the complete arrangement of all buddha qualities, whose garland of hands is immeasurable, whose body is incomparable, who is fully adorned with armlets, crown, crest-jewel, and long nails, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and addressed the following words to the lord of the vajra-essence, the great yogin of great yoga who, with the three vehicles and the world in harmony, abides in happiness within the domain of practice known through one's own noble wisdom in the Dharma of views, who teaches without contradiction all boundaries between ground and ground, and who is the master of yoga:

"Lord of the vajra, you who in all births, in all royal retinues, teach the Dharma to the crowned ones — therefore, O son of the Victor, I make this request to you: reveal to me the abiding place of practice that is noble abiding in the Dharma of views, abiding in happiness within the domain of practice known through one's own noble wisdom, acting without dependence on another. By

this, may I and these crowned ones, through diligent effort, fully attain the happiness of the gateway to the ground of the buddhas as a domain directly manifest before us, exercising mastery over the ten forms of the wish-fulfilling body, together with powers, higher knowledges, and"

miraculous powers (siddhi). The bases of miraculous powers become the abode of the palace of sovereignty beyond measure. Abandoning abiding at the extreme of reality as it truly is, one takes on a nature of manifold bodies resembling a wish-fulfilling jewel, and for the entirety of the royal retinue and those who dwell densely in the dense, one will teach manifold Dharma.

Vajrahṛdaya then spoke:

O King, speak! Excellent, excellent!

To the crowned ones, in a most special way,
entering the Dharma free of self —
ornament of the dense, supremely revealed.

If it is said that the defining marks of mind's intrinsic nature
are the domain of conceptual thought,
conceptual thought turns away from its object.
Seeing beings' conceptual thought,
and seeing, moreover, the intrinsic nature of beings,
one will come to rest in meditative absorption.
Teach the essential nature of phenomena.

O King, hear this from me:

Just like the spring mirage,
that appearance of it — these beings —
from the basis of characteristics, from characteristics, from causes,
conceptual thought does not conceptually think.
Through understanding and cognized object generated together,
that which is the distinctive feature of what is to be cognized,
there being not one thing that is its antidote,
it abides like the sun and its shadow.
Even mere mindlessness does not exist.
Neither measure nor measurer nor both exist.
Conceptual thought is mere mind.
Conceptual thought does not conceptually examine.
Cognition and cognized object are conceptual thought.
If mere mind is thus,

then regarding the cognized object being mere mind,
there is no cognition that always remains at mere.
Mind is the essential nature of phenomena.
Persons and those that are wavering —
when mind is conceptually examined,
they are abandoned through thought and through what is thought.

Upon finding the eighth, one becomes pure.
At the ninth, meditative concentration is the domain.
At the tenth, buddha after buddha
confers empowerment, and one becomes victorious.
In the domain of the Victors, phenomena too
become the inexhaustible dharmakāya.
Like the exhaustion of the sky,
mind and consciousness are likewise:
neither fearful,
permanent, peaceful, joyful, and stable.
It is the unconditioned primordial wisdom,
supremely beautiful in the dense field.
Consciousness has passed beyond the three risings,
like a jewel of many-colored forms.
Likewise, the buddhas' grounds are beyond conception,
dense, having become the abode of the Victor.

Just as the cause of clay vessels
is revealed by the breaking of an earthen pot,
the vessels too are of particles,
and the particles likewise of the subtlest —
just as causes appear among the conditions
of existing things,
so too the cause of undefiled phenomena
is likewise the defiled.

Just as fire arises from wood
and afterward burns elsewhere,
so the fire of arisen primordial wisdom
shall afterward burn elsewhere.
Transferred from the body of its abode,
freed from mind and conceptual thought,

the taste of attachment-free primordial wisdom
is supremely beautiful in the midst of the dense.
Without arising, form in manifold aspects,
not abiding on any ground —
take refuge in selflessness,
which exhausts all views.

For the streams of the continuum are cut,
there being no destruction and no arising —
take refuge in selflessness,
which exhausts all views.

Having become still, peaceful, not made still,
through peace, peace is suchness itself —
for all views are fully purified,
take refuge in selflessness.

The grounds made manifold —
through selflessness in selflessness,
struck by the hammer of impermanence
and by the arrow that fully reveals,
like fire that burns and chars,
self itself becomes still in suchness itself.
Likewise, examined by view,
the selfless one dwells firmly in meditative concentration,
happily abiding in the Dharma of views,
in the domain of individually self-knowing awareness,
without fault or defilement from beginningless time,
abiding on the ground of the noble ones.

Noble abiding, abandoned by worldly beings —
abiding in the transcendent noble state,
utterly arisen beyond the ground of mind,
resplendent at the heart of the dense array —
the lords who are without self, without self,
who have spoken again and again of all things:
the vajra essence is refuge and protector.
To that, O friends, let us go for refuge.

The buddha is neither existent nor nonexistent.
Having utterly burned the fuel of the aggregates,
having vanquished Māra together with his hosts,
one abides on the ground of the Dense Array, the buddha.
Go for refuge, O friends,
to what is known, stainless, and peaceful,
free from conceptual thought and from the measure of inference,
not the domain of intellect and its objects —
the yogi who dwells at the heart of the Dense Array.
That one too, O friends, is protector and refuge.

The field of all yogis,
the supreme field, the good and dense —
the Dense Array, filled with yogis:
go to that for refuge.

Free from all conceptual elaboration,
having thoroughly abandoned the faults of views,
the sages look upon beings
as a drawn line, as something conjured in a dream,
as a woman fair in a dream,
as a city of gandharvas moving through,
as hair-locks circling around a spindle,
as the thirst of a desert deer for a mirage —
having abandoned existence and non-existence.

Like the diverse forms of an illusory body,
like magical emanations and apparitions,
they are seen when engaging with the world.
On ground after ground, the sages
take on countless forms without remainder,
like the fruit of an illusory tree,
and the sage sees the yogi
as clouds, smoke, and lightning.

Like the craft of pottery and the rest,
the conceptual thoughts of self among beings arise.
Mentation, the consciousness of mentation,
the essential natures of the five phenomena,
and the activity of engaged consciousness —

these are adorned with selflessness and non-duality,
arising from the habituation of beginningless habitual tendencies
in the mind's state of taking on existence.

Like the waves of the ocean,
they abide on the ground of the all-base consciousness (ālayavijñāna).
When the wind sets the ocean
moving back and forth upon itself,
the waves are not destroyed,
nor does the ocean itself cease to be.

Those whose habitual tendencies have been in place since before any
beginning,
inclining toward the domain of engagement —
the engagement of the eight minds (citta)
is not separately distinct;
sometimes they arise all at once,
and sometimes they arise in sequence.

The mind's engagement from time without beginning
with the maṇḍala of stars and planets,
with leaves, flowers, and fruits,
with mountains, settlements, and forests —
understand that this is always simultaneous
and yet also sequential.

What was an object before was not genuine;
it is seen while lying in bed.

The engagement of the body, too, is sequential,
arising in dependence on the vital force.

With substances, numbers, and phenomena,
arising distinctly takes place in sequence,
but with gruel, preparations, and food,
passing through them is not distinct and sequential.

With tastes and with forms of smell,
arising distinctly occurs in sequence;
and yet with sequential distinctions of color and variety,
it is also simultaneous.

The royal mind is inconceivable —
always luminous by its own nature.
It is the tathāgatagarbha (buddha-nature),
abiding like gold within stones.

Mentation arises from the ground of all.
The consciousness of mentation is the same.
The six consciousnesses, with their manifold aspects,
differentiate the stages of the ground.
Together with habitual tendencies and mind,
the all-base, the ground of all seeds —
through that which is always luminous by nature,
the utterly purified and afflicted —
in this way the lineage of the Tathāgata
is virtue, both determinate and indeterminate.

Its arising, ever present as if abiding,
like the waves of the great ocean,
pervades by way of the all-base consciousness
in lower, middling, and higher degrees.
On ground after ground it is purified,
becomes otherwise and splendid,
and reveals things as they truly and authentically are.

And Vajrahṛdaya spoke again:

Now that you have seen, heard, and understood,
you yourself, O master of the great ground —
teach it to those with the courage to hear.
Especially, O self of distinction —
when the elements of the minor elements,
the wheels that wheel upon the grounds,
and the all-base consciousness are thoroughly purified,
one becomes a king of the earth.
One also becomes a wheel-turner
who rules over Jambudvīpa.

In Tuṣṭita and the other immeasurable mansions
one becomes the lord of the highest tier.
As lord in the abode of lords,
so likewise as sovereign in the place of sovereignty.

One becomes the lord of lords in the desire realm;
likewise one becomes master of the form realm.
And the sentient beings of the formless realm,
who are without perception —
these too ripen as the fruit of the bliss of meditative concentration.

Without grasping at manifest realization of the real,
without having touched the ultimate limit,
one roars the fearless lion's roar,
fully possessed of joy and primordial wisdom,
satisfied by the bliss of the sovereignty of meditative concentration —
that one is destined for the dense realm.

Having settled into equanimity without attachment,
through the faults of conduct in the three realms,
and having entered the dense realm by stages,
one fully awakens as a perfectly purified buddha,
becomes master of Dharma as its sovereign,
and is happy, having passed beyond dependence.
With qualities that are permanent, stable, and peaceful,
in the midst of the dense realm with one's sons,
splendid as the master of the Dharma,
indestructible, the highest of humans —
nirvāṇa is not destruction.

While those seated in corners whisper it about quietly,
through the actions of the ten kings of the highest, the lowest, and the middle,
it takes form as the three vehicles.

Moreover, the distinction of those who seek the dense realm:
the true king will take birth
by dwelling on ground after ground.

If that were to be destroyed, conditioned things would become a fault,
and it would be likewise for those who die.

The king is not one whose destruction is final.

If the gnosis body (jñānakāya) of the Tathāgata —
the very thing that makes sentient beings exhausted and gone —
if that nirvāṇa were to be destroyed,
then the prior limit too would be destroyed,

and the arising of sentient beings would cease.
If the realms of sentient beings were exhausted,
there would be no object of knowledge for the wisdom of the Victors,
no passing beyond sorrow, no object of knowledge,
and buddhahood itself would not exist.

By the analogies of the lamp consumed by fire
and the seed burned to ash,
those skilled in liberation through conceptual means
teach liberation to embodied beings.
Yet through the liberations of existence and non-existence,
those very ones are far from the bliss of liberation.
All who abide in meditative concentration —
their engagement and withdrawal according to method,
the formless, the perception-free,
the five superknowledges, sovereignties, powers,
the undiminished and the unimpaired,
and those skilled in the marks of phenomena,
those skilled in the elements of the grounds —
go toward the dense realm as lords among humans.

Through the destruction of existence and non-existence,
they do not emerge from the cycle.
The three contacts are indestructible,
together with causes, the conditions of objects,
the immediately preceding condition, and also sovereignty.
The grounds are selfless and external.

Taking eye and form as causes,
those who, through contact, come to engage —
the wisdom that manifests form-objects,
and all of those, will be dissolved.

The outer and inner grounds
arise through each other's power.
When, having been freed from the views of existence and non-existence,
one is dissolved —
because one is freed from mind and from object,
one does not abide through discernment of objects;
conceptual thought before one is gone,

and its intrinsic nature does not abide.

When object is abandoned,
conceptual thought does not abide;
when one is fully liberated from the two,
and conceptual thought is relinquished through non-conceptuality —
at that moment the mind rests in meditative equipoise,
and beings are seen without conceptual thought.
Without apprehended and apprehender,
one abides in inconceivable wisdom.
Having transformed from dependence,
wisdom has relinquished its inferior appropriation.

The ten aspects, wish-fulfilling,
adorned with varied forms,
excel as king over the three grounds,
and the king goes out fully into the dense realm.

Form, mind, and what arises from mind,
the non-associated, and the unconditioned —
the inner and outer grounds distinctly,
fully seen in their differentiation —
skilled in one's own individual gnosis,
one abides in the phenomena of the view.
The king who enters the dense realm
is the yogin skilled in wisdom.

Sign, name, and suchness,
conceptual thought and gnosis,
abiding in the limit of perfect reality —
these become the domain of individual self-knowing.
Kings and princes of kings,
yogins of yogic mind,
going into the dense realm as king —
this is in the field praised by the buddhas.

Abandoning the three contacts and conditions,
when one has surpassed one's own side,
ruin through falling away from one's side
goes together with the conceptually minded.

With the unestablished and with analogy,
the king becomes thoroughly contradictory.
Conceptual thought and the flaw of fault —
these become fivefold in their aspect.

Refuting the three contacts,
like a bee consuming its store —
so too does one who speaks of wrong conceptuality
lay waste to the world.

There are five faults in that:
for one whose eye is tainted by conceptual thought,
the quality of likeness bears the defect of unlikeness;
error and the absence of its reversal;
the mind's falling away from its own side;
and dependence on the opposing side.

The arising of those views
is what destroys the first extreme.

The prior limit of sentient beings —
O king, there is none.

Running through and through, through the rounds of saṃsāra,
they stream through the elements in confusion.

Along that stream and its continuum,
by the power of compassion the Victor goes forth.
With rays of light from emanations, with divine substances,
moving and turning like the moon.
In accordance with prior karma,
the fatherly protector teaches the phenomena.

To those sunken in continuum after continuum,
even Dharma is not taught;
for if nirvāṇa were to destroy that,
what quality would the Victor have gained?

The three masteries,
liberation and the seeing of truth,
the four bases of miraculous power,
the four foundations of mindfulness, emptiness,
the four correct knowledges of differentiation,

prophetic disclosures in response to inquiry,
object of focus and its immediate arising,
cause and faculty likewise —
the formless and conduct,
together with the faculties and powers,
higher knowledge and the faithful,
consciousness and its causes,
conditioned and unconditioned phenomena,
the limbs of awakening, persons,
liberation and the eight types of individual,
the grounds, purity and knowledge,
the sense bases that overpoweringly suppress,
and the ten of gnosis made manifest —
knowledge of the nature of reality of suffering,
individual discernment of suffering,
consequent knowledge of suffering itself;
knowledge of the phenomena of conditioned things,
conceptual thinking about conditioned things,
knowledge of consequent engagement with conditioned things;
knowledge of phenomena with respect to cessation,
conceptual thinking with respect to cessation,
knowledge of consequent engagement with cessation;
knowledge of the phenomena of the path,
individual discernment of the path,
knowledge of consequent engagement with the path —
these knowledges, and the ten trainings:
the eight of the many — seven lifetimes,
and from family to family, one return;
the one intervening individual,
one who passes into nirvāṇa in the intermediate state,
one who passes into nirvāṇa in another birth,
one without striving,
and likewise those of the higher continuum —
all of these, O king,
are declared to be the domain of gnosis.
Varied domains belong to the yogin:
the last, the supreme, and the intermediate.

It is on this that the bodhisattva, being distinguished,
together with the supreme, meditates.
The pratyekabuddha is the middling;
the śrāvaka is the last.

The eleventh and the twelfth —
in the fifteen of fives and threes —
yogins bring about the cessation
of the aggregates of mind in the extreme degree.
Whatever has passed — that has ceased.

Mind is by nature luminous.
Whatever is a defilement — that is not mind.
Nor does anything abide together with mind.
The future has not yet arrived;
the present, as it arises, does not abide.
Mind, being without conditions,
does not arise here or elsewhere.
In the four meditative concentrations, mind is absent —
there is no harm to the cause of arising.
The cause of arising is consciousness:
mentation and the five consciousnesses.
Not knowing their own conceptual elaboration,
they arise like waves on water.
Free from examination and conceptual thought,
this is the ground of all the Sages.

From existence and non-existence, as a divine substance,
it transforms into another without being destroyed.
In the dense and in the heart of the dense,
it is supremely beautiful like the moon.
There it abides, indestructible and at ease.
In the heart of the dense, together with the sons,
knowing the defining marks without differentiation,
gnosis becomes of one taste.
Immeasurable — the domain of the yogin —
the king moves about like the moon.
This splendor of the king,
borne by the yogin, belongs to the Sages.

Therefore, forever, for the sake of that king,
may your own mind become yoga.

Over the six modes of the desire abodes,
the twelve of the brahma gods,
and the sentient beings of the formless, the non-perceptual —
O king, become sovereign over these.

You shall also attain what is desired in the dense,
for the sake of aspiring to the dense of the Good.

If the king's ten gnoses
are cultivated, he will proceed to the dense.

Knowledge that follows along with phenomena,
knowledge of others' minds and of conventional reality,
knowledge that assembles suffering,
knowledge born of cessation and the path,
knowledge of purification and of non-arising,
and likewise the cultivation of profound craft —
the royal lineage of Śākunta,
the lineage of Ikṣvāku and Soma:
the supreme king who teaches the authentic meaning —
your lineage is supremely distinguished.
Born into that lineage,
proceed to the dense without hesitation.

The yogin who abides in the Dharma of view
dwells in a stainless state,
breathing like a hollow reed,
moving like a sheep,
going and coming with half the body
like a young deer —
in all this the body is mind,
abiding like the deer of an illusion,
appearing vividly like an illusory tree,
like fire within a river.
Brow, eyes, and limbs —
playing with them, sport like a king.

Mind, mental factors, and mentation,
and the phenomena of mind-consciousness:
all these phenomena are without substantiality,
arising in the manner of clouds.
The ground of all, with all its seeds,
is thoroughly wound about by habitual tendencies —
like varied form-jewels,
and like rainbows and lightning just as they are:
the domain of the body for embodied beings
appears in form of such a kind.

Like the lotus of the water-lily,
like the king of immaculate geese —
of a brilliance that is beyond doubt,
it abides like the emanation of a buddha.
From the power of signs, names arise;
signs arise from conditions.
Signs are bound up with names,
and they too are thoroughly conceptualized by conditions.
From the aspect and shape of signs,
conceptual thought arises in great abundance.
The causes that generate conceptual thought
are declared to be twofold:
external signs and minds,
and likewise habitual tendency and mentation —
that which is endowed with mind
abides in the interior.

That which is endowed with mentation and the sense faculties
is the cause of the five consciousnesses.
Constantly, through perfect gnosis,
it surveys the causes of the world.
Thus there is no agent and no action.
This suchness is not otherwise.
The suchness of all phenomena
arises through the mutual force of one another.
Yogins behold it thus
and see it clearly as suchness.

The thoroughly established intrinsic nature —
that is the nature of reality of all phenomena.
All phenomena in the intrinsic nature of an imputed thing
are unborn,
empty, without essential nature.

Abandoning the extremes of existence and non-existence,
they are like illusions and dreams,
like the city of the gandharvas (scent-eaters),
like clusters of hair and mirages,
like thick billowing smoke.

Through signs, conventional marks, and shapes,
and through the many words and syllables
by which names are applied to things,
and through the many names themselves —
this is the nature of what is imputed.

The dependent nature is other than that.
From the convergence of mind, objects, and sense faculties,
along with all seeds and habitual tendencies,
arising together with mind as not truly separate —
all consciousnesses arise.

The nature of the dependent, too,
arises from causes through the mutual force of one another.

Self-cognizing awareness, exceedingly subtle,
abides in the domain of what is seen as phenomena.
This thoroughly established intrinsic nature
is the sphere of activity of the noble ones.

Because the buddhas and the bodhisattvas
have penetrated the noble intrinsic nature to the core,
and because they behold the thoroughly established nature
as the ultimate boundary of reality,
it is proclaimed: "Birth is exhausted."
The Brahmā path, too, has been transcended.

"What has been done has been endured; there is nothing further to do.
Henceforth, no more arising" —
thus fully released from all suffering,

all agitation has utterly subsided.
Since every last habitual tendency has been burned away,
conceptual thought no longer arises.

Seeing selflessness in the most profound way
is proclaimed with respect to phenomena and persons.
Since they are free of seeds,
the host of mental factors does not engage.

Having completely cleared away all the conceptual elaboration
of mentation's habitual grasping, accumulated since beginningless time,
nirvāṇa is like iron that has been smelted.
Just as iron, thoroughly smelted,
becomes cool and yet is not destroyed,
so too all liberation
is a cooling, like fire that has gone out.

In the central maṇḍala of dense gathering,
within the undefiled dharmadhātu,
the Victors and the bodhisattvas together
dwell sustained by the nourishment of meditative absorption,
remaining in equipoise and continuing to abide in equipoise,
resting in ease within the domain of what is seen.

O king, this is the domain of the yogin.
Undertake this yoga.
This is the virtuous abode of the sons and daughters of the Victor.
If you wish to travel to the dense gathering,
that supreme realm where all buddhas dwell
is precisely the dense one.
Therefore, O king, apply yourself to virtue,
and perform virtuous acts for other kings as well.

Names arise through the power of signs.
Signs arise from conditions.
From signs, conceptual thought arises.
Apart from the thoroughly established,
the domain of the senses — pottery and the rest —
and aggregates endowed with qualities:
these signs of conceptual thought

are the cause of birth.

Conceptual thought is what makes distinctions
and also turns a locus into something known to consciousness.
From going, not-going, and the beings who go,
delusion arises abundantly.

Long and short, color,
rough and smooth,
the domain of sound, smell, and the like,
sweet, pungent, and hot;
the domain of mental consciousness —
all the virtuous and non-virtuous,
conditioned phenomena and unconditioned phenomena,
nirvāṇa, the domain of gnosis —
these arise moment by moment,
arising and ceasing again in turn.
They move with extreme swiftness.

Consciousness arises from causes.
Connected intimately with mentation and the all-base consciousness,
it churns around like a spindle.
As a two-headed snake behaves,
so too does mentation:
it stirs the all-base consciousness
and yet, as one, it arises distinctly.
Along with mental consciousness,
having served the purpose of causes, it turns back,
and it very much enacts the purpose of self,
and causes the notion of "mine" to proliferate.
It generates warmth in the body
and acts variously throughout.

It engages with food, drink, enjoyment,
clothing, incense, and other pleasures,
with acts of offering and of running about —
it is that which holds the human body.
With dance, laughter, and play,

Mentation, too, is ever active:
it enters into all conceptual thought —
into the whirling of a gathered mass of hair,
into the cities of the gandharvas (celestial beings who feed on fragrance),
into dreams, and likewise into mirages.

A mind that swirls in every downward flow,
because self and mind are not grasped inwardly,
it dwells in bodies and in vessels
like a hollow reed or a strip of cloth.

Weak and without substance,
its conceptual thought is without ground;
it moves about in objects imputed by the self,
and abides, upon being seen, like a reflection.

The seeds of royal consciousness
stir as objects of the view
and intoxicate the host of those who grasp at things —
a master of the ground who is no noble one.

The entry of the three — the royal consciousness and its companions — has
been fully revealed.

The true intrinsic nature is that which is accomplished through being free of all
of these.

Myriads upon myriads, however many there may be,
are seen by the power of holding momentum,
and even by the noble Maudgalyāyana
those forms and those great and beautiful bodies —
these surpass even those
in the dense pure land, O lord of the ground.

Whatever is beautiful in all those fields —
none of those is a fitting comparison.
In lands of bliss, delight, and joy,
and the realms below, by the billions,
the buddhas dwelling in each and every one of them —
to the Dense One those are offered in praise.

That which is called Dense has no beginning at the fore;
it is the self-arisen magical display.
It dwells in the buddha-ground without defilement,

transcending the three elements.

It has no appropriation of pleasure;
it is free from what is practiced as "you" and "I";
it is utterly and supremely permanent,
stable and dense — unconditioned.

In true perfect buddha-awakening,
in the supreme abode of Akaniṣṭha,
the buddhas who have not yet become buddhas in the desire realm
do not perform buddha-deeds there.

But having gone to the dense pure land,
with billions of buddha-emanations
they are ever established in yogic equanimity,
enjoying sport together with those emanations.

Like a moon in every land,
to whatever being, by whatever means influence comes —
in that being, in that manner it arises.

And through miraculous emanations as well,

the supreme sūtra of the ten grounds,
the Gaṇḍavyūha and the sūtra of tree-display,
the sūtra of various manifestations,
the Śrīmālādevī and the various sūtras on Vairocana,
the journey from the glory of illusion, and so forth —
sūtras of various kinds
arose and issued from the Dense Ornament.

This sūtra of the Dense Ornament
surpasses all sūtras.

O king, you and all the kings
should attend to this with reverence and ceremony.
Transcending the formless, the realm of desire, and form,
and likewise the sphere without perception —
the sovereign of buddhas, transcending those very abodes,
dwells in the maṇḍala of the Dense One.

In the palace like a lotus,
within the many forms of varied aspect,
there is wisdom — the marvel of divine substance —

and through the purity of the Tathāgata,
the Blessed One dwells there together with the yogins who are fully liberated.
Dwelling in the center of the Dense One, he enters meditative concentration.
In the four supreme buddha-grounds he is present, holding form —
a master of yoga, in that very mode,
whose limit is unseen.

The sage, a master of yoga in forms and in sense-objects,
abides in the various aspects of form within the center of the Dense One
and reveals all to those who possess yoga.

The sky, gold, moonlight, the campaka flower, the neck of a peacock, a lotus
—
the form of the god above all gods dwelling on that ground is beautifully
adorned.

Wearing the armor of the divine sovereign of forms, gleaming like lightning,
fire, and coral-light,
some behold him resting on a bed of fine wool, robes, leaves, and grass and
such.

Possessed of a form blazing brilliantly like a thousand suns,
some among the capable, the lords of yoga, behold him seated on a single
lotus flower in the center of the Dense One.

The uṣṇīṣa (cranial protrusion) of the Sage, with its assembled mass, is like
releasing the crown of one who walks by hand. For some, the form is adorned
with a crown ornamented with a helmet of vajra and aṇḍa-stones. Some
among them behold the Sage adorned with a wheel, designs, a fish, and a
conch. Some behold the Sage as one beholds a rainbow arc in the path of the
sky-traveler. Bearing divine treasures in hands with webbed fingers,
encompassing manifold domains, with Mount Meru resting upon his palm, the
Sage makes the three realms — the abodes of sea-monsters, the abodes of
waters, and likewise the hoofprints of cattle — to fit within them. Through the
force of his generosity, he is supremely venerated by the crowns and diadems
of human lords. Some, in the courts of kings and royal retinues, become skilled
in what is needed, and appear to cut through with decisiveness. In the center
of the Dense One, one appears otherwise — a luminous manifestation: this is
for those who practice the wisdom of the Sage, who are masters of yoga, who
perfectly accomplish the yoga. Yoga reveals those domains that were spoken
by the former Victors. For some, grounds and views, minds and intellects, are

utterly transformed; and they come to possess diverse empowerments and wisdoms, meditative absorptions, and the wish-fulfilling body. For some, free from attachment to objects, acting in the domain of awareness-intelligence, cutting through the activities of mind — since there is neither this nor other, neither burning nor arising, since there is nothing to be spoken, it is nirvāṇa. Just as fire in this world utterly passes beyond sorrow when there is no fuel and no radiance remains, so it is. For some, it is in the realm of making offerings, presenting clouds of perfection-offerings, and giving in worship. There, the generosity, the veneration, and the conduct of the Sage are beheld in their proper form most excellently.

In that supreme field called "Possessing Bliss," those beings who are present there are not born from a womb; they are possessed of maṇḍalas of light blazing in bliss. Bearing bodies blazing like divine gold and like the moon, lords of yoga — those divine treasures of fair light, and whatever is within, are the domain of the faculties of masters of yoga. One hundredfold, the lords of yoga cannot match that bliss. Otherwise, the fires of that field of enjoyment that we ourselves have set out — in the Blissful with Boundless Light, the sons of the Victor are surrounded by halos of divine radiance. True yoga, the aspiration-realm of the Sage's sovereignty, tasting the nectar of dhyāna, the supreme in the flock — forests of purified branches of various and manifold precious jewels, a supreme field assembled from the realm of divine refined gold — it is supremely beautiful. Adorned supremely with gold and various precious jewels and lotus flowers, this is the treasure of a buddha-field, without equal; from all of it the lotus-born arise, never perishing. Devoted to that Sage, skilled in meditative concentration, deeply aspiring to the buddhas — those who have been set on the path by my Teacher are born from pure lotuses with minds full of aspiration. Humans abiding in that supreme buddha-field are fully adorned with excellent major marks, and with excellent minor marks, their bodies blaze in wonder, accompanied by glorious calves. Free from conceptual thought discriminating existence and non-existence, they are immaculate and pure.

Having thus fully revealed all these things, the Vajra, supreme in the flock, became the size of a thumb. He likewise became as the form of a hundredth part of the tip of a strand of an extremely fine and subtle fiber-dust hair. For some he appeared as the form of a Sugata, a pratyekabuddha, a śrāvaka, and various other forms as well — whatever forms of mind's conduct there are, such are the distinctive forms. The one called Vajra, a master of yoga,

relinquished the domains of immeasurable forms.

Having said these words, he spoke again:

The sons of the Victor, possessing various forms,
the grounds likewise, and the faculties,
undiminished direct knowledge,
meditative absorption like an illusion,
and likewise the wish-fulfilling body —
dhāraṇī and the feet of miraculous power,
and the diverse liberations — truly knowing,
powers and fearlessnesses,
and aggregates and elements undefiled:
these, having been transformed into something other, are attained.
These are also the grounds of the eternal buddha.

Having thoroughly understood the intrinsic nature of the five dharmas and the eight consciousnesses, and the two kinds of selflessness, transformation into something other comes about.

The ten wish-fulfilling bodies, adorned by one who moves with the courage of an illusion, and the ten inexhaustible aspirations — these are thoroughly manifested by the aspects of the path.

Seen as a dream, as a mirror's reflection, or as the moon in water — those who have mastery over the path of yoga, who have entered the grounds of the buddhas, and who dwell on the lotus seat of the Victor, are placed before them by the sons of the Victor.

Free from the extremes of existence and nonexistence, those multitudes that atomically dissolve — the king accomplished like a gandharva's achievement, and the hosts assembled in the divine abodes — who walk upon the surface of Mount Meru and enjoy pleasures even from the midst of the sky: just as these do not appear as they seem, so too the cherished sons of the Victor are not seen by those who lack yoga.

Possessed of manifold forms, in billions of grounds and pure realms, those who are devoted to honoring the Victor and who abide in the power of aspiration are born in lotus mansions.

With mastery, concentration, and intent, they pass into nirvāṇa from pure land to pure land, revealing birth from meditative absorption. Spontaneously accomplished everywhere, like the moon rising from the water,

undifferentiated as the sun, appearing as the domain of sentient beings, without touching the ultimate limit, they thoroughly turn back into meditative absorption.

Like bees resting on a boat crossing the vast ocean — wherever the boat goes, they too travel, however many leagues it may be — so too, through compassion, beholding bodies diminished by afflictions and oppressed by suffering, the Victors and their sons reveal the arising of those conditions.

Also, one who has turned back and is without self — omnisciently knowing even destruction — does not remain at the moment of exhaustion. Those hurled by apprehended and apprehender, those engaged in apprehended and apprehender: because they are produced by apprehended and apprehender, they have no ground for characteristics and no defining marks. Those carried along by the stream of saṃsāra are born again and again in the fields. Like monkeys grasping one another in a boundless oceanic treasury, the activity is seen by those dwelling on the boat. With no basis or support for the grasping — in just this way, the Victor and the sons of the Victor, seeing those whose conceptual thoughts and suffering are stirred up by craving, and afflictions that abide, arising from the grounds — renunciation comes forth, and turning back, and giving and offerings also arise.

Practice in manifold ways the Dharma of such a one who possesses yoga.

Here ends the second section of the noble Ghanavyūha Sūtra (the Dense Array).

Samantabhadra, sovereign of humanity, of great splendor and manifold forms — the great bodhisattva spoke to Vajragarbha:

Those who have power over harmonious ones, and others assembled in divine abodes, and in various jeweled mansions — whatever sons of the Victor who possess yoga and are within the maṇḍala of the Dense Array, those who have heard the name "Dense" and upon hearing it apply themselves diligently, who incline toward transformation, who have heard the manner of transformation, and who have entered into the nature of that samādhi — they go swiftly, without obstacle, for a long time within the Dense. Devoted to going truly to the buddhas, taking hold of beings and grasping their momentum — Mañjuśrī with his manifestations, the great-powered noble Lokeśvara (Avalokiteśvara, lord of the world), the lord of dhāraṇīs beginning with Moonlight, Superbly Tranquil Intellect, the knower of Vajra Yoga of the navel, Druma the lord of space, Vajrapāṇi of great mind, those with yoga and the sons of the Victor —

whoever came from billions of pure realms to hear the Dharma, those who are devoted to the Ghanavyūha Sūtra, and who, having seen future Victors, feel from within compassion and tender care: the chief of the sense faculties endowed with yoga, thoroughly spoke to those of manifold forms, and questioned the chief of those with yoga.

Regarding Fearless Vajra Essence,
the questioner spoke to the one of manifold forms:
"How was it that diverse jeweled mansions
and fine mansions of lordly power were made so manifold?
Tell us, you of manifold forms.

All the manifold variety of things,
and the manifest arising of beings as well —
clay vessels and similar material things:
just as from kneading wet clay
all useful implements are fashioned,
so too were these beings made.
Drums and lutes and sounds and the like
produce melody by being set in motion —
so likewise, is this world entirely
arisen from the action of movement?

Do all three intrinsic natures
abide together in a single thing?
Are all the grounds thus thoroughly present
in what has substance and in what relates to substance?
And likewise, are all of these
thoroughly abiding in a single thing?

Since such ornaments appear in this way,
together with the moving and unmoving of the three realms,
were they made by Tuṣita, by the highest among the divine,
and by the lords of power?

Or were they made by the many vidyādhara
and by beings of brilliant splendor?

Were they made by Akaniṣṭha, the one with the tuft on his crown,
or by those of the formless realm?

Were they made by all the gods together,
gathering as one?

Were they made by miraculous emanations,
or crafted by the bull supreme among Victors?
Or perhaps the Victors and their bodhisattva sons,
dwelling in other pure realms,
or those adept in yoga who dwell
in buddha-fields — did they make all the grounds?

Whatever is thoroughly mistaken
appears like water in a mirage.
Just as qualities appear on the side of the mistaken,
so they abide on the side of beings —
qualities that are inseparable from qualities,
and that are without qualities yet rest in qualities:
since they are not, yet stand in mutual relation,
qualities abide there in their assembly.
So too with manifold mistakes —
do they similarly abide everywhere in that way?

The many forms of diverse beings
that appear on the grounds —
were they brought forth by Brahmā,
or by powerful great beings,
by the bull supreme among Victors, or by a kinsman,
by monastics or by oneself,
produced through causes of what is cherished,
or by intrinsic nature, or by the faculties,
produced by time and direction,
or perhaps by ignorance and craving?

The divine sages are uncertain,
and the hosts of gods likewise.
The lords of accomplished ones and gandharvas,
and the yogins who abide on the grounds —
are all of these a conjuration of the eye,
like the dwelling of a gandharva,
or a dream, or a mirage,
or unprecedented conceptual thought?
Do they abide, with respect to apprehended and apprehender as entities,
like a two-headed serpent?

Or does this intrinsic nature simply not exist?
Do they abide like a mechanical corpse set in motion,
or like a sickle going round and round,
or like a mass of hair?

They are not made by an agent and action,
not made by the lord Kubera,
not by the fruit of offerings, oblations, and sacrifice,
not by the path of mantra or of tradition.
Since causes are altogether too common,
persistent constancy is not the case,
yet beings are not without something to hold them.
The causes too have their causes in turn.

Beings are established by way of essential nature,
arising from the habitual tendencies of karma.
The person of the eighth consciousness,
called the all-base consciousness,
turns all this manifold variety
like a potter's wheel.

Just as sesame pressed yields sesame oil,
just as brine yields saltiness,
just as impermanence is present in form,
so too does this person abide.

Just as fragrance and other such qualities
are the character of qualities in their qualities,
like the rays of sun and moon —
so does this person abide.

Without purpose and without action,
abandoning the extremes of existence and non-existence,
without unity and without separation,
fully departing from the extreme of dwelling in a corner —
there is no subsequent-arising consciousness,
and at no time does conceptual thought occur."

The self-cognizing awareness of liberation,
born in the domain of a buddha — of the Capable One —
is free of the apprehended and the apprehender.

Without prior arising, through mind and mental factors,
it is free of the eight consciousnesses
and at no time does conceptual thought occur.

Abiding therein is like a wave on water:
the defining marks of each are not distinct from the other;
they arise and once again subside.
Being endowed with that is not awareness.

Just as the meditative absorption of the Capable One
and the miraculous feats of one possessed of such powers
are seen clearly through meditative equipoise —
not by other wandering yogins —
so too the consciousnesses that enter in this way
all dwell together with the all-base.
The yogin sees this always,
as does a buddha, as does a buddha's son.

By that one, all of these,
just like jewels filling a cavity,
strung upon a thread and like a wheel
turned round by the wind of karma —
just as the potter's wheel,
spun round by hand and by the slap of the palm,
revolves completely and fashions vessels
endowed with qualities of every kind —
so too the person of the eight consciousnesses,
together with the reflections of the elements,
constitutes the ground,
and beings who wander in the outer and inner worlds —
all these worlds abide within it,
dwelling there in manifold aspects
like a host of stars in the sky,
turned round by the horse of the wind.

Just as the tracks of birds in the sky
do not appear,
and although midair exists
there is no activity of birds in their passage,

so too the person of consciousness:
there is no self that exists, no other that exists.
Those that resemble pure open sky
arise abundantly, like waves.

Through the flaw of habitual tendency's character,
like the moon in a lotus unstained —
the lotus is not without water,
yet the water does not lack the moon's reflection,
and when water is gone the moon still exists,
and on the lotus petal, water likewise —
so too the young women seen by the eye
do not become what the eye perceives.

In the same way, the all-base consciousness
performs its actions all at once;
it pervades and dwells within the bodies of beings,
containing all seeds.

Like a dense cloud,
it rests most pervasively upon the grounds.
Life and consciousness saturate everything entirely,
and warmth likewise, with great force;
it manifests the varied forms
of those who possess bodies of diverse forms.
Just as the potter acts upon the vessel of earth,
it is exactly like that.

One sees the horn of a cow and the like,
but a donkey has no horn:
what has not been seen does not exist as absent.
That the cow has no horn
does not exist by being apprehended through inversion;
by being contemplated through inversion,
when the subtlest particle is dismantled,
those existents become non-existent.

Non-existence arises from the cause of existence;
the thought that non-existence exists
depends on existence not existing —

it arises from a cause of mutual dependence.

There is no cognition and no object of understanding;
comprehension that arises is without birth.

The wheel of the sickle is not a wheel,
just as one perceives a mass of hair.

Like the cities of gandharvas (celestial musicians)
and illusions — arising from whatever is seen —
arising in the mind without a cause,
conceptual thought does not truly exist.

The object of understanding is produced by conceptual thought.

From the mentation that arises in embodied beings,
through the association of names and perceptions
and through the habitual tendencies of the two natures,
the mind of a person comes forth abundantly.

The established real does not arise.

Accumulated since beginningless time,
arisen from the domain of appropriation,
through mentation saturated by proliferation,
the mental host comes into being.

As for the thing of the apprehended and the apprehender,
the mind of a person is perpetually arising.

The visible forms of clay and so forth —
there is no appearance of anything else.

All of these are mere cognition;
the thing that is the object of understanding does not exist.

As for cognition and the thing that is the object of understanding —

this is the very engagement of the self-nature —
something that childish ones do not rightly understand.

Those whose minds are intoxicated by habitual tendencies
will have the eight modes of consciousness and the seven
arising simultaneously.

Because of possessing unprecedented habitual tendencies,
the all-base consciousness contains all seeds.

Just as the waves of a great ocean,
stirred by the condition of wind,

dance and surge abundantly forth,
and the stream of it never ceases —
so too the light of the mind is ever constant,
impelled by objects and by contact,
and through the consciousness that imputes a manifold self,
it clings to what is self and what is mine.

Just as in earth there is no conceptuality,
yet earth takes on various forms of shape,
appearing in whatever form is needed —
so too it is with the all-base consciousness.

Just as a person, with their own hands,
strokes their own body,
and a bull elephant uses its own trunk
to spray water on its own body,
and just as certain powerful beings
apply remedies to their own bodies —
in the same way, the mind engages its investigated objects
in the manner of a twofold object.

This activity that serves as the domain of mind
pervades and dwells throughout the three realms.
Both the outer and inner activities
are seen by the skilled yogin.
All buddhas behold all of this.
Whatever appears on the earth —
forms of varied shapes and colors —
earth takes on those varied aspects.

When this Dharma is properly taught,
the Vajra Heart, the Fearless One,
delights in the things that mute beings delight in,
and the unmoving meditative concentration of the gods
in the inconceivable dharmadhātu —
having entered the domain of buddha-conduct,
and having come from the Dense Array,
the form of one who abides on the path of yoga,
the divine material body of that Sage —

the yogin, having relinquished it, remains there still.

Coming forth from the mass of darkness
of the dwelling-places of the desire realm, form realm,
formless realm, and the plane of non-perception,
from that Dense Array they came here.

Departing from the most excellent dwelling-place of the buddhas,
from the supreme buddha-field,
the buddha's body too emerged in the many aspects of form,
and performs miraculous transformations in the human realm,
benefiting whomever's mind wishes it.

Having departed from the name of Dense Array,
all the Victor's sons
looked upon one another
and spoke to one another.
The Dense Array is stainless merit
and destroys every evil.
It is the supreme dwelling of those who possess yoga,
the finest offering of the sacred buddha-field.

Having heard its name, we —
our minds overjoyed —
shall attain the firm path
of the dwelling of Dense Array, the home of yogins.

Akaniṣṭha, the realm with the crown-knot of Brahmā,
surpassed by the pure abode —
the wondrous spectacle of the field,
the father of the Victor's sons, the buddhas.

When Brahmā then made supplication,
the fearless ones of the pure abode,
all of them thinking:
"Shall we go, or not go, to the Dense Array of Brahmā?
Brahmā, possessor of great yoga,
has been obscured by darkness.
Not knowing the Sage or the sage's understanding,
how will he obtain that abode?"
Brahmā, ever thinking there,

"The foremost understanding among minds is Brahman;
the lords of the desire realm and the form realm
are not to be found there" —
the dwelling-places like sky-palaces,
and likewise the plane of non-perception,
where one sits silently, known to others —
yogins do not go there.

"Have I done some deed?
Did I form some thought, and come here again?
Shall I go — or to the firm, eternal,
permanent, unconditioned Dense Array?
Or perhaps the Sage himself,
the god above the gods, lord of yoga —
by his power, do those who know yoga
go to that palace of Dense Array?"
He pays homage to that Sage.

Having spoken these words, the one with the crown-knot,
blazing intensely in his vision,
addressed those who abide on the path of the buddhas:
"Speak, speak, you who are sages!
What do you require? What shall you do?"

The lord of buddhas then declared: "How is the Dense Array to be attained?
Turn back from this domain of form. Those who possess form cannot go there.
That Dense Array is the domain of the Great Sage, the buddha-field of the
unsurpassable, and it is not attained through perception. Likewise, those who
sit at the edge under the sway of the desire realm, known to others in that
place — they too cannot attain the Dense Array by the path of yogic
knowledge."

Brahmā heard that declaration. He stood before the one offering worship and
entreaties, and then he turned back from there and went once more to the
realm of Brahmā. For that reason, going there — since even Brahmā cannot
attain it — those of the formless, desire, and form realms who would go there
cannot arrive. Why was such faith found? Even the vision of the maṇḍala of
the Dense Array — the supreme abode of the yogin — therefore came to
inspire wonder. That abode of the Dense Array, the domain of the meditative

absorption of illusion, the supreme abode of the yogin: this was heard from one to another and, arising from that transmission, was described in manifold words.

Having heard these varied words, the sons of the Victors spoke: "You, the son of the Victor, who hold the vajra-essence of the Great Sage — speak of this. The sons of the Victors wish to hear. In the same way as the sovereign king, let your great magnificence be unimpeded. Those dwelling in Suśīma, in Tuṣita, in the pure abode free from fear — who is able to speak the teaching of the Sage without remainder? Apart from you and the buddhas, those who bear the power of the Great Sage — the domain of the buddhas is inconceivable. Who can teach the foremost sovereign of buddhas, the yoga and the absence of yoga, to anyone at all?"

Suśīma, Grasp-of-Force, and the sovereign sons of the Victor all spoke with a single voice: "Speak, speak, O son of the Victor! Vikurvita, Mañjuśrī, Maitreya, the lord of the kinnaras — and whatever other yogins there may be — let them speak and proclaim their words."

Then a voice arose from the sky, and gods and mantra-holders beat the drum loudly from there: "Speak, speak, O son of the Victor!"

While they were speaking thus, the crown-knotted Brahmā came, and speaking from among all those assembled upon the earth, he sat upon the supreme seat and said: "What is this wondrous divine matter? In the assembly of the sages, all the lords of yoga and those skilled disciples also wish to inquire of the supreme Sage. To the son of the Victor, the lord of the vajra, on this occasion — what is it, and to whom did the son of the Victor speak? To the son of Kuru and to Dilīpa, to those who wander in the cycle of the wheel to the farthest edge, or to Yovanaśvāla — is this speech about divine matters and human things? To the two, Ikṣvāku, or likewise to the possessor of a thousand bows, or to the guardian of the place, or to the others who revolve in the wheel — or in the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm, or to those dwelling in the sphere of no-perception, in the infinity of space, in consciousness, or in those who are somewhat less than that — to the great sages, to the pratyekabuddhas, to the śrāvakas, to the sons of the Victors, or to those who have entered the buddha-stages, the sovereign victors — is this that speech? Or is it for the asuras, the sons of the gods, or for one like a star? Whatever the case may be, you should declare it. We, your disciples, listen from all directions. Having heard the words of the master, all sons of the

Victors examine them carefully with one another."

Those whose samādhis come and go, the sons of the Victor who hear the words — they are revealed as coming from the crown-knotted one; those who wish to listen together with their disciples include the lord of the pure abode himself, Tāramati of inexhaustible wisdom, Gaganeśvara who holds beings, the mighty Avalokiteśvara, the knower of yoga who holds the dhāraṇī, the lord of yoga whose crown is a divine diadem —

Ratnamati at the crown, Śāntamati who holds the vajra, great Ratnamati who holds the jewel — these sons of the Victor and many others besides have come from fields beyond counting. Having all looked upon the one of wisdom at the Vajra Seat, those who are seated on lotus thrones offer supplication to the sons of the Victor: "Speak with great eloquence! The sons of the Victor wish to hear. Whatever words have arisen concerning the past, the future, and the present — made perfectly clear through causes and examples, those words that come from your mouth — even these unfailing words you have heard without remainder from the mouth of that Victor himself. The knowledge of the Tathāgatas is flawless. Now the king who wields sovereign power over meditative absorption, having surveyed everything with discerning wisdom, Vajragarbha the fearless has spoken these words to the yogin."

"No one is able to speak the entirety of a Victor's collected scriptures. Apart from his blessing, not even the buddhas and sons of the Victor could do so. Having paid homage to all buddhas, those who have been blessed by the buddhas and who dwell in exquisite abodes filled with palaces of various precious gems, adorned with sovereign beauty — they too should speak with faithful wisdom. This is the way of perpetuating the buddha lineage. Hear all of this from me."

"The auspicious wisdom of the Tathāgatas — this discourse is not for kings. Nor is it for even the most excellent lords of men who have passed away. This is the discourse of the buddha lineage, the domain of yoga for the yogin who dwells in the dense heart of its excellence. The splendor of all buddhas, the subtle wisdom of the Tathāgata — free of conceptuality, having abandoned conception, the domain of knowledge that is individually self-aware, utterly separated from expression — of that there is no confident speaking. Having heard of its power, I will set it forth through the divine-substance wisdom and the flower of meditative absorption. That which the perfectly enlightened Buddha has spoken — resting in meditative equipoise within the dense heart

— is utterly freed from all extremes, having abandoned the extremes of existence and non-existence, wholly parted from the sides of being and non-being. The Middle Way is indeed auspicious. The divine substance in its aspect of transformation leads one into the buddha grounds. That very Middle Way, the true path, is free of the four extremes — without conceptuality, without object of focus. One who abides in the dense heart sees it with perfect clarity. The great Sage himself knows this path. When those of wisdom in the gnosis of selflessness hear these words of the master, all the yogins together, joining their hands at the two feet, address the vajra thus."

"All yogins are striving to listen, like the thirsty who seek water, wishing to drink from your mouth. Like bees seeking the honey of words, O sovereign yogin, speak truly! Sons of the Victor, listen with great care. Yogins of yogic discernment, masters of wisdom with great powers, great rulers who are lords of fields, those who reflect upon the path of yoga — they listen to the words of the Sugata (the Well-Gone One, a buddha). What has come forth from your mouth, the various difficult sounds — those with fine marks who penetrate them to the heart, the one of right going with Brahmā, the special fame of the lords' meaning — these are extraordinary. The speech of the Sage of varied modes: since I am expert in the meaning of sound, I am therefore not eager to speak. Having abandoned the analyzing of objects through conceptual thought, having abandoned such things as forms in the sky, empty shadows, and their like — if even these seem wondrous, how much more so the word of the Tathāgata, the sage's command. Just as bird-tracks in the sky are exceedingly rare to behold, so the word of the Tathāgata, the sage's command — that cannot be shown. Let the one learned in the three levels of grounds demonstrate it fully through examples. But the suchness that is free of examples comes forth from the sage's own mouth. That teaching of his has no example whatsoever; to me it appears as though a dream."

Like the flickering of a cataract-dimmed eye, or the swarming of hair-strands floating in the visual field — just as an illusory city, or the wind that is exceedingly difficult to see, or a mirage — both forms of conceptual thought are thoroughly abandoned. And yet the yoga of the sage is manifold: the word of the sage is exactly like this. Therefore, speaking of it in the midst of yogins, I have no confidence. All of these are the wise — those whose minds know suchness. The domain of a buddha's conduct is inconceivable; therefore I have no confidence in speaking of it. And yet I shall speak, through the sage's yoga.

Hear from me today, O sons of the Victors: the sage's command, rich in the meaning of manifold words, is without example, transcending mind and mental factors entirely. Just as a bee, having drunk the nectar of a flower, leaves the remainder for others to drink — so the most excellent sages have drunk the very essence, and it is the portion they have left that I expound today. Even that cannot be taught by mind or word; it is the domain of the god of gods, and for the wise it causes virtue to increase.

Having taken the form of a human being, he who is named "buddha," bearing the marks — appearing to some as wearing a crown, and to others dwelling in immeasurable palaces, appearing in various beautiful forms to various beings on earth — dispels the pride of those who sit in the midst of the dense assembly. At all the four times, at the various moments of the buddhas, the one who abides in the dense pure realm appears through manifold emanations of time, making clear distinctions. The good time, likewise the third and both the extremes — the evil time — and in all of these whatever is needed by the embodied beings on earth, all of that he has accomplished, abiding in the center of the dense realm. That dense realm is an immaculate abode, the basis of well-being for those of great practice, at the boundary beyond both the evil and the two extremes. The sage, having taken on a form, abides in the immaculate dense realm endowed with yoga, and appears to beings like the moon — appearing in various beautiful forms to those various beings who perceive him, whatever form is joyful to whom and in whatever way — dwelling thereby in their eyes through those aspects, at all times. The sage, endowed with awareness and its objects, appears through the knowledge of yoga-wisdom. To those of great capacity, and in other forms, and to those wishing to enter, and likewise to others; in the form even of a novice, and in some instances abiding in space — appearing rightly to those with understanding and those who know.

To the sick of the earth, those oppressed by the earth, those afflicted, to young people, to pure fire, to Rāhu and other beings, to the human Cimā-bu-ru, to Igśva-ku and those of the moon's lineage — to all of them he is the king of the earth, worshipped by all on earth. His body, in whatever form each desires, appearing to some as sitting in the midst of assemblies, as an emanation conducting himself — the Teacher is seen by beings. He teaches also the summit of discipline, demonstrating it rightly and properly. Vajra, silver, gold, copper, iron and their sources; the flavors of ro-nye, of zhā-nye, pearl, lotus, ruby, andara-nyil, beryl, crystal, aśma-garbha, musāra — bearing

all forms and investigations: the preceptor, the master, the one who goes among all — just as from whomsoever, in whatever body, well-being arises for any embodied being on earth, so that very well-being for that being at all times springs forth from the sage's supreme yoga. It is not practiced by divine daughters, nor likewise by gandharvī women, nor by the women of the desire realm, the daughters of the sense-faculties, nor likewise by nāga women, nor by human daughters, daughters of asuras, nor likewise by yakṣa daughters. That yoga is victorious over the objects of desire; so too the domain of the form-realm beings; infinite space of consciousness, and likewise the sphere of nothingness, and the station of neither-perception-nor-non-perception — abiding there, there is no confusion whatsoever. All of these, beginning with the universal and so forth, are the path — the things that bind the yogin. Those that are not pacified, the other non-virtues — those too are grounds that exist for living beings.

The domain of the body for those who possess bodies —
in the Dense One there abides, yet in the Dense One there is none.
That pure, stainless field of merit,
the Dense One, is the heart-essence, supremely beautiful.

Likewise, liberation and the knowing of liberation —
among all fields, it is the supreme field,
the excellent field of the buddhas.
That Dense One is to be contemplated for a long time.

Those ten lordships together,
powers, superknowledges, and meditative absorption,
and the body arisen from mental causes —
a buddha there is resplendent in form.

Having cultivated all ten grounds,
liberation, truth, emptiness,
the signless and the wishless,
and likewise the six perfections —
through cultivation, generosity, ethical conduct,
and wisdom, one attains that body.
All limbs and forms, like flowers —
the unconditioned is the body of a buddha.

Free from thought and separated from thought,
selflessness of mind and of the sense faculties,

endowed with the gateway of the faculty of wisdom,
fully gathered together through all the marks —
through generosity, ethical conduct, and the rest,
by having performed white, wholesome actions,
one will attain the supreme abode of the buddha body
within the rank of the Dense One.

The dwelling place of the divine substances of the Tathāgata —
sun and moon are altogether absent.
Stars and asterisms, their light,
and the moon, its seasons and spectacles, are not there.
The light that dawns for yogins
and the light of the buddhas as well —
by that entirely excellent and dense luminosity,
it shines on every side like the sun.

The wasting away of time does not exist there.
No illness of any kind is present.
It is a place without death and without aging —
that Dense One is the supreme field.

All there have form; it is an abode of peace.
The assembly possessed of stainless vision —
the dense meritorious buddha-field:
this is what all the gods aspire to.

Yogins especially,
those who dwell on the grounds and in the grounds —
since the things that are the nature of mind-only
are thoroughly taught thereby,
mind, thought, and the manner of the all-base,
and the three natures likewise:
it is possessed of the nature of selflessness of phenomena.
The abode shifts elsewhere,
and the body becomes utterly transformed.
The Munis proceed there —
the supreme abode of yogins,
the Dense One, the excellent and sacred field.

This concludes the third chapter, entitled "Entry into the Dense One."

The body is possessed of the nature of nine substances,
a conditioned assembly of subtle particles.

Diverse in aspect through a collection of qualities,
it is an assembly of elements and their sources.

Arising entirely from semen and blood,
it proliferates in ways never before seen.

What is on top descends below.

The machine of suffering is without beginning.

It is enveloped by a hundred forms of karma,
like the ground of a poisonous tree,
nourished likewise by dust and air,
and sustained also by darkness.

It sways and trembles along the channels of the path,
urged on by time, it takes birth again and again.

Passing away from qualities through karma,
it is born in the wombs of cattle and of humans,
among nāgas, hungry ghosts, flesh-eaters,
the blazing ones, and among the gods —
or it is born as an asura, in the world,
or likewise in the class of mantra-holders.

Yet in the midst of yogins

one takes birth through meditative concentration, by direct arising.

Even in the noble circle of the wheel-turning lineage,
one is born again and again at various intervals.

Having been born and having seized awareness,
when the sense faculties then flourish —
from whatever time, of whomever and in whatever circumstance,
that which co-arises goes forth abundantly.

In the manner of co-arisen karma,
one fully enters upon the path and what is the path.

When, free from examination and divorced from thought,
phenomena are directly realized,
there are the three liberations of the liberated —
syllable rendered as no-syllable.

The assembly of causes of all the elements,
that is the supreme luminous light.

Refined from above, refined in the highest —
it dwells fully in the center of the Dense One.

With a body equal to fields countless as grains of sand —
pervading all with emanation, it abides.

If one knows that as that,
one will be liberated by way of the path of certainty.

The birth of a person born in such a way
is proclaimed "knowledge of distinction."

Declared rightly so by the God of gods,
set forth before the Victor's sons,
the arising of womb-birth
is what has been made for human beings.

It does not arise from ignorance, craving, and karma —
it has thoroughly arisen from affliction and karma.

The signless becomes manifest,
and having utterly transcended the signless,
from that arising of the letterless,
all conceptual elaboration is completely shed,
and one passes fully into the center of the Dense One.

The dissolution of mind from its object —
by the confusion of sound on the part of the yogin,
through the intoxication with divine substances, games, and the like,
and through the delusion of consorting with celestial women,
when the Great Sage is not present,
then mind arises.

The meditative absorption known as "moved from the path,"
born in the desire realm,
arises fully in beings of the form and formless realms.

When a sentient being has gone without perception,
one becomes separated from meditative absorption.

In the absorption of infinite space and infinite consciousness,
one will have no mastery.

When the Victor becomes the sovereign sage,
by being free from duality, the purified mind
does not arise in a manifest way.

That is the truth; that is yoga.

It is the meditative concentration of the meditator.
Meditative concentration should always be practiced.
That is so, if one desires the center of the Dense One.

This is chapter four: "The Arising of Womb-Birth."

Mind of eight aspects and nine modes —
ignorance is the cause of the world.
This is the power of mind and mental factors,
abiding in whatever is various in nature.
By its power alone, engagement occurs:
the consciousnesses and the faculties —
ignorance and these various aspects —
the root mind, that which abides stably —
all twelve links,
the elements, their sources,
objects, faculties, the world,
these are the cause of momentary dissolution.

Spoken by the Sage, the God of gods:
having abandoned cause and result,
this migration to the world's end of the Brahmā realm,
endowed with faculties —
it was not created by seeking the world;
it perishes like a clay vessel of its own accord.
The inner and the outer are always so.
Among beings, the stationary and the moving
are the domain of the God of gods.
What is unseen by anyone on earth —
those who sit in corners, those called by other names —
belong to the fame and marks of the Sage.

Bound by mutual bondage
through craving in its many modes,
because consciousness moves swiftly,
the nature of mind is not understood.

Through offerings reaching to the end of a thousand years,
one attains the means of the Brahmā realm,
yet turns back again —

thinking with a mind of proper conduct,
the fruit of blocking desires and killing,
whatever is the fruit of the monthly observance,
the fruit of committing to fire,
the fruit of whatever other offerings,
and the fruit of binding cattle —
all these turn back from the Brahmā realm.

Beings with three dharmas,
ignorant of any fault, disheveled —
the seeds connected with three qualities,
like a water-born flower, are without essence.
By this, liberation is not found.
The Dense One is the abode of the Tathāgata.
That is attained by yoga.
The Dense One is the abode of the wisdom of yoga.

Therefore, the lord of the Brahmā realm in one manner,
those who are yogins, striving in engagement —
in this, whatever kin of self there may be,
that there is birth and death or is not —
what cannot be destroyed, having nowhere to be dismantled,
is the consciousness of all embodied beings,
unstained by habitual tendencies,
having arisen since beginningless time.

The elaboration accumulated by the mind's appropriation
does not enter into any appearance whatsoever.
Just as divine substances and water-born flowers,
as a silk banner in the sky,
as the sun and moon by the stain of clouds —
in the same way the yogin is unstained.
Do not be lax; be utterly diligent.
All is blessed by the buddhas.
Yoga is the divine substance of the Sugata (the Well-Gone One, the Buddha).
It gives rise to the conduct of the yogin.

One endowed with moral discipline drinks the draft of discipline,
one endowed with wisdom drinks the draft of wisdom,

and having drunk the supreme wisdom,
cross beyond saṃsāra, cyclic existence.

In this there are no elements whatsoever.
The five aggregates and consciousness as well,
with name and form as their cause,
give rise to the mind of embodied beings.

Just as fire, governed by wood,
burns and blazes without any conception,
so too the aggregate is an empty chariot.
Why, then, would one not enter yoga?

In the abode of deer and gandharvas (fragrance-eaters, celestial musicians)
there appear sounds and gatherings and sights.
One sees deer, mirages, and so forth,
led astray by signs that are not real.

Just so, the mind arising from objects
wanders as though spinning on a needle.
There is nothing whatsoever substantial in this.
The elements — movement, warmth, moisture, and solidity —
are ever conceived by those who are bewildered.
Since the elements are but a gathering of mind,
why, then, would one not enter yoga?

As long as the unbroken body exists,
and as long as mind arises within it,
in the wisdom of yoga
do not be slack — practice meditative concentration with full earnestness.

All is like illusion and like dream.
Regard all three realms of arising as exactly so.
Like a mirage or a reflection of the moon in water —
why, then, would one not enter yoga?

Just as in the city of the gandharvas
the conduct of beings appears in full display,
so too the conduct of the aggregates in the body —
why, then, would one not enter yoga?

In dreams, assemblies of beings
appear just as a dreamer sees them in dream.
Since this is likewise the abode of the aggregates,
why, then, would one not enter yoga?

This earth and the mass of other elements
are an accumulation of gathered dust.
That this is mind together with its mental factors —
let all the sons of the Victors behold this.

The four great elements
are mutually assembled from all sides
and possess hardness and the rest.
Why, then, would one not enter yoga?

This body is intoxicated by wind and bile,
abiding like a training corpse.
There is no agent whatsoever here.
Why, then, would one not enter yoga?

All things like a head of foam,
those beings that abide and those that move —
understand deeply, through perception like a mirage,
that they are like pottery and the like.

Feeling is like a water bubble,
conceived as pleasant or unpleasant.
Formations are like a plantain tree —
decaying, fractured, hollow at the core.

Consciousness is like an illusion;
there is no substance in which it truly abides.
Just as grasses and trees have no abiding essence —
why, then, would one not enter yoga?

This is a dream, a state of delirium,
an illusion leading the bewildered astray.
All these are mirage,
and likewise the city of the gandharvas.

Whatever adorned appearances there be —
the beings and non-beings of the three realms —
all this is to be understood by the intellect.

By the fearless sons of the Victors,
when the causes of fault, together with their roots like grass,
are utterly burned by the fire of wisdom,
the divine substance of bliss comes to exist.
Even in the dense abode of the yogin,
this fearlessness is without sign.

Bound to signs is the nature of things;
freedom from signs is ever blissful.
Signs are the domain of ordinary mind.
The domain of ordinary mind is not the truth.
Truth is the domain of the awakened intellect.
Mind is the domain of wisdom
in which there is no abiding in signs.

Alas! All these are signs —
proclaimed as brahman (the Absolute, here the pure realm) in the three
abodes.

Signs: names, objects, and sounds and all the rest —
these are what is expressed.

The objects of all the sense faculties
are the cause of bondage for embodied beings.
What is to be bound, what is bondage, and what is its cause;
who is liberated and by what means liberation comes;
freedom and the bliss of liberation;
abiding in the Dharma visible in this life;
knowing it as selflessness —
all this occurs when attachment has been overcome.

Then the great-minded bodhisattva, the precious crown of men,
Spoke to the master of all yogins, at the fearless vajra-essence,
throughout all the fields of ten million realms:

"You, son of the Victors, strive with diligence.
You are the measure for all the Victors,
dwelling close to the yogin.
The yogin's doubts have been cut through.
In order to establish all the similes,

all the limbs that are to be examined —
the arising of the body in those who have bodies —
the manner thereof is expressed in sound.
What is there that cannot be stated in words?
Present it fully, together with its essentials.
Destroy with the treasure of the coupled pair those causes that cannot be
grasped.
Remove the causes of the aggregates.
Through the genuinely unchanging and through virtue, the wise one
swiftly, without delay, attains liberation.
Having burned the causes of the aggregates,
there arises a life that is of the Dharma, not of non-Dharma,
and that is attained in this existence and in others.
Through knowing, one is freed from sufferings.
Through craving one is ever bound.
Through ignorance, karma, and craving,
embodied beings are made to proliferate vastly.
Through form, appearance, mental engagement,
and consciousness manifesting toward objects,
that which does not swiftly penetrate to the depths
is a mind that wanders in its domain of experience.
Phenomena are those for which mind goes before —
so it is for all embodied beings.
Where mind goes, mind holds dear:
what is there that cannot be said to be pleasing to mind?
By whatever substance of whatever thing
humans are densely brought into being,
through that it becomes the very actuality of that —
like a gem that displays many forms.
Just as a many-formed gem,
when combined with color, becomes variously beautiful,
so too, yogin, at your center, the Tathāgata, through manifold forms,
in the virtuous palace of sovereign power,
causes an appearance to arise before the sons of the Victors
in which all is pure.
The passing beyond sorrow and the transcendence of sorrow,

the dense and supreme primordial wisdom,
the dharmadhātu and also miraculous power —
that dense state is the abode of the yogin.

It cannot be cut by weapons;
it cannot be burned by fire.
It cannot be cut, it cannot be divided;
it is the permanent locale, the dwelling-ground.
It cannot be dampened by water;
it cannot be dried by wind.
It is not destroyed like clay;
it does not arise as the result of effort applied after the fact.
Permanent, stable, indestructible —
it is the consciousness of all living beings.
Not refuted by causes,
not by the like and the unlike —
through the pledged vows and their limbs as well,
it becomes endless, without limit.
The pledge of what is pledged,
the distinction of cause and causes —
therefore nothing surpasses it.
It is not the domain of those who are conceptual.

When consciousness has become other,
that is the dense state wherein mind has been relinquished.
It is not the domain of the conceptual.
Dense is the palace of the Tathāgata.
It has no beginning, no prior arising, and no end.
It arises from the power of spontaneous accomplishment.
It is without cause and does not arise from karma.
It is not made by the Great Lord (Śiva).
Having truly transcended the formless, form, and the desire realm,
it abides.

Having transcended the desire realm,
it has no perception of form or of the formless.
Having fully transcended the cause of darkness,
the dense field is radiantly beautiful.
This direction, constituted from space,

is not the domain of those who have causes.
It is free from the side of existence and non-existence;
it has abandoned unity and otherness.
It is neither what is cherished nor intrinsic nature;
it is not Kāmarāja or Indra.
It is not even on the side of the Lord of the Bull (Śiva as Vṛṣabhanātha).
Likewise for the three possessors of knowledge:
it does not arise from the condition of atoms.
It cannot be expressed by sounds;
it is not produced by essential nature;
it cannot be found by Kāmarāja.
It does not come from ignorance, karma, and craving;
nor is it to be spoken of as arising from not-knowing.
It is the bearer of the burden and the domain of the burden.
This is the domain of the buddhas.
The divine substance — this the Tathāgata knows."

Purified across the ten grounds,
it is the manifold domain of those endowed with yoga.
It is the Teacher who reveals the highest meaning.

"What is karma, and what is not karma?" —
the childish are utterly bewildered by this.
Yet when karma and non-karma are explained,
those endowed with yoga find ease.

Variegated appearances are one's own mind.
The twofold self of embodied beings
abides, externally and internally and everywhere,
as though it were apprehended object and apprehending subject.

Mind is seen by mind —
yet those who are confused do not grasp this inwardly.
That mind is of a dual nature, belonging to the embodied being,
yet it is not understood as such.

One acts just as the self-agent acts;
it appears vividly as though it were an object.
It rests as form in things such as clay pots and so forth —
and yet those clay pots and such do not truly exist.

Regarding the meaning of this,
the weak yogin is quite bewildered.
That yogin too, failing to understand,
abides on the path of conceptuality about the self,
while this mind — the identity of both —
abides like the moon reflected in a mirror.

Just as one with a cataract
looks and looks at a mass of hairs —
"Look! Look!" —
and those hairs appear to one another,
yet it is through one's own fault, through a defect of the faculty,
that here there is not a single hair,
nor is there ornament or jewel —
they are seen through the defect of the faculty,
as though they were things that exist and do not exist.

In just the same way, under the sway of conceptual thought,
consider how the mind of the self abides.
What appears to have reached its limit in Brahmā and the rest
is grasped as such because conceptual thought is absent there.

All these manifold appearances,
the various characteristics of Brahmā and so forth,
all of them without exception — the mind of the self —
the characteristics of the qualities of clay pots and such,
the forms that have become inner,
the abodes of those dwelling in the higher realms,
and all these outer and inner activities —
all of these arise from mind.

The dense yogin, whichever one that is,
does not exist somewhere outside.
By the merit of one who is endowed with yoga,
train in this that has been entered.

Whether it be the abodes of the gods who exercise dominion over divine
substance,
or the abodes of those who have form,
or the realm of no-perception,
or the realms below,

or the state of nothingness, and consciousness,
and that which is neither perception nor non-perception,
and the various realms —
if attachment and its side are shattered,
you will quickly abide there.

In the abode of the dense yogin,
with the sons of the Victors placed before one,
go to that dense place.
Train in that yoga.

What is my kinsman to do?
My kinsman ever binds,
and is also the wanderer along the stream of saṃsāra's paths.
The faculties are unstable,
and the mind is confused even toward women.
From the repulsive mingling of semen and blood,
insects are born in the putrid mass.
Nine or ten perish,
and from the ripening of semen, birth becomes manifest.
Stirred about by the faculties,
just as worms wriggle —
in this very manner, in due sequence,
so it continues as long as sentient beings remain.

Look upon the birth of embodied beings!
In life after life they have arisen thus.
Thousands of fathers and mothers,
and hundreds of sons and wives —
finding them all in their abodes
is what it means to abide in the birth of the embodied.

Just as in a dream a barren woman
gives birth to a son,
and has the joy of finding that son
while she is in the very midst of dreaming —
then she wakes and is gone,
and having recognized it as a dream she is awake,
and the dream-son has not died,

nor has any birth occurred —

so too the rivers, dense with groves, and cities, and mountains,
villages and market towns, and cattle pens and herds,
and the places of ascetic practice in thick groves,
lands filled with living beings,
fields full of cattle and sheep,
the enjoyments of the world,
appearing here and there and elsewhere —
just as one runs about in this world,
so one runs about in the dream,
and bowing and contracting and so forth
appear here and there as well.

The wise one who sees the dream
reflects, upon waking,
that it was without birth and without death.
Those who are wise daughters understand this.

Just as with mountains and their echoes —
Just as a shadow appears everywhere,
so too the world is like a dream —
the wise should reflect on it in just that way.

Just as a man who is asleep
dreams of delighting together with a woman,
of various pleasing things,
of equaling the most exalted divine queen,
and of still other various objects —
and upon waking reflects:
was any of it true, or was it a dream?
He played with the dream-woman together,
then woke, and finds himself alone.
It was false, a deception, a fraud.

In the same way, all one's kinsmen,
and likewise the power of a kingdom,
soldiers in armor, sons,
mother and siblings and father too —
all of these should be known as like a dream.

Do not be slack in applying yoga.

The groves of ascetic practice and the fields,
mountains and the healing vales of mountains,
the arising of milk and the Mālaya range,
Mount Meru the Gifted and the Great Lord's mountain,
the snowy peaks and Mount Kailāsa,
places where rain falls,
the juice of the rose-apple fruit of Jambudvīpa,
those who partake of the nectar of immortality,
Phaṇḍukambala and Pārayātra,
what rests in the Kovidāra tree,
what dwells within Mount Meru,
what abides in the wish-fulfilling tree,
pratyekabuddhas and sons of the Victors,
śrāvakas of great miraculous power —
the yoga of all of these,
of all that arises and has arisen,
establishing oneself in the lotus posture,
sitting in cross-legged meditative equipoise,
train constantly in yoga.

Be utterly removed from desire and pleasure.

The faculties and their objects,
turn back completely from all of them,
and like a goad that masters an elephant,
place the mind in meditative equipoise.

Meditative concentration (dhyāna) worldly and world-transcending,
likewise the virtue of the Tathāgatas,
removed from desire and joy and so forth,
or proclaiming all of them,
and in particular the formless absorptions
and the concentration free of perception,
infinite space, infinite consciousness,
neither perception nor non-perception —
one who has entered yoga sees these clearly:
like the form of the sun and the moon,
like a lotus and like light,

like designs painted in the sky, like fire.

Having abandoned all of these,
remain in utter absence of appearance.

When one who practices the yoga of signlessness
has no conceptual thought and no attachment,
one sees countless buddhas,
abiding in meditative equipoise in field after field.
They confer empowerment with their hands
upon the crown of that one's head,
who enters the buddha grounds
and from whom various forms abundantly arise.
Having attained various actual modes,
one comes to know omniscience, knowing all.
Powers and the mastery of direct knowledge are attained,
and dhāraṇī and all meditative absorptions
become the source of all.

Even the form that the Sage generates through yoga
is dismantled into particles —

because particles are separated into the partless,
what exists becomes nonexistent.

It is just as a donkey sees the horns of a cow:

because there are no parts, there is a possessor of parts;
because there is no self among the aggregates, there is one who possesses
aggregates.

Therefore that which has become the fruit of karma
is made as if by a conjurer's illusion.

Here there is no karma and no fruit;
neither does the performance of karma exist.

The world is not made by a maker,
and the doer is not a doer.

If there were a doer in the doing,
these would become endless.

Through the fault of having made something endless,
the Sage would become stained.

Now, the various streams of the path —
those with bodies who dwell in water, sky, and earth,

who dwell in bodies altogether,
whose place is a good rebirth —
because there is movement by class,
embodied beings move as they wish.
And the individual activities of the faculties
grasp their objects as they wish.
This is the transformation of conceptual thought.
Just as from milk come curds and butter,
so too arising, abiding, and ceasing —

If mind were made by karma,
it would be like a dream, a gandharva city, an illusion, a cloud,
like a flash of lightning, like a mirage that deer in the wilderness pursue.

The yogin who has meditated on phenomena,
through the habitual tendencies of human conceptual proliferation
accumulated since beginningless time,
takes up various inferior states
and conceptualizes actions through various conceptual thoughts.
The faculties are like an illusion;
sense-objects are like a dream.
The doer, the action, and the activity —
the accomplished yogin does not examine these.

One who is conceptually driven, intoxicated with the real,
confused in their conceptuality, with diminished and disordered
consciousness,
exceedingly conceptualizes a doer,
and holds that wandering beings are made to move by activity.
They are not made by what the world holds dear,
nor arising from the condition of atoms,
nor made through the absence of causes,
nor arising through intrinsic nature.

Through iron, needle, and hollow tube,
through precious garlands and ornaments —
what kind of action has been performed?
By giving the name "gold" to a jewel,
the sharp features of birds, wild beasts, and variegated creatures,

and the sharpness of thorns,
and the wondrous diversity of beings —
these have not arisen from karma through conceptual thought.

Those who are intoxicated by belief in the real, who hold that this or that does not come from karma — not knowing the real nature of what is true — this is not something other than conceptual thought.

Just as poison that exists within milk later transforms into something disagreeable, so conceptual thought in all respects similarly enters into phenomena.

Phenomena do not truly arise;
phenomena do not truly perish.
Those various conceptual thoughts
are not known by the conceptualizing mind.

The phenomena of the various classes of beings —
destroy them through Yogācāra practice,
engage in it and enter into that yoga,
without thinking of action and non-action.

Through the phenomena belonging to the classes of beings,
the moon and sun, so beautiful,
though driven on by wind,
move through the sky without any support.
The extremely subtle and hard-to-know karma
is seen to abide in a dense form.
What then would such karma be?

For yogins who have entered and strive with diligence,
just as fire reduces a forest of wood
to ashes in an instant,
so too the fire of wisdom in an instant
burns away all the karma and habitual tendencies of the yogin.
The karma and habitual tendencies accumulated together
over many long ages —
through the habitual tendencies of yogic wisdom,
all are destroyed in an instant.

Just as a lamp instantly dispels
a mass of darkness,
so too by that lamp of wisdom, the Sage
shall dispel ignorance entirely.

This is the fifth chapter of the sūtra of the Great Vehicle called the Ornament
Dense with Meaning, the chapter known as "The Practice of My Own Karmic
Activity."

The Third Fascicle.

Just as a house standing on mud, grass, a mirage, and rope,
assembled from all sides into one,
appears in the midst of earth —
yet in each component there is no house —
and when one examines the substance and the thing itself,
one designates and expresses "house" for the assembled configuration of
substances:

Just as when fingers are all gathered together,
a hollow is formed from the two hands brought together,
and does not arise from something separate —

So too with a battle, a chariot, a roofless shelter,
a city, a forest;
likewise a mountain, a cloud, and waves on water —
all are like an echo and lightning.

Mirage, reflection of the moon in water, like an illusion —
cloth, clay vessels, and the like are spoken of:
to the learned, all phenomena
appear everywhere as like a dream.

Likewise the body, that manifold house,
when the channels and path of the winds are blocked,
it becomes like a mountain through the elements —
unstable like a house, never fixed,
without arising and without perishing,
not from self and not from other,
freed from both eternalism and annihilation,
utterly abandoned is apprehended and apprehender.

Just as a gandharva city —
though it is exhausted as mere appearance, it appears like a city —

Just so, things that arise through one's own conceptuality and mental
fabrication

emerge and proliferate.

Phenomena are like a mirage —
free from both existence and non-existence, they are wholesome.
They appear like a dream, like clouds,
like a painted image on a wall.

Like a fool who is blind,
all things move through one another as cause and effect.
Intrinsic nature cannot be grasped by conceptual thought —
the yogin sees it truly.

When atoms are examined and scrutinized,
no substantial atomic thing remains;
and since intrinsic nature is the supreme of all,
one speaks of "the supreme atom" for that reason.

Therefore the mind turns back,
abandoning the qualities of sound and the rest.

For the yogin who is a master of yoga,
that is the moment of becoming fit for rest.

The yogin who possesses that restfulness,
released from every bond,
is born neither here nor in the beyond.

Those devoted to the way of meditative concentration
dwell in the abode of the essence of manifold precious things —
there the masterful ones find their summit.

Lordly in qualities, free of fault,
they are supremely worshipped by vidyādhara women in great number
and by the sages (munis),
and they abide as in a dream.

Though dwelling here, even Brahmā,
the sages and the sons of sages,
and hosts of vidyādharas alike
are unable to look upon the crown of their heads.

This is the domain of the yoga of the sages.
Therefore apply yourself diligently to meditative concentration.
This is not the domain of all —
therefore teach it to a friend who is worthy.

Even in the abode of the stable earths in their variety,
and in the abode of those possessed of light,
attachment together with its party,
and delusion and aversion likewise —
having vanquished them, one passes beyond the dense into the thoroughly
vast,
and goes to the place of wish-fulfilling peace.
That place is not the domain of the lord of death,
nor is it equally the domain of consciousness.
It is the abode of the signless,
and it is not established by conceptual thought.

This is the abode of divine substance,
the abode of the sages possessed of yoga.
Therefore, if one desires that supreme field,
let the sage practise meditative concentration upon it.
Having utterly vanquished attachment and aversion,
where there is no "I" and no movement of "mine,"
not thinking of attachment and aversion,
cultivate the supreme meditative concentration.

Because each grasps at its own object,
the cognition of both subject and object abundantly arises.
Through the conceptual thought of existence and non-existence, likewise,
consciousness in all its forms has the all-base as its ground.

A woman with full and shapely lower limbs,
beautiful hair and lovely eyes,
a fine nose, a pleasing momentary form,
thick eyebrows and an attractive gaze —
just as someone who is attached to such a one,
with a mind thoroughly intoxicated,
looks upon her and conceptualizes at that time:
the unwise one is utterly drunk with it.
Whether walking, sitting, or standing,

even when reclining in the drowsiness of sleep,
the one full of desire thinks of nothing else —
the one who is desirous keeps her in mind.

Likewise your mind, turbid,
dwells upon her in all aspects.
Do not fall under the sway of bonds
through a turbid domain of defilement.

Just as certain people, whose minds are conceptualizing,
go completely astray in the range of their cognition —
among buffalo, bulls,
elephants, rhinoceroses,
the Raṅga, the Kṛṣṇasāra antelope,
the śarabha, the sura,
the smyan (a kind of wild yak), and the yak as well —
seeing the great horn of the white-eared one, the foremost of its herd,
and declaring "this is true and cannot be otherwise,"
they then say that lions, tigers, donkeys and the like
have no horns.

Thus from such views of existence and non-existence
there arises proliferation among the unwise.

In this way, seeing the horn of another animal,
the conceptual thought arises: "a donkey has none."
But if one had not seen the horn of another,
the thought "a donkey has no horn" would never arise.
Because the cause is a mistaken apprehension,
the thought "there is none here" arises.
And even without that apprehension,
one inevitably relies upon non-existence.
In the turbid, proud domain of conceptual thought,
do not conceptualize about the range of wisdom.

Cattle, cows, buffalo —

just as conceptual thought conceptualizes —
so too, do you examine with direct perception,
with valid cognition,
with wisdom itself —

whether the mind's activity,
the aggregates, the sense sources, and their objects
lead to liberation, to high rebirth, or to whatever one desires,
whether to dwell in Brahmā's realm in a Brahmā-like manner,
or in the abode of the highest, most glorious excellence,
amid various precious things, sovereign and beautifully adorned;
or among the realms of lesser and greater radiance;
or as a powerful lord of the desire realm,
or in the domain of the lords of sun and moon,
or amid other blazing, brilliant lights;
or in the realm of the Thirty-Three with its great kings,
or in the realm of the gods who delight in creation;
the yogin endowed with the ten Brahmā-abodes
is beautifully adorned, splendid in appearance, utterly clear to see,
desireless and undefiled — and so too
in the divine realm of Akaniṣṭha, amid divine substances,
utterly beautiful in Akaniṣṭha itself;
or the realm of infinite space, the realm of infinite consciousness,
the realm of neither perception nor non-perception,
and likewise the realm of joy born of emanation,
and other pure fields equally so —
as a sky-farer, in accordance with resolve,
one abides within the family of those who turn the wheel of saṃsāra.
In the domain of liberation, belonging to the liberated —
those who dwell there are yogins.
Those formerly victorious through the power of attachment
abide upon the good ground.
Because one is endowed with such yoga,
strive earnestly in the yoga.

Just as a clay vessel in the motion of its breaking
transforms even as it is caused to move,
and moment by moment it perishes — moment by moment —
yet impermanence itself is permanent,
even as a seed corresponds to a sprout,
so too these causes are comparable.
The sprout is not other than the seed,

yet the seed itself is not the sprout.
From clay-soil there arises a clay vessel;
from dyeing, red appears manifestly;
from black mixed with the earthen yellow-brown,
red wheat-grains too are born;
from a bulb comes an onion;
from a horn, salt likewise comes;
from filth and insects,
worms arise — and many other unlike things.
A result identical to its cause
is nowhere to be found in the world.
The result arises from a cause that has transformed.
As for the subtle particles that become a cause —
without the destruction of the thing itself,
without conceptualizing upon conceptual thought,
without a self of the cause, without an inner self,
and without any supreme self —
the self, the sense faculties, the mind, and the object
are not an aggregating cause.
From encounter there arises arising, and consciousness,
and the conditions are not independently existent.
By the knowing of a knower with respect to objects,
endowed with the power of the skilled,
the māras of the afflictions, with their armies, their forces, and their mounts,
are to be tamed.
Craving degrades the world.
Like swarms of insects and abundant phlegm,
those who are mighty and who have broken craving
are liberated from manifold aspects.
When one is thoroughly stirred up by craving,
one is not freed from the wheel of saṃsāra;
but parted from craving, one comes to escape.
Therefore, apply yourself to yoga.
Long-established habitual tendencies,
like a venomous, enraged serpent,
dragging one to this life and beyond —

this is what makes the stream of the path of saṃsāra so poisonous.

This is the sixth chapter, called "The Conduct of the Analysis of Yoga," from the noble Ghanavyūha Sūtra.

By the blessing of the Buddha's analysis of yoga and of the self-possessing one,

the Victors and the children of the Victors
who dwell in fields numbering in the tens of millions,
and all those who abide in the three realms,
those endowed with yoga at their respective levels —
the fields of bliss and density,
the supreme field of the yogins —

I see the buddhas seated in the center of a lotus,
arrayed as finely as atoms, I myself beholding them.

Rising from that yoga,
on the ground I see those Victors —
dwelling myself in the dense field,
the bodhisattvas dwelling together —
seen abiding in the sky like the moon,
like atasī flowers,
like the joint of a thumb,
the grounds thoroughly devoted to virtue,
I myself behold the essence of liberation.

"Now here, son — who are you?"

Thus the essence spoke, and the mind was transformed:

"This sage is one," he thought,
and then he entered into the body.
The beings too, having entered the body,
by the essence of the sage's lotus —
the enjoyments of all the buddhas,
dwelling everywhere throughout the three realms —
when he saw this, at that very moment:

"Alas, how wondrous is this thought!"

Then the sage, the god among gods,
gathered entirely the domain of yoga,
and the sage placed it as it was before.

"Alas, these inconceivable divine substances —
the manifold forms of the yogins,
the domain of the divine buddhas —
I behold them, beyond all thought.

The samādhi of the cloud of Dharma,
and joy and immovability likewise,
the full manifestation of what was far distant,
and those who bring forth light, without remainder —
going boldly like an illusion, and all the rest —
and those who are resplendent, without remainder:
they are also the domain of forms,
arisen from the skillful means of Akaniṣṭha.

That, through a body that transforms like a wish-fulfilling gem,
the eight qualities of mastery —
the qualities of the subtle and the vast,
the proclamation of attainment and the fulfilment of desire,
the possession of lordship and sovereignty,
and those that accord with all one wishes —
having attained these, one abides in the central realm of density
and sports with supreme delight.

From the dense realm of emanated divine substances,
those virtuous ones who have gone forth
discern fully the magical displays of the buddhas,
accomplished of themselves spontaneously.
Dwelling together with the Victors and the sons of the Victors,
they appear everywhere as one."

"This ground thus is manifold,
and those bearing their own forms are mingled together.
When one turns back from the part,
through action accomplished, the ground of density
is understood and cut through by the wise;
the sages see the density.
In what resembles an immeasurable lotus
it blazes forth like fire.

The sage, delighting in the yoga of ease,
dwells together with the yogins.
Endowed with the emblem of Śrī and all marks,
bearing subtle bodies and their own light —
in the midst of these, the lord of sages,
you will come to dwell supremely.

Behold the divine diadem,
the Druma, lord of the kiṃnaras —
blazing forth like the moon
with immeasurable tens of millions.

The sages and the sons of the Victors,
Tuṣita and the other supreme gods,
like atasī flowers,
of fine wisdom and bearing many marks,
those who hold garlands and crowns,
dwelling with their immeasurable multitudes —
their bodies blazing utterly,
omniscience and all aspects fully manifest,
fearless eloquence,
and Samantabhadra of great power —
with immeasurable ones resembling the moon,
they dwell in the great ocean of the dense expanse.

Praised by the sages from every side
in manifold aspects —
the supreme flock, free of attachment, of Brahmā,
the hosts of siddhas and gandharvas,
the lords of assemblies of men who are skilled and certain,
placed in front by the sons of the Victors —
and what is seen as if in slumber
through the practice of Yogācāra:
those who are free from sloth,
trained in restraining sleep and torpor,
follow after the divine buddhas;
sitting in stillness, all perceive them.

Likewise the gods, and Brahmā and the rest,
the people of Jambudvīpa and those of Akaniṣṭha,

and those who see the sage through miraculous emanation —
the beings, in all their manifold forms,
enter all together upon the ground.
Through many aspects of magical display,
the Protector is utterly resplendent.
Some lie down, blazing with light;
likewise others walk back and forth;
some meditate with distracted mind engaged;
likewise others pass beyond sorrow;
some enter the womb,
take birth, emerge, practice austerity,
fully awaken to full awakening,
and turn the wheel of Dharma.

Buddhahood itself and the buddha-realm,
the unsurpassed wisdom of the buddhas —
the fearless sons of the Victors
will all attain these.
Just as the sage, the lion of the Śākyas, obtained them,
so too, friends,
through the fearlessness of the sons of the Victors,
have full confidence in all of these.
When confidence is gained — buddha!"

There is no doubt that liberation will be attained.
One will become a wheel-turning king.
One endowed with confidence will become lord of the elements
and sovereign of the retinue in realms such as that of Brahmā and the rest.
One will take birth amid the lotuses of a stainless pure realm
at the very center of a sage.
That birth in the heart of the lotus
is likewise attained by the diligent son.
Through diligence one conquers māra.
Even from the habitual tendencies that are the causes of desire,
one defeats the lord of desire, the master of craving,
and enters fully upon the single vehicle.
The lineage that is diligent and without tranquility
is also supremely revealed by the sage.

The sons become the lineage of the vast,
and in realm after realm they become its sovereign.
When one aspires in mind to buddhahood itself,
the lineage of the buddhas becomes perfectly pure.
That son who belongs to the purified lineage
is prophesied by the buddhas:
just as a swift buddha is such as he is,
so likewise does the sage awaken.

Having fully awakened, one dwells in ease,
together with Brahmā and the rest, and with yogins.
Like the earth, ever in all times,
one abides close to all embodied beings.
All are endowed with the yoga of medicine.
Just as one who dwells in town and village
with consummate skill removes diseases,
such an expert acts
with a mind free from conceptual thought.
Though cut, it moves and yet is not shaken.
This is mere cognition alone.
The mind operates both inwardly and outwardly.
There is no self and no mine —
one sees the error and is unmoved.

The mind-consciousness with its objects,
the all-base consciousness (ālayavijñāna), pervading all —
it is both what is cut and the act of cutting,
and that very same is both what is to be cut and the cutter.
The all-base of every embodied being
is impregnated by the habitual tendencies of karma.
Just as fire arises from a crystal and the sun
coming together —
it does not arise from the firestick and the fireboard alone,
nor is it made by a person —
so likewise mind, mentation, and consciousness,
faculties, objects, mentation, and karma:
the minds that have arisen abundantly
are like the waves of the ocean.

Mirage, sky, illusion,
a dream — it is not an error.
Frog's hair, tortoise hair,
and a rabbit's horn — it is not equivalent to those either.
Fire arises from wood;
lightning, likewise, from clouds.
No one produces something from nothing —
it is like a potter with clay and so forth.
Just as, depending upon grass and wood
and together with them, an illusion arises,
so likewise all of faith and the rest
abide together with mind and mental factors.

The object of mind is beyond thought.
One who abides in stillness sees it well.
A divine substance, co-arisen without precedent —
like nirvāṇa and like space,
like cessation that is unanalyzed by each one separately,
free of the three times,
luminous, ever pure:
this is the all-base of every embodied being.

Like the color of the moon on the first day of the month,
it is luminous throughout a trillion realms.
Abiding at Mount Meru and revolving still,
entities are not destroyed.
Likewise mind, mentation, and consciousness
revolve within the element of sentient beings,
yet in that there is no increase and no diminution —
always, by its nature, it shines with light.

Just as ordinary beings ignorant of the moon
have the conceptual thought that it waxes and wanes,
yet waxing and waning are not in the moon —
it shines forth equally in continent after continent:
so likewise even childish, ignorant beings
constantly have the conceptual thought
that the all-base consciousness waxes and wanes,
yet that is the undefiled buddha.

This all-base consciousness is not rendered distinct
in any way by the elements.

The engaged consciousness that comes and goes
is, through habitual tendencies, like the moon.

Like a tree at the center of a river's course —
it accompanies the river's current
yet is fully established as distinct in its defining mark —
so it goes likewise into the great ocean.

In the same way, the all-base consciousness too
is always accompanied by habitual tendencies.

Though it accompanies the seven consciousnesses,
it is not commingled with them.

It is the cause both of thorough defilement and of purification,
and likewise the cause of complete purity.

Even for the noble ones who see phenomena directly (āryas),
this is the yogin's meditative equipoise.

Animals, humans, those born as gods,
flesh-eaters, serpents (nāgas), hungry ghosts,
asuras, gandharvas, and those in the realm of fire —
through all their paths and lineages, all are under its sway.

Even in the beautiful ground that is the basis of all buddhas,
this very thing has become the cause.

Having realized it, one becomes a buddha,
and will not turn toward another lineage or another vehicle.

It always dwells in all bodies,
abiding distinctly amid the faculties.

In the glorious one it abides with special distinction,
and in all beings altogether it dwells completely.

In the highest, middling, and lowest,
in all the jealous realms of beings,
it abides everywhere —
the support dwelling in the bodies of embodied beings.

The self of the fruit and the self of the cause,
and the inner self as well —
in this very thing childish ones imagine a fixed and permanent self.

Its expanse is beginningless.
It is produced by clinging and by karma,
sustained by beginningless habitual tendencies accumulated over time.
What nourishes and sustains it
are the seven consciousnesses.

Mentation is constantly like the wind:
it moves and swiftly engages.
It dwells in the bodies of embodied beings,
abiding on the higher planes of the elements.
Stirred by the wind of karma,
it pervades and dwells in all the sense faculties.
Together with the seven consciousnesses
it flows along like waves upon the water.

In the atoms, in time, in the principal matter,
and in the person endowed with a lord —
the all-base consciousness alone, that virtuous one,
is imagined by the conceptual-minded to be a fixed entity.

Always taking forms of manifold variety,
moving and arising swiftly,
the all-base consciousness abides in all the grounds
both externally and internally.

That it is the cause of the grounds
is examined by those who reason from causes.
Its movement is supremely subtle;
it intoxicates those with conceptual minds.
Driven by self-interest and the intoxication of the mental faculties,
not seeing correctly, one becomes bewildered.

Stirred by former karma,
consciousness is the cause of craving.
It is the cause of beings with diverse forms,
and equally the cause of human beings.

Thus spoke Vajragarbha to the fearless sons of the Victors:
the all-base consciousness and its virtuous unfolding
are seen and heard by the bodhisattvas.

The supreme virtue of the all-base consciousness
clings to all bodies.

Endowed with the thirty-two marks,
possessing form of manifold variety,
even the Victor who turns the wheel —
is seen by those traversing the grounds to be progressing through them.

Just as the moon together with the host of stars
abides in the sky in unison,
so too the consciousnesses and the all-base consciousness
abide together in the body in just that way.

Just as a god who sways by his power
is brought forward by a goddess,
resplendent in beauty amid precious jewels —
so too is the all-base consciousness on the grounds.

Just as the lord of waters, the god of rivers,
governs rivers, oceans, and pools,
just as the earth is the living ground of living beings —
so too the mind is utterly resplendent.

Just as the sun dwelling in a measureless palace
shines beautifully beyond the slopes of Mount Meru,
and gods too bow in homage to it —
so too the all-base consciousness, on the ground of buddhahood,
abides together on the ten pure grounds.

The bodhisattvas who travel those grounds practicing conduct,
drawn forth by the Great Vehicle,
dwell beautifully within the body.

Through the mouths of those who proclaim,
the Victors are universally praised forever.
The śrāvakas and the pratyekabuddhas,
and the bodhisattvas especially,
pure ground upon ground,
are proclaimed with distinction as sons of the Victors.
The Victors and the sons of the Victors —
all of them are spoken of in terms of this all-base consciousness.

Those bodhisattvas and Victors who undergo the transformation
of prophecy and prophetic proclamation —

through the stainless merit of the all-base consciousness
they become Tathāgatas.

Such is the domain of the all-base consciousness.

The yogin who dwells in stillness,
practicing with diligence and yoga,
sees fully through yoga,
sees buddhas and pratyekabuddhas,
śrāvakas and others seated in solitude —
having realized suchness and seen it,
this is yoga, the fearless yoga.

Whatever is the domain of consciousness,
whatever appearance arises — anything at all —
that has become consciousness.

Pottery and the like are not earth in itself.

Whatever erroneous appearance arises in this way,
whatever it may be that is heard as various pottery —
that has become the all-base consciousness.

Erroneous appearance is its defining characteristic.

The all-base consciousness, like a river,
is seen by those who proceed into manifold appearances.
The mind, impregnated by habitual tendencies,
revolves extensively in the apprehended and the apprehender.
Yet things are not like illusions,
not like a cluster of hairs or a mirage.

They are neither arisen nor unarisen,
free of the dichotomy of empty and non-empty.
In actuality there is no single thing that does not change,
just as with long and short and so forth.

Where the illusory nature has arisen,
there is nothing whatsoever anywhere.

This is a magical formula, an illusion,
that appears fully to people.

A mirage, a cluster of hairs, and so forth —
these are what become manifest from the two.

Without there being a one, the two likewise

do not arise, and cannot come to arise.
Illusion and the rest, examined,
are what consciousness has become.

Where there is no illusion yet "illusion" is spoken of,
there is nothing at all in any thing.

Yet whatever exists — anything at all —
what is made by illusion also exists.

What causes intoxication exists in the world
for those who have no mastery over their minds.

Illusions and conjured displays
are not made by various illusions.

Whatever movements there may be — anything at all —
those are not appearances; no one sees them.

Here, conceptual thought and movement
are like iron to a hollow needle.

For sentient beings there is no self, yet the impermanent
is like a crystal sphere and a jewel.

The all-base consciousness, diverse in all its aspects,
appearing as if an agent,
arises and dies,
yet there is no one who transmigrates through saṃsāra.
Seeing birth and death as like a dream,
one is fully liberated.

When the sage arrives at that moment,
it is called liberation.

What is taught through reasoning and scripture —
that is the Buddha, the supreme bull of the herd.

All phenomena are like a mirror,
like scales, and likewise like a measure,
like a lamp for all things,
dwelling like the lodestone for the hollow needle.
This is the defining characteristic of the yogic path:
it reverses destruction as well,
the supreme concentration of the meditator,
and is the cause of complete purification.
It exhausts all afflictions fully

and also purifies the path.

It is the domain of the ultimate purpose
and fully demonstrates transformation.

This is the seventh chapter of the noble text Dense Array.

Then the great bodhisattva (bodhisattva mahāsattva) Vajragarbha gazed in all ten directions, and with rays of light from the precious jewel at his crown he illumined all the world-systems, as well as the abodes of the lords of dominion and all the sons of the Victors dwelling in the palaces at the heart of precious jewels, and he spoke to the one who teaches right placement just as it is. He said:

O teacher of right placement just as it is, on a snowy hillside there is a species of deer called "the slayer of all deer." By means of a thousand and one deceptions, this creature lures many deer close, and when they are caught in its snare, it kills them and eats them. If it sees a doe deer with her fawn, it calls out in the voice of a fawn. If it sees a horned deer, it takes on a form resembling those antlers and draws them near. Then, when those deer trust it and it knows they trust it, it kills and kills and eats them. Even upon seeing antlers, it displays an antler-form, and having lulled them into complacency, it kills and kills and eats them as it pleases.

Just as that fierce deer-slayer kills deer by means of many different forms, so too the all-base consciousness (ālayavijñāna), obstinately persisting in the views of the non-Buddhist opponents who assert a self, dwelling in the character of the intrinsic nature of selfhood, binds beings through this and that form of grasping. For those who are bound by such grasping and are thoroughly conceptualizing a self of such and such a nature, making it known down to the subtlest particle, the all-base consciousness abides as their very grasping at self — and this holds until consciousness no longer remains as mere consciousness apart from it. Those who fully understand the self see that cognition arises from the coming together of mind, sense faculties, and objects; it does not arise from a cause that is a collection of self, mind, sense faculties, and objects. Just as when a flower and a garment come into contact they become distinctly fragrant, but when there is no contact no fragrance is perceived — in the same way, there is nothing else apart from mind, what arises from mind, mentation, and consciousness: the object that has come to be other than that, like a vessel and its contents, like oil and a clay pot, like a

mirage and the ishikā reed — nothing at all. From causes and conditions the mass of mind and mind-arisen factors arises; and those who are without self, subtle, incapable of being produced, without parts, pure and luminous from the very beginning, and practitioners whose domain is the mere cognizance of objects — those who realize this do not perceive them except within the domain of the noble one's own self-knowing. This very thing is like the fierce deer-slayer: it generates in worldly beings the views of existence and non-existence, oneness and multiplicity, everything and not-everything; and it causes those beings who have not understood that embodied experience is mere cognizance to fall into attachment to assertions of self and mine. Because of not understanding, with a mind that desires to comprehend the Dharma, they mount the wheel of the stream of saṃsāra and run about from this life and lives before. Separated from a spiritual friend, a buddha, or a bodhisattva; their minds fallen into a state of wandering even further than far from their own side; unable to attain the eight branches of the noble path; and not entering into even a single one of the three vehicles in any form — until a turning away arises from holding to such forms, they do not see the noble truths. Even those who are destined for the dense array (the densely arrayed buddhafield) neither hear the name "dense array" nor hear a sound of it. This teaching, setting forth things precisely as they are, is the thorough purification of the view for yogins. You and the other bodhisattvas should strive in this. Teach the yogins also the manner of the discourse on entering the densely arrayed buddhafield.

This is the eighth chapter: "The Domain of One's Own Cognizance."

Like a needle to a lodestone
drawn whirling round on every side,
so the chariot of the aggregates,
empty, born of habitual tendency, revolves.

From grass and clay and wood and reeds
and rope assembled into one,
a house appears in just that way —
so too is this form of the aggregates.

Iron and needle and a walking corpse
have no sentient being perceived within them,
yet all move as if they were sentient beings —
just so, the aggregates are without self.

The Victor's son, Precious-Handed (Vajrapāṇi),
addressed to the supreme king much of form:
"O king, you should inquire
of the vajra-core of meditative equipoise."

What all Victor's sons, the fearless and the wise, will hear —
free of analysis, incapable of being analyzed,
relinquished by expression,
free of name and what bears the name —
yet their assembly is just so.

"What is the intrinsic nature of this earth in all its variety,
and in what form does it abide?"

Then the king of much form
put a contextual question to the vajra-core, the fearless one,
concerning the examination of other meanings of things:
"What is the thing of the vajra lord
that some should thoroughly examine?
Does the object of name and perception and so forth exist?
Vajra-core, please speak."

Having heard the words of the protector of men,
the vajra-core spoke to him thus:

"All of these are mere names,
abiding only in mere perception.
What is to be expressed, being distinct from expression,
does not exist.

The four aggregates are names;
form too is to be analyzed as 'mere.'
What has been designated as a name onto a mere,
this is called 'this person' —
the Victors and their sons have taught
that onto a mere, what is called a 'characteristic sign' —
without a characteristic sign, these cannot be conceptually elaborated into
names.

Therefore, relying on characteristic signs
as supports, names are thoroughly examined.

Just as a flying bird, a bee, and the intervening space
do not actually exist in themselves,

without a characteristic sign, whatever it may be,
a child does not conceptually engage with it.
Likewise, all this earth
does not exist without a characteristic sign;
whatever is not discerned as a characteristic sign —
if a characteristic sign exists, one conceptually elaborates it.

Pots, cloth, and chariots
are expressed where form exists.
This world is just this much —
mere form; it does not become something else.
What is designated as a name onto a mere —
this has no truly established name.
Yet when sages view these grounds
as being free from names, separated from them,
conceptuality enters in;
without conceptuality, it does not arise.

What has become other, not born from thorn,
arises inexhaustibly from that.
Because there is no cause, there is no name;
one conceptually engages with mere perception.
Therefore the king should always
cultivate what is perception yet is not perception.
All these are just this much;
there is nothing else beyond everything.

The mere is to be understood as form.
Likewise body, form, and shape,
deportment, height, and broad figure —
characteristic sign and synonym are one.
Perception, name, and conceptuality,
expression and distinction together —
the mere, the characteristic sign, and perception
are extensively designated as conduct.
Abiding in the mere, even the names
are examined with respect to conventional meaning.

Without expression, a thing
has not arisen and will not arise.

The arising of consciousnesses too
does not exist without an object of conceptualization.
The object of conceptualization, the name, and the mere —
all the grounds are just suchness.
The thing with which one should examine what thing by which name
does not similarly exist.
This is the nature of reality of phenomena:
when analyzed, it has no established abiding.

All of these are mere names;
there is no thing possessing perception.
Because that does not exist, there is no name;
because there is no name, there is no conceptual elaboration.
Being without conceptual elaboration, one grows calm —
like a fire that, having burned what was to be burned, is extinguished.
Just as a burden-carrier carries a load,
the burden-bearer is characterized as distinct from it —
likewise the mere carries the load of name,
bearing characteristics distinct from it.

'Mere' is conceptually applied to mind;
by name, through mere mind, onto the mere —
'this person,' 'this trunk' —
whatever it may be, examine it as mere name.
The elements and their assemblage —
the mere too is to be analyzed with respect to form.
Without the mere, the mere of the elements
is not apprehended.

Just as a quality on the surface of a pot,
the name abides distinctively on the mere.
The pot is free of the thing of the pot
and separated from the name;
the pot does not abide in the thing of the pot,
nor does the name abide as name.

When the yogi sees
the mere of the name as unmoved,
and sees the presence or absence of the name-mere
connected with the two kinds of conceptual elaboration —

just as iron in fire,
and fat, and lac,
become liquid together with water,
yet do not possess the quality of water —"

Likewise the all-base consciousness (ālayavijñāna),
together with the seven consciousnesses,
constantly enters into the body.
It is abandoned, in time, through consciousness.

Just as a magnet and lodestone provide support,
and iron revolves as though it were a sentient being,
yet neither of these two acts —
it moves as if it were a living sentient being.

Mind is counted as the seven.
The all-base is, in the same way, the eighth.
Because it is threaded by the thread of habitual tendencies,
it moves like a sentient being, yet there is no sentient being.
It dwells pervading throughout the body,
and beings wander cycling, dizzying themselves.
One does not know the other,
like iron and a lodestone without an agent.

With many heads, many tongues,
many mouths, many hands,
and bodies transformed into many forms,
those who make offerings to the Tathāgatas
in fields beyond measure and by the thousands,
go to those protectors in their manifold places
and constantly offer worship to them all.

With flowers, food, and abundant rains of offerings,
equal in height to Mount Meru,
of many kinds and various forms,
they make these offerings in fullness.

With garlands, half-garlands, and diadems,
adorned with many precious ornaments,
they constantly make offerings in fullness
to the Omniscient One and to the sons of the Victors.

Palaces vast as clouds,
their forms shifting into many kinds,
their limits equal to the expanse of the sky —
and further, goddesses numerous as atoms,
many emanations,
proclaiming the excellent sounds of music and cymbals,
dwelling openly in those pure palaces,
make offerings to the Tathāgatas.

Obtaining power over strength and super-knowledges,
undiminished from the stage of dizzying progression,
having emerged from the cloud of Dharma,
those who have entered the buddha ground —
practicing the meditative absorption of the illusion-hero and the like,
abiding in meditative equipoise,
those who have become skilled in dhāraṇī —
make offerings to the Tathāgatas.

Those inspired to speak of the buddhas truly
travel to fields without limit,
and those possessed of true qualities
proclaim fully the qualities of the buddhas.

Having vanquished Māra together with his armies,
together with the Victors,
the sons of the Victors each cultivate
the meditative absorption to be realized through their own individual
awareness.

Those who possess qualities transformed to another abiding,
who teach the selflessness of phenomena,
having cut the stream of all conceptual elaboration
and cultivating the true ultimate in full —
skilled perpetually in the nature of the five phenomena
and likewise in the eight consciousnesses —
those who dwell in meditative equipoise make offerings.

Both with a body like the finest dust particle
and likewise with a vast great body,
transforming into forms of every kind,
they make offerings to the Tathāgatas.

Pervading all grounds with their own body,
they press in like a mustard seed into grain,
the ocean follows after the bull,
and the bull follows into the great ocean.
They cause beings both stationary and mobile
to enter fully on the tip of a single hair,
yet they cause no harm,
moving freely among all beings.

The pleasant domain of those endowed with enjoyment —
equal to the sun and moon and earth,
and also like unburning ground —
they benefit in every respect.
Like fire and wind,
always like water and medicine,
like the source from which a precious element springs,
they sustain all sentient beings.

Without birth and without cessation,
without interruption, without permanence,
neither different in meaning nor identical in meaning —
those without going and without coming,
through analyzed names (parikalpita)
and through the imputed intrinsic nature,
they accomplish the benefit of sentient beings.
Free from both name and non-name,
like an illusion, like a dream,
like a city of scent-eaters (gandharvas),
like a mirage, like the moon in water —
these imputed intrinsic natures:
like lightning, like a cloud, like smoke,
like the wheel of a firebrand, like a mirage —
the phenomena of this kind of analysis
are the imputed intrinsic nature.

Whatever phenomena are expressed by whatever names —
those are not present there in that way.
That is the imputed intrinsic nature.

All of these are mere names.
This migration through existence is mere name.
Expression and what is to be expressed
are in no way separate things —
there is simply nothing to be expressed at all.
This is the intrinsic nature of the grounds,
the imputed nature fully revealed.

From the eye and form in dependence,
from these three arises mentation.
From drum, sound, and fire meeting,
from sprout, seed, and earth in sequence,
from houses and the like in their variety,
from cloth, from clay, and so on,
from embodied beings and from phenomena —
this is the intrinsic nature that is the dependent nature (paratantra).

Things without abandonment,
and whatever phenomena are without defilement,
together with the streams of individual self-knowing awareness,
and the selflessness of phenomena —
all of these are the established nature of phenomena,
and as intrinsic nature, that is what is examined.

By intrinsic nature, the phenomena
are proclaimed as distinct in their characteristics.
If all phenomena were to be blended together,
they would become utterly without intrinsic nature.

From substances that are not singular, assembled together,
the illusionist makes forms that are not singular —
just as the illusory deer he creates
is not easy to comprehend.
In just the same way, all things
are analyzed by conceptual thought.
Forms that are not singular, not fit for conceptual determination —
that is the imputed intrinsic nature.

From a gathering of material causes
resembling various jewels and animals,
the illusionist fashions diverse appearances,

and so it is with the forms of all sentient beings.
In just the same way, all these things
are analyzed by conceptual discernment.
The intrinsic nature is difficult to comprehend —
that is the imputed intrinsic nature.

Just as a jewel of many colors,
encountering dye, shines forth in splendor,
so too all these grounds are the same:
when analyzed by conceptual thought,
their qualities do not abide as real entities.
They are like an illusion, like a dream, like a cloud,
like a mirage, like the moon in water —
that is the imputed intrinsic nature.

Just as the palaces of the scent-eaters (gandharvas)
are not palaces, yet appear as palaces,
and do not appear without a cause —
so too these grounds in all their variety,
the palaces of the sun and moon,
ordinary mountains and jeweled mountains,
are never harmed by the harm of smoke and clouds.
When analyzed by conceptual thought
from the standpoint of self, other, or both,
things themselves are not established.
The intrinsic nature of things is the imputed nature, through and through.

Things do not arise from causes,
nor do they arise without causes.
"Intrinsic nature" is conceptual thought —
it is the analysis of things and non-things.
Signs serve as the support for names,
and conceptuality dwells in those two.
Genuine knowledge and suchness
are the reversal of conceptual thought.

Mind is like signs,
and signs abide in mentation.
Upon mentation, the five minds

arise like waves upon the ocean.
Mind moves through habitual tendencies;
habitual tendencies are without beginning.
The object of the beginningless cognitive stream —
that object is the confusion of mind.

Mind is like objects,
and the grounds are called objects.
All seeds dwell together in the all-base consciousness,
and all consciousness also dwells there.
The seven forms of consciousness arise
from the all-base consciousness in mutual dependence.
Between mind, the various forms of consciousness, and the all-base,
there is neither permanence nor annihilation.
All the grounds are the all-base,
dwelling spread through intermediate space.
Arising from the condition of the three assembled,
arising from self and from the sense faculties,
the consciousness of embodied beings
arises by meeting its objects —
this is the way of the one who has conceptuality,
arising through the causation of cause and karma.

The sense faculties and all the grounds,
along with Brahmā and the rest as outer things —
these are not produced from asuras,
nor are the grounds made from atoms.
Like the grounds, the all-base consciousness itself
moves as the object of [various] views.
Conditions do not make the all-base,
nor is the all-base made by conditions.
In all of these, the three are not assembled.

Yet consciousness is saṃsāra —
like a crystal moon reflected,
the consciousness that co-arises with the consciousnesses,
the consciousness arisen from habitual tendencies,
and the all-base consciousness ever accompanying —
like the moon seized by a jackal,

it co-arises with the consciousnesses.
Roused from those habitual tendencies,
it proliferates again and again.
What has proliferated causes further proliferation,
and that again is made to proliferate yet again.
Thus the mind that has fully entered in,
seeing, turns that mind back around.
It connects thoroughly with an unstable object,
like iron to a magnet.

In the all-base, the minds that exist —
those imbued with habitual tendencies,
whether defiled or undefiled —
engage and disengage.
Just as from the burning of fuel
fire moves elsewhere and blazes up,
then moves elsewhere again in the same way,
and from those places moves on still —
so too the all-base consciousness
and those others that arise from it,
flowing through phenomena,
are what belongs to the defiled and the undefiled.

Dwelling in the phenomena of vision,
their objects and object-possessors are these.
The meditative absorptions, too, of those noble ones
who possess the phenomena of noble seeing —
those noble ones who are endowed with these,
because they are possessed of cultivation and of seeing,
know the suchness of all phenomena
and pass from field to field.

Just as the finest gold
is not visible in its ore,
but when thoroughly refined by assaying
and fully purified it becomes manifest —
in the same way, the one with meditative absorption
who is a yogin thoroughly purified through samādhi
always sees the all-base consciousness

together with the seven consciousnesses.

Just as butter is present in uncurdled milk
yet does not appear there,
but is seen through the process of churning —
the wise therefore churn it for that reason.
In the same way, the all-base consciousness
together with the seven consciousnesses
is seen by the sages who, through churning and dense practice,
have discerned it clearly.

Ignorance is what is called suffering;
the maṇḍala of wisdom is its synonym.
The yogins who have trained in this maṇḍala
pass into the dense realm.
The formless, the form realm, space,
consciousness, and the sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception —
whether a yogin has meditated upon these as objects,
they pass into the dense field.

Like the light of sun and moon,
the fearless sons of the Victors
demonstrate to yogins and remain on the path of Yogācāra.
Consecrated by all the buddhas,
they pass densely into empowerment.
Perceiving the yoga of the buddhas,
they are transformed and pass into density.
Dwelling in that density, through emanation
and through emanations of emanations,
wherever and for whomever a Dharma is desired,
they remain in space and demonstrate it.

The all-base that has been constructed by conceptuality,
accumulated by the cause of habitual tendencies
through the condition of beginningless time,
gives rise to bondage that arises everywhere.
Just as the waves of the ocean,
stirred up by the wind,
arise in an unbroken stream —

so too with the consciousnesses on the all-base:
that consciousness proliferates
through the habitual tendencies produced by it,
arising, and for some turning back —
with no annihilation and no permanence.

Because one has not comprehended one's own mind,
the consciousnesses that lean toward objects,
though they enter in, they turn back again.

When a being sees its own mind,
the mind that has been transformed
is like fire and what is burned.

The all-base, too, appearing as an object,
when transformed, becomes undefiled;
entering the course of the undefiled,
one is born into the lineage of noble ones.

The all-base, appearing as an object,
pervades and abides throughout all the grounds.

The mentation, regarding the self as self,
is that which gives rise to the sense of I.

Consciousness distinguishes colors and distinctions
and fully makes every discrimination.

The mind is what accumulates actions and so forth.

Mentation it is that brings about comprehension.

Consciousness makes things known distinctly.

The five together bring about the seeing of appearances.

Just as one with cataracts, or one who is intoxicated,
sees a cluster of hairs that is not there,
so too with form and the rest — what appears as form is not form.
Mind abides in the likeness of form.

The sun-gem and the moon-gem,
characterized by utter purity,
when struck by the rays of sun and moon
draw forth their own inherent qualities.

Likewise, the all-base consciousness,
which is the tathāgata-heart of virtue,

endowed with undefiled excellence —
when transformed, it brings forth abundantly.

Whatever appearances there may be,
those that appear as signs in the likeness of form:
the all-base is beset with habitual tendencies,
and abides throughout all the grounds in the likeness of form.

Just as from milk, through transformation,
the qualities of curds and butter become manifest,
so too the all-base consciousness,
having undergone transformation, abides in the likeness of form.

Just as one with cataracts sees hairs
through the defect of the eye in various ways,
so too, by reason of the defect of habitual tendencies,
the all-base, for beings with bodies,
constantly enters within the range of the eye,
setting in motion the appearance of form.

All these appearances, whatever they may be,
are like the example of a mirage on water.
Form is left behind by both existence and non-existence;
this is what is seen in the wake of the all-base.

Dependent on the eye and on form,
it arises just as an illusion does.
Ever entering within the range of the eye,
it flickers like a mirage.

Form endowed with the qualities of form,
the all-base abiding in the likeness of form —
just as when a child has imagined something,
the form does not exist somewhere else out there.
There is no agent and no act of intending;
it abides like a cluster of foam.

Sleeping, yawning, stretching,
walking, sitting, roaming about —
performing all these activities simultaneously:
this is the all-base of beings with bodies.

Just as from parched earth scorched by blazing heat,
mirages rise upward,
shimmering like spring water
and deceiving the deer —
so too the all-base consciousness,
within the domain of what is seen as non-form,
appears as form to the conceptualizing mind,
yet upon examination it is not actually like form.

Just as when a magnetic lodestone is seen
and iron swiftly turns and circles round it,
and yet there is no intention in the stone,
it nonetheless appears as though it were minded —
so too the all-base consciousness,
mindless, moves in the manner of sentient beings,
stirring in its going and coming,
progressively depleting the grounds.

Just as in the tidal currents of the ocean,
there is movement and stirring even without life,
so too the all-base consciousness
dwells in the body yet is in motion.

Just as an elephant fights its own reflection
and is crushed without the reflection being real,
so too the all-base consciousness,
engaging and being overwhelmed, ceases to flow.

Just as a spotless lotus
arising from within the mud
is worthy of humans, gods, and holy ones,
and is desired by all who dwell in divine realms —
so too the all-base consciousness,
arising from the mud of habitual tendencies,
when it dwells transformed in purity,
is what those of great estate desire.

Just as a perfectly pure jewel,
though hammered and beaten against a cliff face,
is still worthy of a king's crown
and is fit to be set in a diadem —

so too the all-base consciousness,
hammered and beaten by habitual tendencies,
is, when purified, the lineage of buddhas;
it is to be recognized as buddhahood itself.

Just as stones at the bottom of the water
are wrapped all around by fish scales,
so too the all-base consciousness
is rendered defiled by habitual tendencies,
and by the support of both the apprehended and the apprehender
it is set in motion by these two things.

Just as a two-headed serpent
goes wherever it wishes,
so too the all-base consciousness
moves both sequentially and simultaneously.

Always various, like form,
it is examined there by conceptual thought.
The one given to conceptuality becomes thoroughly intoxicated,
projecting concepts of self and mine,
remaining as the cause of existence and non-existence,
conceptualizing even throughout the grounds.

Because those of lesser intelligence do not properly comprehend
the transformation of what undergoes change
and the profound depths of the all-base consciousness,
they wander as in an illusion of deer in a mirage.

It is difficult to understand that intrinsic nature is not one,
yet it is similar in all embodied beings.
Likewise the all-base consciousness
is always like deer in a mirage.

It is difficult to understand that sentient beings are not one.
They are conceived as existent and non-existent.
Atoms, the primal matter (prakṛti), the primal person (puruṣa),
the unmanifest (avyakta), and Brahmā as well —
those who are deluded by conceptuality
always conceptualize the all-base in such terms.
Just as with what abides in the manner of the grounds,

so too they conceptualize it at each of the various grounds.
The mentation that conceptualizes whatever is conceptualized at the ground is called thoroughgoing conceptualization.

Just as a painting with high and low,
just as forms of clouds in various shapes,
just as the rainbow, and the thirst-inducing mirage of deer,
just as the sound of clouds and thunder —
just as the garland of one with blurred vision,
just as the face of a beautiful woman —
in dreams there are many and various appearances,
the palace of the gandharvas (gandharva) and their abode,
the trees of the undead, the trees in water,
the echo of a cliff, and clouds and smoke,
the reflection of a face in a mirror,
the moon reflected in water —
by these and many such conceptual projections
beings conceptualize the all-base.

When one perceives the all-base in such a way,
seeing all its various forms,
and thereby sees one's own mind,
then at that moment the mind turns back.

The all-base, being the ground of all phenomena,
is rendered turbid by habitual tendencies, pride, and the like,
and by conceptuality. Having been transformed into something other,
it becomes undefiled.

Having perfectly attained the undefiled natural state,
these become permanent and stable.

Like the sky, like nirvāṇa,
and just as with cessation,
for one endowed with a mind in meditative equipoise
undefiled phenomena arise.

Miraculous powers, meditative concentration, liberation,
meditative absorption, powers,
skillful means, strength, and the higher knowledges
are undiminishing and inexhaustible — just so —

reaching to the very limit of the sky's end,
the space, the mind, and consciousness being permanent,
possessing the abode of the ten perfections,
with a body as stable as a wish-fulfilling gem,
the yogin accomplished in yoga
attains these through transformation.

This is not destruction, not passing into nirvāṇa.
There are no sentient beings, there is no birth.
Without diminishment, without filling,
the Victors thus describe beings.
In other pure lands and in this one
the nature of reality is exhausted into one.
Whether things have arisen or have not arisen,
phenomena abide just as they are in the nature of reality.

For the liberated yogin
there is neither permanence nor annihilation.
If the classes of sentient beings were to be destroyed,
omniscience would not appear.
Future Victors, and those of the past and present —
they are neither equal nor commensurate.
When the objects of knowledge are exhausted, those arise.

Māras are utterly vanquished and refuted,
whether spoken of or left unspoken.
For if sentient beings were to perish,
they would not be freed from the shell of suffering.

Just as from the burning of an iron ball
fire arises and then becomes cool,
while the iron remains permanently as it is —
so do yogins abide.

The habitual tendencies of the household of the aggregates
and the habitual tendencies of definite renunciation having been transformed,
those who are sages diligent in yoga
are thereby permanently liberated.

The consciousnesses are like waves
arising from the ocean of the all-base.

Stirred and flowing swiftly by the consciousnesses
of the nature of the five phenomena,
they are struck down by the elaborations of the defiled tendencies,
being without fixed abode, a form that is meaningful,
stirring in the domain of what is seen.

Knowing this, one turns back.

The protectors, having transformed what is unbearable and permanent,
enter into dense concentration.

Like the moon dwelling in density,
reflections appear beautiful always.

The dense aggregate is the all-base.

Mentation benefits it proximately.

Consciousness brings about understanding.

Form, karma, and the rest are its causes.

The five groups of consciousness,
equipped with sense faculties and inclined toward objects —

they grasp the manifold in mind.

The all-base is not itself an object-possessor.

Life is the all-base consciousness;
mentation abides excellently in warmth.

The consciousness of mentation is there too,
and the remainder abides in the five sense faculties as well.

Mind, mentation, and consciousness
abide distinctly in the midst of the aggregates.

Those connected with habitual tendencies and karma
arise from what was done before.

The karma born from attachment and craving
is what performs action.

Because those were done in the past,
karmic processes arise in a continual stream.

From body to body one passes on —
a transfer like the caterpillar moving onto a leaf.

Mind and mental factors together
proceed in an utterly unbroken stream.

And in fields of aggregates again,

and in the consciousness that probes existence,
they gather and completely arise,
because karmic actions arise abundantly.

When life force, warmth, and consciousness
abandon the body,
at that moment the body is left behind,
without sensation, like a log of wood.

Mind is the all-base consciousness;
the sense of self is what is called mentation.

That which grasps at objects —
that is called consciousness.

Mind is what accumulates karmas and so forth;
mentation is what comprehends them inwardly.
Consciousness discerns distinctly,
and the five perceive appearances and understand them.

Here ends the noble Condensed Array — the fourth and final fascicle.

The body is held by mind.

Mentation is desire that courses in streams.

Consciousness discerns distinctly;
those five are what cut through appearances.

Focusing on a cause, the various consciousnesses
arise, and others follow in succession.

Focusing on mentation, yet others
arise fully at the end in succession.

Having obtained mentation, still others
are produced by the qualities of the sense faculties.

Together with the five sense faculties,
consciousness is fully produced.

Together with formations and their causes —
like a reanimated corpse walking —
mirages are equal to form:
neither mistaken nor true.

This is selflessness and emptiness,
drawn along everywhere by existence.
All those that arise together

are always simultaneous with mentation.

Mental factors, what is called mentation,
arise together with consciousness.

Those five consciousnesses together
with the mental consciousness in possession —
sustained by grasping and nurtured by craving —
arise in an uninterrupted stream.

The all-base of all embodied beings
arises endowed with mind and mental factors.
Having obtained the all-base, they become its cause,
and from the cause they flourish and expand.
Minds throughout every stream and lineage
are ever expanding, one from the other.

This ground, manifold in aspect,
arises from the various consciousnesses.

The all-base, manifold and possessing form,
is the abode of the consciousnesses.

Endowed with the power of mutual causation,
the wheel of consciousness revolves.

Like waves arising from the ocean of the all-base —
the continuum of seeds and sprouts,
the stream of a river, uninterrupted
and arising without cessation —
yet distinctions and differences appear.

Likewise, the activity of consciousness
proceeds in an uninterrupted stream
and arises without cessation.

Endowed with three and born from three,
mind, mentation, and the various consciousnesses,
generated by habitual tendencies and craving
and by the delusion of one's own mind,
arise constantly, like waves.

Meditating thoroughly on the arising
of all phenomena, outer and inner,
and meditating also on the abode of the Sage,
one enters into dense meditative equipoise.

You, Vajrahṛdaya, along with
the fearless sons of the Victors and others —
the teaching that causes entry into density,
revealing all phenomena as phenomena too,
is what the Victors and their sons,
with a single skillful means, have thoroughly contemplated
and declared: this wondrous thing,
whose characteristic mark is beyond all analogy.

O Vajrahṛdaya the fearless one,
seated magnificently upon the lion throne
of Candragarbha of the varied jewels,
having cultivated with great wisdom —

Having been praised in the presence of the Victor's sons,
one meditates in full upon the ornament of density.
Having so meditated, one constantly
reveals the yoga of the yogin.

As for that teaching of Candravarman the Victor,
do not be negligent toward it.

The Blessed One of the glory of the moon
emanates many emanations,
and in the desirelessness of the desire realm
and also in the abode of form-bearing beings,
the Victor's sons surround him on all sides,
and the gods too pay homage before him.
This one who teaches the excellent in the proper manner
is the fearless ornament of density.

The supreme conduct of the yogin,
the practice of yoga in the excellent mode —
the meditative absorptions and blissful states
of individually self-knowing awareness,
experienced without recognizing the ultimate limit,
arising from the joy of yoga —
one rises from the bliss of yoga
and looks upon one another in mutual regard.
Whoever clearly perceives
this wholesome manner of yogic conduct —

all those who are established upon
the most excellent thrones of various fitting kinds
find it altogether wondrous.

The purposes of reflection, dhyāna, and contemplation,
and of the dhyānas in their aims —
all the fearless Victor's sons
reflect upon these and abide thoroughly in them.

Those who rest their view in equipoise
upon the ornament of density and upon the King,
bearing crowns upon their heads,
all adorned with the thirty-two excellent marks,
their limbs entirely depicted —
these have come from fields of tens of millions,
thoroughly free from any wavering,
all beautiful in fine garments and elegant dress,
practitioners of yoga with great power.

Look upon Vajrahṛdaya:
through conceptual thought and discursive analysis
he truly sees devotion to the Dharma.
Then, surveying all that, and casting his gaze
in the four directions,
he first let forth a gentle smile
and spoke in a voice soft and pleasing:

"O Victor's sons resting in equipoise,
hear from me about the domain of the yogin's yoga —
those matters in which one gifted with conceptuality becomes enraptured.
Whatever one contemplates, in whatever way,
the purposes of dhyāna and reflection —
secluded from desire and from evil,
accompanied by conceptual thought and by discursive analysis,
with the joy and bliss born of seclusion —
the first dhyāna arises.
In such a sequential fashion,
the fourth, the eighth, and likewise the tenth
are where those who speak of an abiding self

and those who possess dhyāna practice dhyāna.
Those of the śrāvaka vehicle
and likewise those of the pratyekabuddha vehicle
all practice dhyāna constantly.

Comprehending the individual defining characteristics
of phenomena and of grounds,
the aggregates, sense sources, and collections —
all of these are without self,
without agency and without wavering,
arisen from the conjunction of the three,
like a mechanical automaton that has risen up,
thoroughly abandoned by those who act with intention.

The Sage practices dhyāna externally.
Those who hold the view that looks to emptiness,
who are devoted to the characteristic marks of phenomena —
what is alive and meaningful is not a defining characteristic.
Those who are skilled in the selflessness of the aggregates
practice dhyāna in just this kind of dhyāna.

The dhyānas of the Tathāgata —
like divine substances, they refine merit and view.
The yogin and the Victor's sons
rest in equipoise and practice dhyāna constantly.

All of these are mind-only.
There is no bearer of characteristics nor any defining characteristic.
The aggregates are absent; the elements do not exist.
All phenomena are without defining characteristic.
When atoms are analyzed,
they do not abide in that way either.
What is examined by the production of conceptual thought —
entities such as earth and water and the rest —
those who do not know the intrinsic nature of entities
will conceptualize even that as a defining characteristic.

Color that is pleasant and color that is unpleasant,
and other appearances of color, likewise —
like a rainbow, like Indra's bow,

like multicolored clouds of many hues —
resembling the body of a buddha,
filling all the destinies of beings completely,
through what are called the expansive sense sources,
the elements too are fully analyzed."

The yogin who possesses form
always perceives form in the body too.
Whatever object one fixes upon in meditative equipoise,
that same object is what one focuses on as one arises.
Whatever one thinks about conceptually,
that is what becomes the object.
Without a yogin there is no yoga;
and so conceptual thinking of this kind
is itself the yoga of one who has yoga.
All the grounds of the all-base consciousness,
and the yoga of the Sage, abide in bliss.
Phenomena and their defining characteristics
are continually and fully understood,
and the distinctions of meditative equipoise
are thoroughly demonstrated to those who possess equipoise.

Through the analysis of the intrinsic nature of phenomena,
the mind of the yogin becomes confused,
arising from weakness of intelligence,
and one comes to grasp at phenomena and at self.
Those who teach phenomena
without being endowed with trustworthy scripture
waste themselves through conceptual fixation on characteristics
and give others indigestion while they themselves are nourished.
Without the characterized there are no characteristics;
they appear only on account of their being mixed together.

Sweet flavors dispel bile;
phlegm is countered by heat, sourness, and salt,
and the forms of undigested heat
are dispelled by salt and the like.
From the disturbance of bile and phlegm
fevers arise;

and in the body, as the domain of the embodied,
what assembles arises from wind.
For the destruction of all fevers,
the Sage compiled this summary:
the six members beginning with the bitter,
flesh, decoctions, and fluids —
each is destroyed according to its own specific characteristic,
and they are the full range of fevers of all embodied beings.

The various consciousnesses do not abide
separately from the all-base consciousness.
If there were a single intrinsic nature of phenomena,
or a single defining characteristic,
then phenomena and defining characteristics
would be without any dissimilarity of characteristic.
Substances taken together would not be able to dispel,
nor would anyone be cured.
Cure and thorough elimination —
this is what the wise perceive.
Otherwise, the all-base consciousness
abides in manifold aspects,
circling like an illusory deer —
this is what is examined by a yogin who strives.
Without marks, without a bearer of marks:
apart from the aggregates there is no possessor of aggregates;
apart from the major and minor limbs there is no possessor of limbs.
For the limbs, the world is not made by causes,
and even for results there are no causes.
The world is not an accumulation of atoms,
and it does not move to directions and places.
Those atoms, whether two or three,
do not initiate anything at all.
Since they encounter entities that actually exist,
all atoms are said to come together.
Then, the qualities having their own distinctions,
those qualities would constitute quality —
the world is not made, nor does it arise

by intrinsic nature, nor from conditions of the world.
The king of desire does not make it so in reality either.
Nor is it made by the third dharma.
The mind disturbed by habitual tendencies
is the dwelling place of manifold conceptual thought.
Residing in the region of the heart,
it is the all-base of all embodied beings,
and mind, mentation, and the various consciousnesses —
these beings have examined in diverse ways,
and all beings, without exception, are thoroughly oppressed by them,
abiding like an illusory deer.
Entering through the mere-mind,
in another way one fully transfers and abides:
the ground is to be called empty.
Mind abides in the mode of entities,
but objects such as clay vessels do not exist —
mind is like unfired clay.
The forms that exist on the earth,
the houses situated in the divine realms,
and whatever manifold appearances appear —
all of these are appearances of the all-base consciousness.
The all-base is hands everywhere,
is face, eyes, and head everywhere,
abiding perfectly in the grounds
simultaneously and sequentially.
The intoxicant intoxicates thoroughly;
whatever abides in whose heart —
that, in a dual mode with respect to it,
fills the entire body and abides fully.
There is nothing that is not empty, no entity whatsoever.
Just as a clay pot struck by a hammer —
the entity with respect to which something is to be destroyed,
that entity does not exist as something really there.
If there were an entity that is empty,
it would not be indestructible — it would be destroyed.
Whatever is to be destroyed and whatever does the destroying —

that is examined by conceptual thought.

A view of self as vast as Mount Meru
does not cause harm,
but a view of emptiness that harms
is the false conceit of superimposition.

The practitioner of Yogācāra (yogācāra)
should not apply emptiness to what is not its proper ground.
If it is applied where it does not belong,
nectar turns to poison.

Whatever views may exist —
however many there are among embodied beings —
it is in order to abandon those views
that the manner of emptiness is taught.

Yet even upon hearing the view of emptiness,
if the view of some people is not dissolved,
they are holders of a view that cannot be remedied —
like a patient abandoned by the physician.

Just as fire that burns fuel
does not remain once there is no more to burn,
so too when the fuel of views is burned,
the fire of emptiness also is extinguished.

Yet at the very moment views are extinguished,
true wisdom, like a fire, arises,
and burns away all afflictions.
Burned clean of afflictions, one is fully beautified.

Those mighty sages who are possessed of yoga,
endowed with this wisdom, in the conduct of the sage —
they proceed into the supreme abode of the Tathāgata,
the dense one, therein.

With the horn of a hare one cannot
be seen destroying mountains —
nor is any living creature killed by it,
nor even by such a tiny thing.

No one strings a bow with a hare's horn,
nor does anyone use it as a cooking spit.
No one, in any case, would employ
a barren woman's child for the work of the house.

Emptiness and impermanence
are always one with what is actual.
The natures of existence and non-existence too
have likewise become a single thing.

Even from the time of dwelling in the womb,
forms are ever striving toward dissolution.
Nowhere is there that without which form could exist,
nor is there that without form.

Their arising without distinction
is like the unobscured moon and its rays.
In just the same way, things and emptiness
arise together as one,
and when they are taken as separately distinct from each other,
they do not accomplish the purpose.

From the gathering of causes and conditions,
the yogin accomplishes his activity.
This body has no self —
it is just like a walking corpse or an automaton,
bound by the cord of craving,
drawn along by sense objects.

The divine substance called emptiness is taught
to purify all views.
The view of emptiness that transcends the extreme —
the Victors have declared that it is the viewless view.

Purifying the view of emptiness
in order to dissolve both existence and non-existence —
the wise one in meditative equipoise,
the yogin, should always cultivate this.

Grass, trees, and creepers
are made into ingredients by the master illusionist,
and by means of mantras made into

whatever material form is desired.

Form, appearance, mental engagement,
craving, and the eyes are made into ingredients,
and visual consciousness, like an illusion,
shimmers like a mirage.

It does not come from any particular object's domain,
nor does it go to other objects.

Regarding the arising of such consciousness,
one should not examine it as existing or not existing.

A mass of hair, a donkey's horn,
a barren woman's child, a mirage,
a gandharva city, and dreams —
they are known by name but do not exist.

Tigers, leopards, bears,
horse-mules, donkeys, dogs,
yaks, otters, and tortoises —
these do not have horns.

Why then does one who strives with enthusiasm among the sages
not investigate those,
but instead undertake investigation of a donkey's horn?
What purpose would establishing that serve?

What the wise one has indicated is worthy of investigation —
those things should be examined without delay.

The conceptualizing ones in saṃsāra
are like the foolish, the blind, the lame.

Within them there is no liberating wisdom,
nor is there any domain of individual self-knowing awareness.
What can conceptual thought accomplish
with respect to states that are made by another?

One fully discerns what abides in density,
investigates it, and attains virtue.
The yogi in meditative equipoise
perceives things as they are in abiding there.

The pride-free ones who dwell in the divine realms,
and the moon, planets, and so forth —
those that are thoroughly moved by the wind
abide on Mount Meru and move about it.

Likewise the seven consciousnesses,
endowed with their habitual tendencies,
together with the all-base consciousness (ālayavijñāna), which holds all seeds
—
they move about in dependence upon it.

Just as all things depend upon the earth
and whatever grows from the ground arises from it,
so it is the abode of all sentient beings,
distinguished as the source of all arising.

Likewise the all-base consciousness
is the abode of all the consciousnesses.
Endowed with mind and the mental factors born from mind,
it arises fully, like waves on water.

Just as the feathers of a peacock
are of many lights and colors,
and crested ones sport their plumage
with the peachen and play at the tips of their feathers,
so too the all-base consciousness abides like an ocean
bearing many seeds.
It is the ground of all phenomena
and is ever seen by the yogin.

Just as an ocean, though it is to be filled
by rivers day by day,
the rivers flow without ceasing
and do not bring the ocean to overflow —
likewise the all-base consciousness,
deep and abiding like a great lake,
is filled continually, day by day,
by the rivers of habitual tendencies from the other consciousnesses.

Just as a jewel-bearing earth
benefits all in various ways,
and all sentient beings live in reliance upon it,

taking their sustenance from its actual qualities —
likewise the all-base consciousness
arises together with conceptual thoughts.
When it increases saṃsāra in this way,
but when transformed, it is the Tathāgata.

The Tathāgata, possessed of the ten powers,
excellent and pure in conduct,
fully arisen from the tenth ground,
has entered the stage of the Sugata (the Well-Gone One, the Buddha).

Abiding supremely at the true limit,
manifesting in all manner of forms for the diverse classes of sentient beings,
arising without destruction —
this is like the ground free of conceptual thought.

The form of the many flowers in spring
is pleasing to humans and birds alike.
Likewise the mind that takes up many and various things
is made intoxicatingly pleasant by the sage's wisdom.

Just as the sons of the Victors who are skilled in meaning
are not arisen from the elements —
those who hold the view of non-existence are like that:
they strive in wrong speech,
speaking what is discordant with the Dharma, given to slander,
holding wrong views with a forked tongue.
That which abides in a manner other than it appears
they present as though it were otherwise.

Just as a magical man
might display many and various fruits and flowers —
though those fruits and flowers are not there —
by means of mantras and enchanting illusions, pleasing to the eye,
so too what abides in the world in one manner
is presented as though it were another.

The Victors and the sons of the Victors
are all skilled in the meditation-object of skillful means.
Whatever and however much they have taught
in other ways of teaching —

all of that has been taught by the Sugata, skilled in yoga,
within the adornment of the teaching of density.

They taught the eighteen elements and the twelve sense bases;
and the person threaded on the string of mind
wanders throughout all sentient beings.

The collection of the eight consciousnesses,
together with the elements, sense bases, and aggregates,
bound by the thread of mind,
roams from body to body.

This is the person of the migrations,
taught for the sake of all beings.

The person of all embodied ones
does not arise from the elements alone —
the six elements together are the person,
and likewise the twelve sense bases,
with mind moving through the eighteen.
This is called the sovereign ruler.

The sovereign ruler with his many palaces,
the jewel-encrusted city,
the pride-free ones of Tuṣita (Joyful Heaven) and the rest —
even of the place of the nāgas the same is taught.

At Vajrāsana, the sovereign seat,
the fearless sons of the Victor
joyously cry out "Excellent! Excellent!"
and all prostrate with their heads bowed.

The sage endowed with yoga practice and —

The Victors and the sons of the Victors,
the pure lands and those who dwell within them,
the sons of the Victors dwelling in divine realms,
the sovereign lords of yoga and the yogins,
the lords of wisdom, the greatly magical,
and the assembled goddesses who wield sovereignty —
all abide with palms joined in reverence,
gazing upon one another,

and speak to the sons of the Victors:

"The being who is the divine substance of wandering existence,
sitting in stillness, having abandoned the claim of self —
the person of all those endowed with the capacity for discipline,
you, the supreme chief among the capable, have taught.
By what has passed and what is present now,
by what was done before and what was not done, what has been attained —
this the former sons of the Victors have taught:
the person of the six elements is wholesome.

Just as the tracks of birds in the sky
are established in no fixed form,
so the elements belonging to a mind endowed with aggregates
have been fully taught along with their logical justification.

Just as fire arising from wood
holds its flame in the sky above,
finds nothing else to burn,
and when the wind ceases it burns no more —
so too, the establishing of the bird's track:
it does not appear as something remaining in the sky.
The person who revolves in the wheel of saṃsāra
is the one who appears.

Birds do not travel by feet alone;
they move by the power of their wings.
What is comparable to the track of the bird
is fully taught by way of the person.

To teach the person of karma
is to say that saṃsāric beings revolve forever,
experiencing pleasure and suffering:
actions that have been performed are never wasted.

Just as the labor of farmers
never fails to produce its fruit,
those who have their aim do not
wait in vain for something further to arrive.

The person who is the divine substance of wandering existence
teaches yoga to the yogin.

From within the body of one who has a body, through the field,
that one performs wholesome actions.

Seeing the abodes of happiness in this life and the next,
and the dwelling place of those established in divine realms,
one always performs the merit
that becomes the cause for awakening from saṃsāra.

Liberation and all the perfections,
and the entire domain of a buddha's meditation —
if the person of wandering existence did not exist,
all of these would become fruitless.

All the happiness of the gods,
the fruit belonging to those who wield sovereignty,
and the yogins capable of seeing suchness —
these too would cease to exist.

Karma and the fruit of karma are seen;
actions are not without purpose.
The continuity of the path for the realms of Avīci
and for the gods at the extreme of what is without pause
also exists.

If that person of wandering existence exists,
one revolves through the wheel of craving.
When freed from that revolving, there is liberation —
this the weak-minded do not know.

If the person who enters does not exist,
then even a barren woman's child would walk abroad,
the horn of an ass would become sharp,
and oil would arise from sand.

The inner and outer grounds
arise through their mutual force;
wherever beings go,
they are accompanied by those very things.

The assembled gods and daughters of gods,
the sovereign sons of the Victors,

the king of accomplished gandharvas (celestial musicians),
and the assembled consorts of mantra-holders —
all make offering and supplicate
the sons of the Vajra Essence, together with those worthy
of being venerated as capable sages,
and say: "All is excellent, excellent!"

The way of Dharma, free from deterioration,
adorned with causes and examples,
which vanquishes the objections of opponents —
this, O great hero, you have taught.

Presenting the covered, the held, the decisive, and the cutting,
and showing the qualities of one's own side —
please, O one endowed with wisdom, teach it,
and these wandering beings will listen.

Let all the sons of the Victors, however many,
and all the kings of the gods hear:
the inconceivably difficult, immeasurable cause,
beyond analysis, devoid of conceptual apprehension —
the flower of cause and example,
the wholesome capability of the yogins —
the ornament of the dense will be explained.

This teaches yoga to the Sage. That ornament of the dense is manifold — the
supreme abode of the buddhas of the Sage who practices in the dense, the
most excellent of all Sages.

To the tree of the Sage upon the earth, Vajragarbha spoke again: "O tree, you
too must come to know the very actuality of phenomena. The intrinsic nature
of things — whether things are empty in actuality or permanent — one who
holds such a view as this: the yoga of the Sage does not go astray. By realizing
the single phenomenon of Dharma, one knows it manifestly as Dharma. The
intrinsic nature of all things, too, becomes known through a single thing. Just
as one perceives in full the curd that has been churned, at the tip of a finger,
so too the intrinsic nature of all things becomes known through a single thing.
Emptiness is the absence of things as things; things do not exist as things.
These are all aspects of the all-base — the aspects of the all-base
consciousness that is emptiness."

The fearless son of the Victors, the tree, spoke to Vajragarbha: "How do the elements (dhātu) of those who have bodies become mind-only? The great elements serving as cause — what are they like, arising from arising? How do the elements — fluid, hot, and solid — come to arise?"

The son of the Victors, Vajragarbha, having heard the words of the lord of the tree, said: "O kinnara (semi-divine being), you are good! You are indeed good, good again! The one who has asked what brings delight — the supreme essence of the yogin — how the elements arise for an embodied being born of the mind: because of this, that is to be explained as wholesome to the son of the Victors who wields sovereignty. Therefore, O lord of the kinnaras, hear from me, your lute-teacher. Just as the lord of the kinnaras, you, together with many kinnaras and men — the many varied ones, free of pride — fare forth splendidly from the sky, and in the assembly-retinue of the śrāvakas of the Victors, having taken up the melodious sounds of the lute, say to one another: 'Look, O Sage, O tree!' — while among the many varied, prideless ones, playing together with the kinnaras, when the lute adorned with vaidūrya is being carried and moves through the sky, the lute is exceedingly pleasing and melodious, its tones thoroughly refined — when the lord of the kinnaras takes it up, the śrāvakas too begin to dance. Seeing those śrāvakas in that state, the sons of the Victors, and the noble Kāśyapa of excellent yoga, spoke to the divine crown: 'By broadcasting the lute-sound, the melody free of conceptual thought, why has freedom from attachment arisen? Show this to us, O Kāśyapa.'

"O son of the Victors, as mighty as a storm-wind from the sky, like wild deer, those śrāvakas with wavering minds — stained with the filth of habitual tendencies, afflicted by the arising of afflictions and conceptual thought — having attained the true body of a buddha, all the filth of habitual tendencies fully purified, cleansed completely by the twofold selflessness, and free of the stain of cognitive obscuration, they shall become fully Tathāgatas, utterly transformed from the mind-element. You, possessing great sovereignty and subtle objects, with vast knowledge and skilled in classical learning, you, O sovereign, dwell in the mark of the classical learning that transcends the world. The classical learning of the kinnaras too is the excellent yoga of the Tathāgatas. Train in the defining marks of the grounds and dwell like the moon. You, sovereign of the kinnaras, adorn innumerable grounds and buddha-fields. Since you are so magnificently adorned, a being born of the mind of the element asks me in the midst of the assembly, where the endowed

Sage holds sovereignty, through the son: 'Listen all together, with equanimous mind in meditative equipoise. Concerning the elements — what they are, in what manner, how — for the being known as mind, I shall teach the manner in which they arise from their causes.'

Water brings forth all that is moist. Heat is fire; solidity is earth. The activities such as upward movement and the rest are all initiated by the element of wind. The boundaries of form and the rest are all initiated by space. The various consciousnesses, each with their respective objects, are thoroughly generated by habitual tendencies. Through the junctures of existence and through the eyes, those that create the gateways of birth are the aggregate of form and the rest. The king has many defining marks. Dwelling in the magnificent, sovereign palace where precious jewels of every kind reside, the great one endowed with yoga, who holds power, is attended upon by the sons of the Victors, who press forward before him. Rising from their own seats, and bowing down again and again, they make offering with the highest offering to the Vajra Essence in due order. Covered above with a net of jewels, they make petition again and again: "Excellent, excellent — truly and completely excellent! Abiding supremely in what is wholesome, having found the way of the cloud of Dharma, supremely residing on the buddha grounds, you, sovereign son of the Victors, who wield command, have supremely revealed the buddha-fields." The king together with the goddesses then made further offerings, and said: "O great one endowed with yoga — excellent, excellent! O fearless Vajra Essence, because you have taught us this Dharma of the divine substance of the Tathāgata, we make it thoroughly auspicious and pure with precious jewels of every kind. The mighty noble one Avalokiteśvara, Mahāmati, Maitreya, Akṣayamati the greatly powerful, Mañjuśrī the Emanating, the Lord of Yoga with the crown of divinity, the power-holding one Drugma Lodrö, the King Lord of Dhāraṇī, Ratnacūḍā the greatly miraculous, the one who sees truly and as it is, the foremost among equals and the holder of beings, the yoga master the great one of yoga, the one who reveals the mind to yogins, the mighty one who accomplishes the purpose of all, the sons of the mighty fearless ones — these and many others besides, the great emanating sons of the Victors, all rose from their own seats, looked one at another, and spoke to the Vajra Essence: 'Establish the way of the Dharma with firmness. You have been blessed by the sovereign power of the Victors. You are worshipped supremely by the sons of the Victors. All mastery of the defining marks of the grounds resides entirely in you. Those who entreat you are all the greatly

powerful sons of the Victors, the yogins, the lords of yoga, and all the women who hold mantra. The Victors and the sons of the Victors, the foundation of wonder for all worlds — taught and read about by all the sūtras, free of stain, surpassing those that are expounded and recited — for the sake of revealing this ornament of density, you, lord of yoga, be bold! Abandoning what is expressed by emanation, and likewise through speech and through emanation — the undefiled dharmadhātu (basic space of phenomena), the domain of individually self-knowing experience — be at ease in the Dharma of the divine substance that is seen: reveal that to the noble ones. Reveal the dharmadhātu that is applied to all the remaining aggregates without exception. Also reveal the assembly of meditative absorptions and dhāraṇīs, liberations, masteries, and the tenfold wish-fulfilling body. The inconceivable of the buddhas and the ornament of the fields of the protectors — reveal also the subtle forms of the Victors and their sons, as fine as dust-motes, as fine as a hundredth part of a hair-tip, O son of the Victors. Free from exposition, recitation, and mental elaboration, and utterly removed from verbal expression — for the sake of going to that supreme, dense pure field, may the yoga-expert, like a lion, and the mighty one, having gazed upon all of these, teach supremely to all the assemblies of beings the way of Dharma that is beyond investigation and free from investigation.' When the power of the intellect is examined in its entirety, yogins who are able to hear the way of the Dharma according to the former textual tradition —"

In the voice of Brahmā, in melodious song,
in the call of the kalaviṅka bird,
with a broad and wonderful tongue, supremely pleasing,
the vajra-essence teaches excellently.

Bearing the body of a lion — chest, torso, and frame —
adorned with the thirty-two major marks
and the excellent minor marks,
the vajra-essence displays that body supremely.

Because of mastery in the sound of the kiṃkā,
through the celebrated defining marks of sound,
that son of the Victors teaches excellently,
in brief, the twofold nature of that.

The pure, transparent melody and so forth,
the sound that is visible and far-reaching,

harmonious as the gandharva and fitting —
the son of the Victors teaches all of this excellently.

With the tones of ṛṣabha, dhaivata,
ṣaḍja, and keśī — these five —
the voice endowed with defining marks,
the Sage, supremely, speaks forth in melody.

Words that are unhurried and never faltering,
a sound that is profound and pleasing —
to the expert in marks (lakṣaṇa) and to the gandharvas
it brings equal delight.

Words endowed with the qualities of speech,
uttered by the vajra-essence,
arise as though spontaneously accomplished,
coming forth like an emanation.

The vajra-essence, son of the Sage,
without uttering anything at all,
yet the sound of all the marks with their branches
manifestly arises in each of the branches.

From the eyebrows, the forehead, the crown of the head,
the shoulders, the tip of the nose, and the chin,
the modes of the Dharma are displayed excellently,
and the sounds of virtue arise.

The vajra-essence of the Sage —
born of excellent aspiration —
like the king of geese on a lake,
all the sons of the Victors gather from every direction.

In the glorious palace of sovereign sway,
all like jewels of form,
the great hero, the vajra-essence,
shines with beauty, and all gaze upon him.

As the lord of stars, that star,
shines beautifully amidst the planets,
so the vajra-essence, the yogin,
shines beautifully on the supreme seat.

Just as between the lord of stars
and the light of the moon there is no distinction,
so between the vajra-essence
and the Victors there is no distinction.

The mighty son of the Victors
who sees the meaning of reality as it truly is,
the yogin and the supreme Sage,
dwelling on the path of yogic practice —

rising gracefully from his seat
and gazing upon all the sons of the Victors,
he spoke these excellent words:

"How wonderful! The Great Vehicle's path
is the inconceivable domain of the buddhas.
Abiding in it, the sons of the Victors
and the Victors teach the inconceivable.

The Victors dwelling in fields numbered in the tens of millions,
together with all those sons of the Victors —
stainless, inconceivable phenomena,
through their intention, are worthy of homage.

The excellent mode of the Great Vehicle
is supremely subtle and rare.

The supreme mode that has become otherwise
is not the domain of conceptual thought.

It distinguishes intrinsic natures (svabhāva)
within the domain of the eight consciousnesses.
And because selflessness distinguishes likewise
among all five,

that which is propelled by habitual tendencies (vāsanā) and conceptual
elaborations (prapañca),
abiding for a long time in continued acquisition,
together with mind and mental factors,
arises fully from the consciousnesses.

Seeing this in the manner of divine substances
becomes thoroughly purified, like gold.

Those who abide in the pure family

will become of the buddha family.

Having obtained the family of the Tathāgata's divine substance,
abandoning the śrāvakas who sit in the corner,
one will proceed to the supreme buddha-field,
going there likewise into its dense array.

What, then, is the domain of this meditative absorption (samādhi)?
And what is the name of this meditative absorption?
In order that the vajra-essence may attain it,
teach this excellent mode.

Having paid homage at the two feet of the vajra-essence,
and with the Sages having prostrated,
please explain to the fearless vajra-essence
through the vajra-mind.

What is the domain of this meditative absorption?
And what is the name of this meditative absorption?"

"You, the Victor's son, should explain
the nature of this and what it rests upon.
All the Victor's sons wish to hear it,
and I, the sovereign one, am likewise so.

The fearless vajra-essence,
along with all those gathered in the retinue,
should listen with unwavering attention
to the inconceivable nature of this,
the power and strength of the Victor's sons,
all the powers held in mind —
having considered whether they are capable or not,
and having seen those whose minds hold the power —
let all the Victor's sons, empowered as they are,
listen without wavering.

This excellent mode of transformation
should be proclaimed in the realm of the sovereign gods
and to the Sages.

This is the domain of the meditative absorption of the luminous Great Vehicle.
Dwelling in it, the Victor's sons

excellently teach the virtuous mode.
They clearly see buddha-fields in the countless billions;
those Protectors are present there just as they are.
Those who have reached the extreme limit of particles
reveal their own faces there.
He proclaimed: 'Excellent! Excellent!'
This is the path adorned with supreme yoga.
Through this path, all of us,
having attained sovereign mastery over meditative absorption,
become undefiled buddhas.

Whatever buddhas are born through meditative absorption —
those who contemplate the refined mind
of the meditative absorption of the luminous Great Vehicle,
who dwell in that, along with the Victor's sons,
and who, with immeasurable activity of buddhas,
through countless emanations,
with the self-knowing domain of individual self-awareness —
the buddhas they see in meditative absorption
are as numerous as the most subtle particles.
The mode of individual self-knowing,
that in which buddhas dwell —
this dharma is without marks,
free of sound and form.
Names are produced by marks,
and marks arise from conditions;
they are born from two kinds of conceptual thought.
The suchness of phenomena —
whoever truly sees it,
their wisdom rightly illumines it.
Intrinsic nature under investigation is a name,
and marks arise dependent on another.
Where name and mark are absent,
the supreme reality of intrinsic nature
is present everywhere throughout the entire body.
That is why the all-base consciousness arises from it,
dwelling in the hermitage of habitual tendencies,

veiled by the mental faculty's appropriation.
Through the activity of mental consciousness,
the mind has expanded in all directions.
The five object-bearing consciousnesses
arise and then turn back again.
The objects of the five consciousnesses,
dwelling in the embodied beings like sentient beings,
arise fully like the waves of a river
from what is known as the all-base consciousness.
Consciousness dwelling in the ocean of the all-base,
those obscured by habitual tendencies,
set in motion by the wind of objects —
they flow in an unbroken stream.

Those buddhas and Victor's sons
skilled in selflessness of phenomena (dharmanairātmya)
attain the state of the Sugata,
fully awaken, and teach the Dharma.

Those who clearly discern and see
the selflessness of the aggregates and of the person (pudgalanairātmya),
without dismantling the actual existence of phenomena,
those śrāvakas come to realization.

The Victor's sons cultivate
mastery in both kinds of selflessness.
Through thorough cultivation and abandonment,
in accordance with the mode described, they reach the real limit.
Experiencing the bliss of the real limit,
those sons who lack compassion
and who have severed the continual service to sentient beings —
they do not attain buddhahood.

Oh, this immeasurable gnosis —
it brings forth the happiness of sentient beings!
Knowing this, the Victors and the Victor's sons
teach the mode to those of lesser intellect.

Just as lotuses bearing marks of virtue,
arising from the mud,

are the cause of the close enjoyment of the Sages and the gods —
so likewise the Victor's sons arising
from the swamp-lake of saṃsāra
excellently find spotless buddhahood
and become pleasing to the gods.

Bodhisattvas stand out distinctly
among humans and gods alike
as the supreme herd-leaders of kings,
and distinctly so as wheel-turning sovereigns.
So too it is with the lords who dwell in the realm of the gods
and with the gandharvas.

Those possessed of the qualities of the Great Vehicle —"
embodied beings always obtain. Therefore, let the Victor's sons
apply themselves diligently to the Great Vehicle,
and in due course they will come
to the supreme abode of the Sugatas
and to the state of kings as well.

All afflicted phenomena in their entirety,
and all that exists as what has been purified —
these are forever, for all embodied beings,
the arising of the all-base at the ground.

Whether the universal and causes together,
or else the universal together with the faculties,
or the principal together with conditions and causes —
these accomplish the world completely.
But to speak of a distinguished cause
as something that could arise from anywhere —
without a cause, one's very self would cease to exist,
and there would be neither act to be done nor agent doing it.

It is not different from what is purified.
The all-base does not become something other.
If the all-base were other than the purified,
the all-base would not be permanent.
Being without beginning, without destruction, it is permanent —
this is the abandonment of the four extremes.

The tathāgatagarbha (buddha-nature) —
it is also known by the name "emanated wisdom."
Their essences are not mutually different.
It abides just like a finger-ring.

The various grounds are the all-base,
and the virtue of the Sugata's essence is likewise.
Regarding that essence, the Teacher, the Tathāgata,
used the term "all-base" to teach.
That the essence has been proclaimed as the all-base
is not understood by those of lesser intellect.

When a skilled goldsmith fashions a finger-ring
from refined, pure gold,
it is beautifully adorned upon the fingers.
Its distinguishing characteristic is its difference in form,
and though it is called "a finger-ring,"
the master craftsman has transformed it through his work,
while the gold itself abides as the underlying form.

The domain of mind and consciousness
belonging to the yogin who perceives phenomena —
upon attaining the seventh ground (bhūmi),
it turns away even from what arises from the elements.
The individual direct vision
of the noble one who sees phenomena,
together with the excellence of the universal and the self —
all of this cannot be expressed in words.

Whatever objects exist in however great a number,
appearing in various ways as the domain of mind and consciousness —
those too are consciousness; there is no external object.

The mind appears directly in two aspects:
as the apprehended and as the apprehender.
There is no object whatsoever —
not a clay pot, not a woolen cloth, none of these.

Just as, with Mount Meru as their support,
the host of sun, moon, and planets
revolve without ceasing, forever —
so likewise upon the all-base consciousness,

the domain of the pure and noble
blazes on forever like gold.

What is proclaimed as the essence of the all-base
is not the domain of conceptual mind.
Intrinsic natures that are imputed
cannot be known through conceptual thought.
But the thoroughly established nature
is always seen by the mighty yogin.

The object-possessing consciousness of mentation is, for the deluded, a thing that binds — like a mirage, like a mass of echoes — but the noble ones behold it stainlessly.

Here ends the sūtra, with all its contents, from the extensive ornament of twelve thousand.

Translator's Notes

- The title transliterates the Sanskrit Ārya Ghanavyūha Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra, which in Tibetan is rendered as "The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the Dense Array of Ornaments." Ghanavyūha literally means "dense array" or "thick arrangement," here referring to the richly ornamented buddha-field that is the sūtra's setting.

The phrase rendered "Subduer of the Views of All Obstructors" translates the name Mur-'dug-byed-pa-thams-cad-kyi-gzhung-rnam-par-'joms-pa. The term mur-'dug is unusual; it likely refers to antagonists or obstructors in a general sense, and the bodhisattva's name means he defeats or destroys their positions. This is retained as best interpretive rendering.

The final sentence — that the dense buddha-field is free of light, planets, and the moon — is the beginning of a doctrinal description of that field's distinctive qualities, and the passage appears to continue beyond what is given here.

- The compound "ཁྲ་མདོག་ལྗང་བུ་རྒྱུ་འཕྲུལ་པའི་སྤྲེལ་པོ་" literally means "dark-headed grain" and likely refers to a specific dark-colored seed used as a color simile; rendered descriptively. The list of color-similes is a standard enumerative passage in this genre of sūtra literature describing the luminous qualities of bodies born in the pure field. The phrase "ལྷན་པོ་ལྡན་པའི་ལྟོ་སྐྱོད་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་" (magical legs of supernormal power) renders the standard term for the four bases of supernormal power (*rddhipāda*), here used in abbreviated form. The final sentence is syntactically incomplete in the Tibetan as given, ending mid-enumeration; the translation renders it accordingly.
- The name rendered "Śughādhārin" translates the Tibetan Shugs 'dzin, meaning "Holder of Force" or "Sustainer of Momentum." This is likely a bodhisattva figure specific to this sūtra context; the Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain. The passage describing his journey through buddha-fields and failure to reach the boundary of the buddhas' uṣṇīṣa and voice-maṇḍala is a classic motif illustrating the inconceivable extent of buddha qualities, paralleling the

Śūramgamasamādhi and similar sūtras.

- The passage listing the various wrong views whose minds are to be "turned back" is syntactically very dense in the Tibetan, with long chains of relative clauses and partially elliptical constructions. The rendering follows the most plausible grammatical parsing, but the precise scope of several sub-clauses is genuinely ambiguous. In particular, the phrase rendered "those who abide alongside those who have fallen into views, with minds attached to the doctrines of others" involves an unusual construction and the referents of the paired groups are not entirely clear from the Tibetan alone.

The verse portion presents its own difficulties. The line rendered "the cause that is the five consciousnesses and so on" reads literally "from the cause of the five consciousnesses and so on," and the exact referent of "five aspects of what is to be known" (五所知相) is not specified in this passage; it likely refers to the five buddha-wisdoms (pañcañāna) but is left as rendered to avoid over-interpretation.

The epithet "good illusionist" (सुप्रमादुर्लभः) appears to be a proper name or epithet of a specific bodhisattva interlocutor, possibly Sunetra or a comparable figure; it is translated descriptively in the absence of a confirmed Sanskrit equivalent in this context.

- The phrase rendered "the blameless dharma" translates "chos skyon med pa," which could also be read as "the faultless Dharma" in apposition to the dharmadhātu; the sense is that both the dharmadhātu and this blameless quality of phenomena abide unchangingly regardless of whether buddhas appear. The final sentence breaks off mid-thought; this reflects the passage as given, which ends at a transition point in the argument.
- The phrase rendered "like a fire whose iron fuel has been entirely consumed" translates a simile for nirvāṇa drawn from the image of smelting iron, a classical Indian figure suggesting total extinction without remainder. The standard simile for nirvāṇa is a fire going out, but "iron fuel" specifies the analogy more precisely here.

The line "lords of the vajra ground" renders a phrase about those who have sovereignty over the vajra ground, i.e., bodhisattvas at the highest stages where the vajra-like samādhi is operative; this is a recognized technical usage.

The phrase translated "like a mantra-adept who has accomplished the highest ritual of anointing at the ultimate end" is genuinely difficult. The Tibetan suggests a sorcerer or mantra-practitioner who has completed a final empowerment or consecration rite — the point being that the buddha's appearance is not like such a fixed, concluded ritual presence but is dynamically invisible and pervasive.

- The passage is metrically dense and, in several verses, syntactically compressed to the point of ambiguity, particularly the sequence involving "the dense realm" (Tib. *stug po*). This term, which likely renders a Sanskrit original such as *ghana* or *ghanāvyūha*, refers to a dense or compact buddha-field, and the imagery of emanation bodies abiding and passing away within it in an instant is a recognizable Mahāyāna and early Vajrayāna cosmological motif; the rendering "dense realm" is consistent throughout.

The "five buddhas" enumeration in this passage is unusual: the text lists a causal virtuous buddha, the root as wisdom, the Victor of the world, the perfectly complete buddha, and then the emanation Victors — this does not correspond neatly to the standard five buddha-family schema and may reflect an early or non-standard classification; no attempt has been made to normalize it.

The final lines trail off mid-verse in the supplied Tibetan, which itself ends incompletely with the dream-forms simile; the translation reflects the text as given without supplying what is missing.

The phrase rendered "the eight minds" refers to the standard Yogācāra enumeration: the five sense consciousnesses, the mental consciousness, the afflicted mentation (klišṭāmanas), and the all-base consciousness — eight in total.

"Vajrahṛdaya" renders rdo rje snying po, meaning "Vajra Essence" or "Vajra Heart." In the preceding passage this figure was called "the vajra essence, refuge and protector," and the name is now used as a speaker designation. It is uncertain whether this is a proper name of a bodhisattva interlocutor or an epithet.

- The phrase rendered "the dense realm" throughout translates Tib. stug po, which refers to the Ghanavyūha realm, the realm of dense array or dense adornment, a pure-land-like sphere associated with the culmination of the bodhisattva path in certain tantric and Yogācāra-inflected texts. This is a significant technical term and the rendering as "the dense realm" is intentional to preserve the doctrinal specificity.

The line "while those seated in corners whisper it about quietly" renders mur 'dug rnam kyis jir rjod bzhin, which is idiomatically and syntactically difficult. The image seems to be of those on the margins or in hidden places murmuring quietly, contrasted with the lion's roar just mentioned. This reading is not certain but is contextually reasonable.

The ten kings and the ten aspects in the final stanza likely refer to the ten bodhisattva grounds and their associated sovereignties; the "ten wish-fulfilling aspects" at the close almost certainly refers to the tenfold sovereignty of the ten grounds.

- The passage enumerates a complex doctrinal schema, most likely from a Yogācāra or early Vijñānavāda śāstra setting. The section on "the eight types of individual" refers to the eight noble individuals of the Foundational Vehicle typology: the stream-enterer and their fruit, once-returner and fruit, non-returner and fruit, arhat path and fruit. The subsequent enumeration elaborates sub-types of non-returner and arhat in traditional Abhidharma fashion.

The phrase rendered "the three contacts" is uncertain in its specific technical referent; in context it likely points to the three kinds of coming-together of sense faculty, object, and consciousness that produce contact, with the argument here being soteriological.

"Fatherly protector" for བཅུ་འཇུག་པོ་ is a compound combining "father" and "protector or refuge"; it is an epithet of the Buddha as both protector and father of beings.

The closing line "whatever has passed — that has ceased" reads as a doctrinal summation of impermanence applied to mental aggregates.

- The phrase rendered "the dense" throughout translates a term referring to Ghanavyūha, the dense array or closely arrayed pure land associated with Samantabhadra and the culmination of the bodhisattva path. The Tibetan stug po and stug po'i dkyil carry this technical sense, which is why "the dense" and "the heart of the dense" are used rather than a more generic rendering.

The "ten gnoses of the king" is a doctrinal enumeration specific to this text's context. The ten items listed shortly after in the verse — knowledge that follows phenomena, knowledge of others' minds, knowledge of conventional reality, knowledge that assembles suffering, knowledge born of cessation and the path, knowledge of purification, and knowledge of non-arising — do not add up straightforwardly to ten as preserved in the extant verse, suggesting either a lacuna or compression in the transmitted Tibetan.

The lineage names Śākunta, Ikṣvāku, and Soma are royal dynasties of ancient India invoked here to honor the king's noble descent. Ikṣvāku is the solar lineage from which the Śākya clan descends; Soma is the lunar lineage.

The passage "breathing like a hollow reed, moving like a sheep, going and coming with half the body like a young deer" describes meditative comportment or subtle-body movement in advanced yogic states. The imagery is cryptic and may be specific to this text's contemplative tradition.

- The phrase rendered "dense gathering" and "the dense one" translates a term that in context refers to Ghanavyūha, the "dense array" pure realm associated with the buddha Vairocana in Yogācāra-inflected literature. The Tibetan "stug po" is a standard rendering of "ghana" or "ghanavyūha." Naming it plainly as a realm name (Ghanavyūha) rather than a descriptive phrase would be equally defensible, but since the text itself uses it both descriptively and as a proper name, the descriptive translation is retained here for the listener's comprehension.

The closing lines of the passage are syntactically incomplete; the text breaks off mid-verse with "dance, laughter, and play," indicating the passage continues beyond the excerpt provided.

- The phrase "cities of the gandharvas" renders a classical Indian image for mirages or illusory appearances; the gandharvas are semi-divine fragrance-feeding beings, and their "city" (gandharvanagara) is a standard metaphor for something seen yet unreal.

The term rendered "Dense One" and "Dense Ornament" throughout refers to the Ghanavyūha pure land and its associated sūtra, a field associated with Vairocana in Yogācāra and Tathāgatagarbha literature.

The list of sūtras named includes the Daśabhūmika, the Gaṇḍavyūha, a sūtra of tree-display (possibly the Vṛkṣa-sūtra or a related title), the Śrīmālādevīsiṃhanāda, the Vairocana-sūtra, and a text associated with the name "Māyāśrī." Some of these identifications carry a degree of uncertainty, but the passage is clearly cataloguing well-known Mahāyāna sūtras as having emerged from the Ghanavyūha.

The final verse passage shifts from prose-style doctrinal exposition into ornate poetry comparing the buddha's form to natural radiances; the translation renders this as verse to match the original cadence.

- The term rendered "aṇḍa-stones" translates the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit aṇḍa, likely referring to egg-shaped or spherical gems used as crown ornaments; the precise identification is uncertain but a decorative jewel context is clear.

The phrase "lords who walk by hand" in the uṣṇīṣa simile is obscure; it may refer to those who travel on all fours (animals) or, alternatively, to beings moving prostrate or in supplication, with the image of loosening or releasing the crown of the head. The exact comparison intended remains uncertain.

The "feet of miraculous power" renders rdzu 'phrul rkang pa, the standard Tibetan for the four bases of miraculous power (Skt. ṛddhipāda); the verse enumeration here is compressed and may draw on a longer prose exposition.

- The phrase rendered "king accomplished like a gandharva's achievement" translates "𑖀𑖩𑖪𑖫𑖬𑖭𑖮𑖯𑖰𑖱𑖲𑖳𑖴𑖵𑖶𑖷𑖸𑖹𑖺𑖻𑖼𑖽𑖾𑗀𑖿𑗁𑗂𑗃𑗄𑗅𑗆𑗇𑗈𑗉𑗊𑗋𑗌𑗍𑗎𑗏𑗐𑗑𑗒𑗓𑗔𑗕𑗖𑗗𑗘𑗙𑗚𑗛𑗜𑗝𑗞𑗟𑗠𑗡𑗢𑗣𑗤𑗥𑗦𑗧𑗨𑗩𑗪𑗫𑗬𑗭𑗮𑗯𑗰𑗱𑗲𑗳𑗴𑗵𑗶𑗷𑗸𑗹𑗺𑗻𑗼𑗽𑗾𑗿𑘀𑘁𑘂𑘃𑘄𑘅𑘆𑘇𑘈𑘉𑘊𑘋𑘌𑘍𑘎𑘏𑘐𑘑𑘒𑘓𑘔𑘕𑘖𑘗𑘘𑘙𑘚𑘛𑘜𑘝𑘞𑘟𑘠𑘡𑘢𑘣𑘤𑘥𑘦𑘧𑘨𑘩𑘪𑘫𑘬𑘭𑘮𑘯𑘰𑘱𑘲𑘳𑘴𑘵𑘶𑘷𑘸𑘹𑘺𑘻𑘼𑘽𑘾𑘿𑙀𑙁𑙂𑙃𑙄𑙅𑙆𑙇𑙈𑙉𑙊𑙋𑙌𑙍𑙎𑙏𑙐𑙑𑙒𑙓𑙔𑙕𑙖𑙗𑙘𑙙𑙚𑙛𑙜𑙝𑙞𑙟𑙠𑙡𑙢𑙣𑙤𑙥𑙦𑙧𑙨𑙩𑙪𑙫𑙬𑙭𑙮𑙯𑙰𑙱𑙲𑙳𑙴𑙵𑙶𑙷𑙸𑙹𑙺𑙻𑙼𑙽𑙾𑙿𑚀𑚁𑚂𑚃𑚄𑚅𑚆𑚇𑚈𑚉𑚊𑚋𑚌𑚍𑚎𑚏𑚐𑚑𑚒𑚓𑚔𑚕𑚖𑚗𑚘𑚙𑚚𑚛𑚜𑚝𑚞𑚟𑚠𑚡𑚢𑚣𑚤𑚥𑚦𑚧𑚨𑚩𑚪𑚫𑚬𑚭𑚮𑚯𑚰𑚱𑚲𑚳𑚴𑚵𑚷𑚶𑚸𑚹𑚺𑚻𑚼𑚽𑚾𑚿𑛀𑛁𑛂𑛃𑛄𑛅𑛆𑛇𑛈𑛉𑛊𑛋𑛌𑛍𑛎𑛏𑛐𑛑𑛒𑛓𑛔𑛕𑛖𑛗𑛘𑛙𑛚𑛛𑛜𑛝𑛞𑛟𑛠𑛡𑛢𑛣𑛤𑛥𑛦𑛧𑛨𑛩𑛪𑛫𑛬𑛭𑛮𑛯𑛰𑛱𑛲𑛳𑛴𑛵𑛶𑛷𑛸𑛹𑛺𑛻𑛼𑛽𑛾𑛿𑜀𑜁𑜂𑜃𑜄𑜅𑜆𑜇𑜈𑜉𑜊𑜋𑜌𑜍𑜎𑜏𑜐𑜑𑜒𑜓𑜔𑜕𑜖𑜗𑜘𑜙𑜚𑜛𑜜𑜝𑜞𑜟𑜠𑜡𑜢𑜣𑜤𑜥𑜦𑜧𑜨𑜩𑜪𑜫𑜬𑜭𑜮𑜯𑜰𑜱𑜲𑜳𑜴𑜵𑜶𑜷𑜸𑜹𑜺𑜻𑜼𑜽𑜾𑜿𑝀𑝁𑝂𑝃𑝄𑝅𑝆𑝇𑝈𑝉𑝊𑝋𑝌𑝍𑝎𑝏𑝐𑝑𑝒𑝓𑝔𑝕𑝖𑝗𑝘𑝙𑝚𑝛𑝜𑝝𑝞𑝟𑝠𑝡𑝢𑝣𑝤𑝥𑝦𑝧𑝨𑝩𑝪𑝫𑝬𑝭𑝮𑝯𑝰𑝱𑝲𑝳𑝴𑝵𑝶𑝷𑝸𑝹𑝺𑝻𑝼𑝽𑝾𑝿𑞀𑞁𑞂𑞃𑞄𑞅𑞆𑞇𑞈𑞉𑞊𑞋𑞌𑞍𑞎𑞏𑞐𑞑𑞒𑞓𑞔𑞕𑞖𑞗𑞘𑞙𑞚𑞛𑞜𑞝𑞞𑞟𑞠𑞡𑞢𑞣𑞤𑞥𑞦𑞧𑞨𑞩𑞪𑞫𑞬𑞭𑞮𑞯𑞰𑞱𑞲𑞳𑞴𑞵𑞶𑞷𑞸𑞹𑞺𑞻𑞼𑞽𑞾𑞿𑟀𑟁𑟂𑟃𑟄𑟅𑟆𑟇𑟈𑟉𑟊𑟋𑟌𑟍𑟎𑟏𑟐𑟑𑟒𑟓𑟔𑟕𑟖𑟗𑟘𑟙𑟚𑟛𑟜𑟝𑟞𑟟𑟠𑟡𑟢𑟣𑟤𑟥𑟦𑟧𑟨𑟩𑟪𑟫𑟬𑟭𑟮𑟯𑟰𑟱𑟲𑟳𑟴𑟵𑟶𑟷𑟸𑟹𑟺𑟻𑟼𑟽𑟾𑟿𑠀𑠁𑠂𑠃𑠄𑠅𑠆𑠇𑠈𑠉𑠊𑠋𑠌𑠍𑠎𑠏𑠐𑠑𑠒𑠓𑠔𑠕𑠖𑠗𑠘𑠙𑠚𑠛𑠜𑠝𑠞𑠟𑠠𑠡𑠢𑠣𑠤𑠥𑠦𑠧𑠨𑠩𑠪𑠫𑠬𑠭𑠮𑠯𑠰𑠱𑠲𑠳𑠴𑠵𑠶𑠷𑠸𑠺𑠹𑠻𑠼𑠽𑠾𑠿𑡀𑡁𑡂𑡃𑡄𑡅𑡆𑡇𑡈𑡉𑡊𑡋𑡌𑡍𑡎𑡏𑡐𑡑𑡒𑡓𑡔𑡕𑡖𑡗𑡘𑡙𑡚𑡛𑡜𑡝𑡞𑡟𑡠𑡡𑡢𑡣𑡤𑡥𑡦𑡧𑡨𑡩𑡪𑡫𑡬𑡭𑡮𑡯𑡰𑡱𑡲𑡳𑡴𑡵𑡶𑡷𑡸𑡹𑡺𑡻𑡼𑡽𑡾𑡿𑢀𑢁𑢂𑢃𑢄𑢅𑢆𑢇𑢈𑢉𑢊𑢋𑢌𑢍𑢎𑢏𑢐𑢑𑢒𑢓𑢔𑢕𑢖𑢗𑢘𑢙𑢚𑢛𑢜𑢝𑢞𑢟𑢠𑢡𑢢𑢣𑢤𑢥𑢦𑢧𑢨𑢩𑢪𑢫𑢬𑢭𑢮𑢯𑢰𑢱𑢲𑢳𑢴𑢵𑢶𑢷𑢸𑢹𑢺𑢻𑢼𑢽𑢾𑢿𑣀𑣁𑣂𑣃𑣄𑣅𑣆𑣇𑣈𑣉𑣊𑣋𑣌𑣍𑣎𑣏𑣐𑣑𑣒𑣓𑣔𑣕𑣖𑣗𑣘𑣙𑣚𑣛𑣜𑣝𑣞𑣟𑣠𑣡𑣢𑣣𑣤𑣥𑣦𑣧𑣨𑣩𑣪𑣫𑣬𑣭𑣮𑣯𑣰𑣱𑣲𑣳𑣴𑣵𑣶𑣷𑣸𑣹𑣺𑣻𑣼𑣽𑣾𑣿𑤀𑤁𑤂𑤃𑤄𑤅𑤆𑤇𑤈𑤉𑤊𑤋𑤌𑤍𑤎𑤏𑤐𑤑𑤒𑤓𑤔𑤕𑤖𑤗𑤘𑤙𑤚𑤛𑤜𑤝𑤞𑤟𑤠𑤡𑤢𑤣𑤤𑤥𑤦𑤧𑤨𑤩𑤪𑤫𑤬𑤭𑤮𑤯𑤰𑤱𑤲𑤳𑤴𑤵𑤶𑤷𑤸𑤹𑤺𑤻𑤼𑤽𑤾𑤿𑥀𑥁𑥂𑥃𑥄𑥅𑥆𑥇𑥈𑥉𑥊𑥋𑥌𑥍𑥎𑥏𑥐𑥑𑥒𑥓𑥔𑥕𑥖𑥗𑥘𑥙𑥚𑥛𑥜𑥝𑥞𑥟𑥠𑥡𑥢𑥣𑥤𑥥𑥦𑥧𑥨𑥩𑥪𑥫𑥬𑥭𑥮𑥯𑥰𑥱𑥲𑥳𑥴𑥵𑥶𑥷𑥸𑥹𑥺𑥻𑥼𑥽𑥾𑥿𑦀𑦁𑦂𑦃𑦄𑦅𑦆𑦇𑦈𑦉𑦊𑦋𑦌𑦍𑦎𑦏𑦐𑦑𑦒𑦓𑦔𑦕𑦖𑦗𑦘𑦙𑦚𑦛𑦜𑦝𑦞𑦟𑦠𑦡

The term "गणनामय" in the second part is the title of the text itself, the Ghanavyūha, rendered here as "Dense Array." The repeated use of "गणनामय" in this passage plays on the text's own title.

[illegible]

- The passage is a long philosophical verse inquiry, structured as a series of cosmogonic and

ontological questions addressed to "Fearless Vajra Essence," likely a figure in this sūtra's assembly. The questions survey rival causal theories — divine creation, yogic power, karma, time, direction, ignorance, and craving — before the final stanzas resolve toward an ālayavijñāna-based Yogācāra position, with the all-base consciousness as the turning force behind phenomenal diversity.

The term rendered "bull supreme among Victors" is a standard epithet for a supreme buddha; "divine sages" renders lha yi drang strong, literally "divine ṛṣis," meaning sages of the god realms.

The phrase rendered "like a mechanical corpse set in motion" refers to a ro langs, a Tibetan term for a reanimated corpse, used here as a simile for automatic, agency-less motion — comparable to a mechanical automaton.

"Tuṣita" in the line about the highest divine is a slight interpretive choice: the Tibetan dga' ldan mtshe ma rab rnam here likely refers to Tuṣita heaven's occupants (dga' ldan = Tuṣita) alongside other high divine beings; this is a genuinely uncertain identification and the rendering "Tuṣita, by the highest among the divine" reflects the most plausible reading.

- The final line is syntactically incomplete in the Tibetan as given; the passage breaks off mid-sentence. This has been rendered faithfully without invention.

The verse "like the moon in a lotus unstained" through "on the lotus petal, water likewise" forms a complex series of analogies that are somewhat compressed in the original. The rendering follows the grammatical structure as closely as possible; the doctrinal intent appears to be that the all-base consciousness and its objects co-exist without contaminating one another, like moon-reflections and water, or water on a lotus petal.

The phrase rendered "the person of the eight consciousnesses" follows the Yogācāra framework in which the individual is constituted by the full set of eight consciousnesses; "person" here renders the Tibetan "mi" used in an extended, technical sense paralleling pudgala.

- The epithet "Vajra Heart, the Fearless One" (rdo rje snying po 'jigs med pa) most likely refers to Vajradhara or a bodhisattva so titled; the exact referent in context is not entirely clear from this passage alone.

The section describing Brahmā's internal monologue is syntactically dense and has some ambiguity. The rendering follows the most coherent doctrinal reading: Brahmā contemplates whether pure "Brahman" equals highest understanding, and whether the various realms he surveys are true abodes. The passage appears to be drawing a contrast between Brahmā's limited understanding and the genuine realization of yoga taught by the Sage (the Buddha).

"Dense Array" (stug po, Sanskrit Ghanavyūha) is rendered consistently as a proper name for the buddha-field; on first use in the preceding passage it would have been glossed.

- The names Suśīma, Dilīpa, Yovanaśvāla, Ikṣvāku, and Gaganeśvara appear here as proper names embedded in what is clearly a hybrid Sanskrit-Tibetan poetic context. Suśīma and Dilīpa are ancient Indian royal or mythological figures; Yovanaśvāla appears to be a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit name (possibly "Yavanaśvāla" or similar) and its identification is uncertain. The passage enumerating those to whom the teaching might be addressed reads as a deliberate cosmological catalogue spanning all realms and classes of beings, including named figures from Indian legend.

The phrase rendered "those who sit at the edge" translates "མཇུག་མཇུག་པོ་" literally, meaning to sit at the boundary or margin — possibly indicating beings confined to the periphery of their realm.

"Tāramati of inexhaustible wisdom" renders "ཐོག་མཐོང་གི་ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་མཚན་པོ་" — ཐོག་མཐོང་ is a compressed name, possibly "Tāracandra" or a similar compound, and the reading is somewhat uncertain.

- The names in the opening lines present some difficulty. "Ratnamati at the crown" renders རིན་པོ་འཇུག་གི་མཚན་པོ་, which could mean either "the crown jewel of wisdom" as an epithet or a proper name Ratnakīrtibuddhi or simply Ratnamati "at the crown." In context, following the prior passage's list of named bodhisattvas, these are most likely proper names: Ratnabuddhiśikhara, Śāntamati, and the third Ratnamati — though the text's compression makes exact identification uncertain. The preceding passage's English already uses "Tāramati," "Gaganeśvara," and so forth, so the same register is maintained here.

The phrase རིན་པོ་འཇུག་གི་མཚན་པོ་ may be read as "addressing the one called Vajra" (i.e., Vajragarbha), which is the reading adopted; an alternative is "spoke in this vajra manner."

The segment beginning རིན་པོ་འཇུག་གི་མཚན་པོ་ རིན་པོ་འཇུག་གི་མཚན་པོ་ — "those dwelling in exquisite abodes of sovereignty should also speak with faithful wisdom" — is structurally somewhat loose in the original and the translation attempts to preserve the sense without over-smoothing.

- Several proper names in the section on Rāhu and those dwelling on earth appear to be phonetic transcriptions of non-Tibetan names or terms that resist confident identification: "Cimā-bu-ru," "Igśva-ku," and the gem-names "ro-nye," "zhā-nye," "andara-nyil," "aśma-garbha," and "musāra" are transliterated as faithfully as the Tibetan spelling permits. These may be Sanskrit, Prakrit, or other Indic terms rendered phonetically; their exact referents are uncertain and would require access to a parallel Sanskrit manuscript to resolve.

The passage "lha yi lha yi yul" meaning "the domain of the god of gods" is an intensive construction; it is rendered "the domain of the god of gods" to preserve the superlative force without over-interpreting whether a specific deity is intended.

The overall structure of this passage is characteristic of a sūtra or śāstra passage describing the omnipresent emanations of a buddha across beings of all kinds; the list of female beings across cosmological realms is a standard enumeration of the six or more classes of female beings who nonetheless cannot replicate the yoga of the sage.

- The term "Dense One" renders རྒྱུ་མཚན་པོ་, which in this context almost certainly refers to the Ghanavyūha pure land, the "Dense Array" buddha-field. This is a field particularly associated with the Yogācāra and certain Avataṃsaka-inflected traditions. The consistent rendering "Dense One" or "the Dense" has been used to match the preceding translation continuity.

The phrase rendered "dying rendered as no-syllable" reflects an obscure line:

ཐོག་མཐོང་གི་ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་མཚན་པོ་, literally "syllable made into no-syllable." This likely refers to a contemplative practice of dissolving the syllable-basis of a dhāraṇī or mantra into non-conceptual awareness — a technical point within the three gateways to liberation. The precise sense remains uncertain.

The phrase རིན་པོ་འཇུག་གི་མཚན་པོ་ "what is on top descends below" likely refers to the inversion of the subtle body's vital essences in ordinary conditioned existence, a trope found in tantric physiology.

- The phrase rendered "the God of gods" (Tibetan: lha yi lha) appears here as a superlative epithet likely referring to Brahmā or to the Buddha in his transcendence of the gods; contextually it is used alongside "the Sage" and "the Victor," so it most plausibly refers to the Buddha himself in this text's idiom, though the identification with Brahmā is possible given the surrounding Brahmā-realm discourse.

The chapter-colophon "The Arising of Womb-Birth" marks the close of chapter four; the subsequent verses open chapter five without an explicit title in the passage provided.

The phrase translated "path of certainty" (dog pa'i lam) is unusual; dog pa can mean "certainty," "decisiveness," or "finality." The rendering "path of certainty" follows the most straightforward reading, but a reading of "path of finality" or "path of the definitive" is equally possible.

- The refrain "ཡོག་པའི་ལམ་ལ་མཐོང་པོ་མཐོང་པོ་མཐོང་པོ་" is grammatically a rhetorical question meaning "Why would one not enter yoga?" — rendered consistently as such throughout. Some editors read it as an affirmative exhortation, but the rhetorical interrogative is more natural and contextually fitting.

The phrase "ཨ་ཨ་ཨ་ཨ་" is an exclamatory particle of lament or wonder; rendered here as "Alas!" given the contemplative context.

The phrase "འདྲིམ་པོ་གསུམ་པོ་" is somewhat ambiguous: "the three abodes proclaimed as brahman" could refer to the three realms being declared pure or absolute. The reading adopted here treats "འདྲིམ་པོ་" in its Sanskritic sense of brahman as pure or absolute, which fits the context of signs pervading the three realms. This is a genuinely uncertain phrase.

The passage ends mid-sentence, as it continues into the next passage beginning with the bodhisattva's name.

- The passage is from a complex tantric or proto-tantric verse context, and several phrases carry significant doctrinal density. The expression rendered "the treasure of the coupled pair" reflects a tantric technical usage where the union of method and wisdom is implied, though the Tibetan is somewhat compressed. "Kāmarāja" appears twice as a name for a deity associated with desire and conquest; it is kept in Sanskrit as the text treats it as a proper name in a list of cosmic powers. "The Lord of the Bull" renders འགྲོ་ལོ་ལོ་ལོ་, literally "chief of the herd," a well-known epithet of Śiva in his aspect as Vṛṣabhanātha; this is glossed in the body on first occurrence. The phrase འཇིག་རྟེན་གྱི་འཇིག་རྟེན་, rendered "the bearer of the burden and the domain of the burden," is a dense idiom whose precise referent is uncertain; it may allude to the notion of the buddha-realm as that which sustains all beings. The "three possessors of knowledge" likely refers to the three Vedic knowers in the tīrthika context, though some commentarial traditions read it differently.
- The phrase rendered "dense yogin" translates a Tibetan term that appears to indicate a yogin of dense or concentrated practice, possibly related to the notion of the "dense array" or concentrated practice ground. The exact referent is somewhat contextually obscure and may point to a specific tantric or meditative setting described elsewhere in the larger text.

The passage on the "barren woman" dreaming of a son is a classical Yogācāra illustration of the mind-only thesis and the unreality of apparent birth and death. The final line breaks off mid-simile, consistent with the instruction not to render more than the given passage.

The phrase "the sons of the Victors" refers to bodhisattvas, a standard usage of the epithet.

- The passage enumerates a series of places and beings used as subjects of contemplation or yoga. "Phaṇḍukambala and Pārayātra" renders "ཕ་མ་ལོ་ལོ་ལོ་ལོ་," which appears to refer to the nāga throne Phaṇḍukambala and the Pārayātra mountain range, both known from other Buddhist cosmological texts. The line "འདྲིམ་པོ་ལ་མཐོང་པོ་" is rendered as "what rests in the Kovidāra tree," Kovidāra being a tree known in Buddhist literature often associated with the heaven of the Thirty-Three. The line "འཇིག་རྟེན་གྱི་འཇིག་རྟེན་" is rendered as form being dismantled into particles, meaning the analysis of material form down to its atomic constituents; this is standard Abhidharma reasoning applied here to establish the absence of inherent existence.

- The image of karma, habitual tendencies, faculties, and sense-objects being compared to dreams, illusions, mirages, and lightning is a sustained Yogācāra-inflected argument that neither agents, acts, nor results have ultimate intrinsic existence, yet conventional function proceeds. The phrase rendered "takes up various inferior states" translates a term for grasping at unfortunate existences or bad rebirths. The passage on "iron, needle, and hollow tube, precious garlands and ornaments" is part of an argument that the sharpness of thorns, the talons of birds, and the diversity of creatures cannot be explained by karma operating through conceptual thought alone, pointing toward the spontaneous character of dependent origination. The final verse of the chapter is incomplete as given and breaks off mid-image; the translation faithfully renders what is present.
- The passage contains a list of animals that is partly in transliterated Sanskrit rendered phonetically into Tibetan. "Raṅga" and "Kṛṣṇasāra" are Sanskrit animal names (a type of deer and a blackbuck antelope respectively), rendered phonetically in the Tibetan as rang ga and kri shna sa ra; "śarabha" and "sura" are likewise Sanskrit names for particular animals (the śarabha is a legendary eight-legged creature; "sura" here may be a species of deer). These have been rendered with their Sanskrit names as they are not standard Tibetan terms. The final line is incomplete in the supplied passage and has been rendered as a fragment accordingly.
- The cosmological itinerary in the opening section moves systematically through the realms of the Buddhist universe: the desire realm heavens including the Thirty-Three and the gods who delight in magical creation, then the form realm Brahmā-abodes culminating in Akaniṣṭha, then the formless realm stations. This is consistent with Yogācāra-inflected cosmological enumeration found in texts associated with the Ghanavyūha corpus.

The phrase rendered "from a horn, salt likewise comes" is a somewhat puzzling naturalistic example in a series of transformation-of-cause illustrations; the point is that the result need not be identical in nature to its cause — a standard Yogācāra argument against Sāṃkhya-style causation (satkāryavāda).

The phrase "self-possessing one" in the colophon-adjacent verse likely refers to a master or deity associated with the yoga transmission; the Tibetan "bdag ldan" can also mean "the ātman-possessor," possibly a coded reference or a title within the text's transmission lineage. This is genuinely uncertain.

The atasī flower (linum usitatissimum, the flax plant) produces a pale blue flower; its appearance here in a visionary enumeration of how buddhas appear in the sky is a conventional simile for subtle, luminous forms.

- The epithet "Druma, lord of the kiṃnaras" refers to Druma (Tibetan: dru ma), a celebrated kiṃnara king who appears in several Mahāyāna sūtras, including the Druma-kiṃnarī-sūtra. The line rendered "the Druma, lord of the kiṃnaras" reads the preceding "divine diadem" as a separate image directing attention to this figure, though the syntactic relationship between the two lines is slightly compressed in the original.

The final word of the passage, rendered "buddha!" following "When confidence is gained," is a single syllable in the Tibetan that functions as a compressed predicate-exclamation, likely meaning "one becomes a buddha" or even as a direct address. The exclamatory rendering captures the rhetorical force of what appears to be a climactic affirmation.

- The passage contains a highly compressed philosophical exposition characteristic of an Abhidharma or Yogācāra verse-text, likely from a sūtra or śāstra presenting the ālayavijñāna doctrine. Several lines interweave cosmological, soteriological, and epistemological themes in rapid succession.

The phrase rendered "lord of desire, the master of craving" translates a compound referring to Māra as sovereign of the desire realm; contextually this is the deity who rules the highest heaven of the desire realm, distinct from māra as the inner afflictive force.

The line "the lineage that is diligent and without tranquility" is somewhat unusual; the Tibetan may mean a lineage of those who are energetically engaged and not yet at rest in calm abiding, i.e., actively practicing. This reading is adopted as the most contextually coherent.

The comparison of the all-base consciousness to "a tree at the center of a river" is a recognized Yogācāra simile: the tree remains distinct even while surrounded and carried along by water, illustrating how the ālayavijñāna persists through transmigration while retaining its own identity amid the stream of habitual tendencies and engaged consciousnesses.

- The passage lists various classes of non-human beings including "flesh-eaters" and "serpents" as translations of the Tibetan terms for rākṣasas and nāgas respectively, which fits the doctrinal context of the six classes of beings plus additional categories.

The phrase rendered "jealous realms of beings" reflects the Tibetan term that can mean jealous beings or asuras in some contexts, but here appears to indicate the full range of migratory states; the translation follows the broader contextual reading.

The reference to "atoms, time, principal matter, and the person endowed with a lord" is an allusion to tīrthika (non-Buddhist) philosophical categories — the Vaiśeṣika atoms, the Sāṃkhya principal matter (prakṛti), and the Śaiva notion of the lord-endowed person (paśu with Śiva as pati) — being implicitly contrasted with the Buddhist all-base consciousness as the true explanatory ground.

The figure of Vajragarbha as speaker is consistent with his role as interlocutor in the Daśabhūmikasūtra and related Yogācāra literature.

- The phrase rendered as "the supreme bull of the herd" translates an epithet meaning the foremost or chief among the herd, a traditional honorific for the Buddha in this literature.

The line "like iron to a hollow needle" alludes to a lodestone attracting iron through a hollow tube — a classical Indian simile for imperceptible influence; it recurs later in the passage in that exact form.

The passage "not like illusions / not like a cluster of hairs or a mirage" and the subsequent ontological negations are dense Yogācāra dialectic on the nature of consciousness and appearance; several lines are highly compressed and admit more than one reading, but the rendering given follows the most doctrinally coherent interpretation in context.

"Mur 'dug gzhan" — rendered "others seated in solitude" — could alternatively indicate specific practitioners or a technical term for a class of meditators; the Tibetan is slightly ambiguous but "seated in solitude" fits the immediate context of the verse.

- The phrase rendered "dense array" and "densely arrayed buddhafield" translates stug po, which is the Tibetan rendering of Sanskrit Ghanavyūha, the name of a buddhafield prominent in the Laṅkāvatāra Sūtra context. The text appears to be from the Laṅkāvatāra Sūtra or a closely related work.

The term ishikā (i sha ka) is a Sanskrit borrowing referring to a hollow reed or rush, used here as an example of something appearing substantial but being inwardly empty.

The final verse section shifts abruptly in topic and may belong to a transitional gāthā sequence at the close of the chapter; the colophon "eighth chapter" confirms a chapter boundary.

- The passage contains several technically dense Yogācāra-inflected discussions of "mere" (ཅོང་པོ་),

The simile at the end — iron, fat, and lac becoming liquid like water yet lacking the quality of water — is interrupted here; the passage breaks mid-analogy, which is reflected faithfully.

The lines about "a flying bird, a bee, and the intervening space" (飛鳥、蜂、及びその間の空間) are somewhat obscure; 飛鳥 may refer to a flying creature or bird, 蜂 to a bee or similar insect, and 及びその間の空間 to the intervening space or atmosphere between them. The exact identification of these three as a set analogy for things lacking inherent existence is uncertain.

The "cloud of Dharma" (धर्ममेघावस्थान) refers to the tenth bodhisattva ground, the dharma-megha bhūmi, which is standard in Yogācāra ground-doctrine.

- The phrase rendered "individual self-knowing awareness" translates so so rang rig, a technical term for reflexive or self-certifying awareness recognized especially in Yogācāra and Madhyamaka contexts. The specific doctrinal register here is Yogācāra.

The final lines concerning the all-base and conditions assert the Yogācāra position that the all-base consciousness is not straightforwardly produced by external conditions as if it were an ordinary conditioned phenomenon, nor does it simply produce them — the relationship is non-linear and avoids both eternalist and nihilist readings.

The line "the sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception" renders the Tibetan གཏུགས་ཀྱི་སྐད་ཀྱི་སྐད་ཀྱི་སྐད་, literally "where there is no perception," which in the Yogācāra cosmological context corresponds to the highest of the four formless absorptions, the sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception.

The closing sequence distinguishing the all-base, mentation, consciousness, and mind reflects the standard Yogācāra fourfold analysis: ālayavijñāna, manas, vijñāna, and citta respectively, with citta here specifically associated with the accumulation of karma. This is a technically precise doctrinal enumeration and is rendered accordingly.

- The phrase rendered "the sun-gem and the moon-gem" refers to crystals or gemstones believed in Indian cosmology to draw fire from the sun and water from the moon respectively when struck by those celestial rays — a standard Indian analogy for latent potential activated by an external condition.

The line "abides like a cluster of foam" translates a term that literally means "a heap of bubbles" or "foamy aggregate," used here as an image of insubstantiality analogous to the skandha similes in classical Pali and Sanskrit literature.

"Depleting the grounds" in the lodestone stanza renders a verb meaning to diminish or wear away the bodhisattva grounds, indicating that the all-base in its defiled mode obstructs progress through the stages.

- The list "atoms, the primal matter, the primal person, the unmanifest, and Brahmā" refers to Sāṃkhya and related non-Buddhist (tīrthika) philosophical categories being criticized as erroneous conceptualizations of the all-base: prakṛti (primal matter), puruṣa (primal person), and avyakta (the unmanifest) are Sāṃkhya terms; the inclusion of Brahmā follows standard Buddhist polemical catalogues.

The phrase rendered "trees of the undead" translates ro langs kyi shing, literally "zombie trees" or "trees animated by a corpse-spirit," a standard simile for something appearing alive but without genuine life.

The final lines of the passage are syntactically incomplete as given; the translation renders them faithfully up to the point of interruption.

- The phrase rendered "like a caterpillar moving onto a leaf" translates "srin bu pad pa bzhin," where pad pa likely refers to the leaf or blade the caterpillar moves onto before releasing the old one — a standard canonical simile for consciousness transferring between bodies (found in Pali sources as the inchworm simile). The basic doctrinal point is clear even if the precise image admits minor variation.

"Condensed Array" renders the text title Rgyan stug po, corresponding to the Sanskrit Ghanavyūha, which appears here as the colophon for the fourth and final fascicle.

"Abode of the Sage" for thub pa'i gnas is a relatively compressed phrase; it may refer to the meditator's own ground of practice as established by the Sage, i.e., the Buddha's teaching, or more concretely to the meditative abode itself. The doctrinal sense is unaffected.

- The phrase rendered "Candravarman the Victor" translates Zla dbang rgyal ba, which could equally mean "Candra the Victorious Moon-Lord." It functions as a proper name or epithet of a teacher figure consistent with Candragarbha mentioned in the preceding passage; the rendering preserves both the name and the honorific sense.

The term mur 'dug bdag tu smra ba, literally "sitting firm, asserting a self," is rendered as "those who speak of an abiding self," indicating holders of ātman-type views; the context contrasts them with those who understand selflessness.

The phrase 'khrul 'khor ro langs 'dra ba, "like a mechanical automaton that has risen up," refers to the classical Buddhist simile of an automaton or machine-driven figure to illustrate that the aggregates function without any inner agent, a well-attested doctrinal analogy.

The line rendered "like divine substances, they refine merit and view" (lha rdzas bsod nams lta sbyong ba) is compressed and elliptical; the general sense is that the Tathāgata's dhyānas function to purify both merit and view, as divine substances refine or purify.

- The medical passage in the middle of this text is a compressed enumeration of Āyurvedic humoral theory as received in the Tibetan tradition: the three humors are bile, phlegm, and wind, and the remedies are listed accordingly. The phrase rendered "the six members beginning with the bitter" likely refers to a classical six-limbed medical formula or compound known in Sanskrit medical literature, the exact identification of which is genuinely uncertain from the Tibetan alone.

The phrase rendered "the king of desire" translates a term that may refer either to Māra as the lord of desire or to desire itself personified as a sovereign force; both readings are possible, though the philosophical context of negating causal agents suggests the latter reading is more likely.

The expression "the third dharma" is briefly cryptic; in context it most plausibly refers to a third causal principle distinct from intrinsic nature and external conditions, possibly alluding to the Sāṃkhya concept of a primary cause or to another non-Buddhist philosophical position.

- The phrase rendered "the dense one" refers to the epithet Ghanavyūha or a dense or concentrated abode of the Tathāgata; the Tibetan stug po is ambiguous between a place-name Ghanavyūha and a descriptive adjective meaning "dense" or "thick." Given the context and the Yogācāra textual milieu, this is likely a reference to the Ghanavyūha realm, a Tathāgata-field described in certain Mahāyāna sūtras.

The line rendered "the divine substance called emptiness" translates lha rdzas stong pa nyid, where lha rdzas is literally "divine substance" or "celestial ingredient," a somewhat unusual phrase; it may carry the sense of emptiness as a supremely precious or efficacious substance, analogous to nectar.

The phrase "individual self-knowing awareness" renders so so rang rig, which in later Tibetan tradition becomes a technical term for reflexive self-awareness or rang rig, an important concept in Yogācāra and Dzogchen; here it appears in a critical context suggesting that conceptual minds lack access to it.

- The final line is incomplete as given, ending mid-sentence, which matches the source passage breaking off at that point. The translation preserves this incompleteness faithfully.

The phrase rendered "the teaching of density" (bstan pa stug po'i rgyan) refers to the Ghanavyūha, a known sūtra title meaning "Adornment of Dense Array" or "Dense Array Sūtra." The translation renders it descriptively to suit TTS narration; a note is warranted that this is a specific sūtra reference.

The verse on the "crested ones" and the peacock is an extended metaphor for the all-base consciousness and its seeds; the syntax is dense and slightly elliptical in the Tibetan, but the rendering follows the most natural doctrinal reading.

- The phrase rendered "divine substance of wandering existence" translates a compound meaning something like "the person who is like a divine substance or precious material among wandering beings." The exact nuance of this epithet is philosophically dense and may refer to the human person as the most precious vehicle for liberation among all beings.

The line "the covered, the held, the decisive, and the cutting" renders four technical terms that appear to denote categories of dialectical or philosophical analysis. Their precise technical meaning in context is uncertain; they may refer to types of logical engagement used in debate.

The passage as a whole appears to be from a text on the person or pudgala, using the analogy of a bird's track in the sky to teach that the person exists conventionally but leaves no ultimately findable trace, and that karma is not wasted. The philosophical school in question appears to assert a conventional person while denying a substantially real self.

- The term rendered "tree" throughout is a vocative and refers to a being called "the tree of the Sage" or "the one of the tree," appearing to be an epithet or name of the interlocutor at the Sage's bodhi-tree. The passage's cosmological and Yogācāra context is dense, and the tree figure likely represents the deity or spirit of the awakening tree (bodhi-vṛkṣa), addressed as such.

The passage's reference to "mind-only" (sems tsam) and the all-base consciousness (kun gzhi rnam par shes pa) places this firmly in a Yogācāra-inflected doctrinal context. The line "transformed from the mind-element" to become a Tathāgata reflects the tathāgatagarbha doctrine that the stained mind-element is refined into full awakening.

The term "pi wang" (pi wang, vīṇā) refers to a lute or vīṇā, a stringed instrument associated with the kinnaras. It is rendered "lute" throughout for naturalness.

The identity of the "noble Kāśyapa of excellent yoga" rendered as "'Od srung rnal 'byor bzang can" is Kāśyapa (the Tibetan 'Od srung = Kāśyapa). The address to the "divine crown" (lha yi cod pan) is somewhat obscure — it may refer to a divine interlocutor wearing a crown, or be a further epithet. No emendation was made to the text.

- The passage contains a dense list of bodhisattva names and epithets, several of which are not standard canonical figures but appear to be epithets or secondary names used in this particular tantra or sūtra context. "Drugma Lodrö" (Skt. uncertain), "King Lord of Dhāraṇī," "Ratnacūḍā the greatly miraculous," "the foremost among equals and holder of beings," and others in the list have been rendered as closely as the Tibetan allows; reliable Sanskrit equivalents for these secondary figures cannot be established from the Tibetan alone. The phrase rendered "dense pure field" for རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷན་སྒྲིལ་པོ་ལྷན་སྒྲིལ་པོ་ refers to the Ghanavyūha buddha-field, a concept well attested in Yogācāra literature; it has been rendered descriptively here since this is a TTS text and the Sanskrit term Ghanavyūha would require a gloss in any case. The verse structure in this passage is irregular and the translation preserves that irregularity rather than imposing false regularity.

- The five musical tones named here — ṛṣabha, dhaivata, ṣaḍja, keśī — are terms from Indian classical music theory (svaras). The fifth item in the set of five is partially obscured in the syllable count; the reading "keśī" for the fifth term is conventional in this context but may be a corruption or variant. This is a doctrinal and musicological detail rather than a translation problem, so it is flagged here rather than in the body.

The phrase rendered "the twofold nature of that" (mdo-na de yi nyis gyur tu) is somewhat opaque; it likely refers to the conventional and ultimate aspects, or possibly to body and speech, but the text does not specify, and no gloss has been introduced in the body.

"Geese on a lake" renders bra mo'i ngang pa'i rgyal po, literally "the king of geese on a bra mo lake" — a classic Indian simile for a noble or lordly figure.

- The phrase rendered "the mode of individual self-knowing" translates a passage about so-so rang rig (individual / reflexive self-awareness), a Yogācāra technical concept; the translation keeps this accessible without forcing Vijñaptimātratā terminology not explicit in the source.

The line "without dismantling the actual existence of phenomena" renders chos kyi dngos yod ma bshig par, indicating the śrāvaka realization of personal selflessness that stops short of the Mahāyāna realization of the selflessness of phenomena; this is a doctrinally significant distinction and is preserved as such.

The passage ends mid-sentence, consistent with the supplied Tibetan breaking off mid-stanza.

- The final colophon line indicates this is the conclusion of a sūtra drawn from a collection described as "the extensive ornament of twelve thousand" — likely referring to a twelve-thousand-verse scriptural collection or chapter division. The precise identification of the source text is uncertain.

The passage contains a sustained and technically intricate argument about the relationship between the all-base consciousness (ālayavijñāna), tathāgatagarbha, and purification, drawing on Yogācāra categories. The phrase rendered "the universal and the principal" reflects a polemic against Sāṃkhya categories (the universal or "general," sāmānya, and the principal, pradhāna), which are being critiqued as inadequate causal accounts of the world — a standard Buddhist refutation of non-Buddhist cosmogony.

The "seventh ground" reference designates the bodhisattva's seventh bhūmi, "Gone Afar" (Dūraṃgamā), at which the practitioner traditionally transcends the ordinary operative flow of consciousness and the gross dependency on the elements.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.